INTEREST OF ASMODEUS

INTERPLANAL CHAMPIONS

PLAYER'S GUIDE



Claimants of the First Crown

SUBCLASSES · SPELLS · RELICS · CONTRACTS · CLAIMANTS

PACTS & POLYHEDRALS

Interplanal Champions

Book II: Claimants of the First Crown · Player's Guide & Character Options

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Interplanal Champions *grew out of* Interplanal Champion: Interest of Asmodeus, *first run at the table in 2020 as the follow-on to* The Night of the Red Clause. *My thanks to everyone who played the original versions on the* ***Blown Away*** *server, my first playtest group and the first D&D server I ran. You crossed the first lava river, argued with the first imps and walked into the first arena, and every page of this campaign is better for it. Special thanks to the playtesters,* ***Tim, Alex, Heather and Kai****, and to the* ***Pacts & Polyhedrals****,* ***Blown Away*** *and* ***Imagi-Nations*** *Discord servers.*

Every crown is a contract. Read yours.

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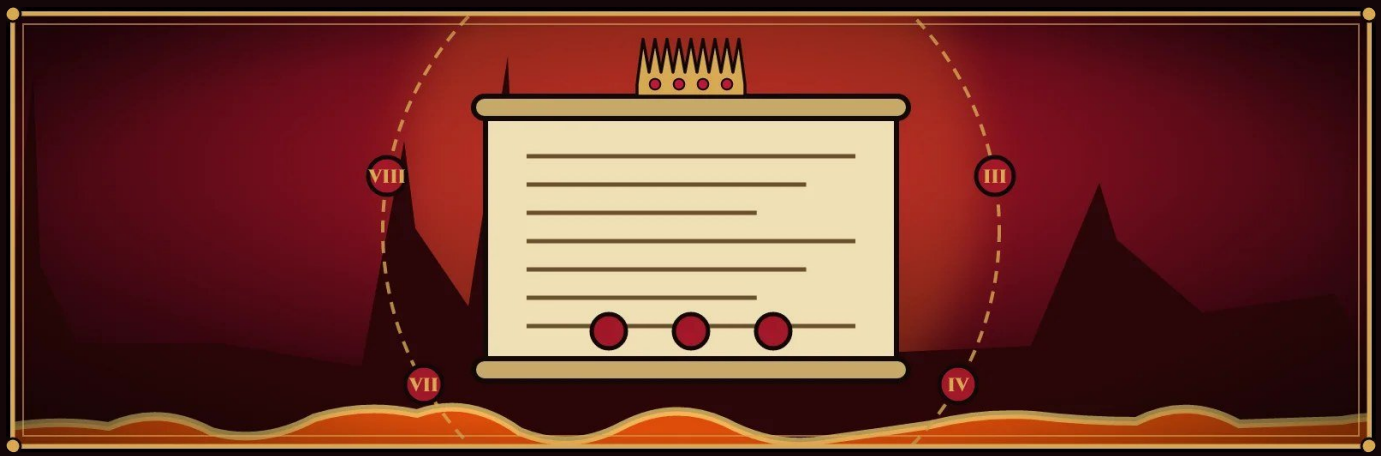
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Chapter 1

Claimants of the First Crown



Book II · Player's Guide & Character Options

Claimants of the First Crown

Interplanal Champions · A sequel to The Night of the Red Clause

Every crown is a contract. Read yours.

Three Asmodean subclasses. Seventeen contractual spells. Fourteen relics. Eight handout contracts. Six level-12 claimants ready for the First Crown. Designed to accompany the Asmodeun Scriptorium.

What kind of campaign is this?

Asmodeus has opened a new Rite of Succession for the First Layer of Hell. Challengers from many planes may compete for the throne of Avernus. Victory requires more than violence: contestants must demonstrate survival, clever legal manoeuvring, and the ability to win consent and command. The prize is real. A sole regent may rule; a declared allied slate may share power; a contestant may represent a patron; anyone may withdraw subject to the specific terms they signed.

You are not required to be evil, to sell your soul, to betray your friends, or to fight other player characters. The tournament invites all of those possibilities but makes none compulsory. Your choices can remake Avernus, reinforce its present horrors, or expose a scheme that neither the lords of Hell nor their challengers fully understand. What characters know before entering

- The tournament is an act of Asmodeus, whose sovereignty over the Nine Hells is unchanged. The successful challenger wins authority over Avernus, not Hell as a whole.
- Each claimant must prove Survival, Deviousness, and Dominion. Strength can qualify, but honourable ingenuity, negotiation and stewardship also count.
- Written agreements matter. Read every article. Contracts are public game objects with actual terms and remedies.
- The Brass Arbiter hears appeals. It can reject improper collection, forged signatures and unauthorised proxy bargains.
- There is a mechanism for individual, joint and proxy claims. Decide what your character actually wants before you arrive.

1. The Championship Charter

The Nine Articles of Infernal Succession

This is the real player-facing charter. It can be handed out and used at the table. In the fiction it is witnessed by the Office of the Ninth Crown. No DM-only appendix changes these terms without a visible amendment and the genuine acceptance of an affected signatory.

Article I - Notice and Acceptance. A contender enters only after freely accepting this Charter, personally or through a disclosed and authorised proxy. Participation does not by itself pledge a soul, bloodline, descendants, memories or previously held property. Contestants who decline are not subject to its competitive obligations.

Article II - Competence. Qualification for final investiture requires valid proof of Survival, Deviousness, and Dominion. Competence may be demonstrated by physical contest, tactical leadership, investigation, negotiation, contract drafting, or other witnessed acts relevant to the Proof. No particular alignment or class is required.

Article III - Form of Claim. A claimant may seek the office alone, as part of a joint slate, or as the disclosed representative of a patron. A joint slate is one legal claimant for eligibility and reward purposes, with several named members. It must publish its internal voting and succession rules before investiture.

Article IV - Consent and Persons. No soul, memory, identity, body, service beyond the explicit competition, or interest in a dependent is transferred by acceptance of this Charter. Additional bargains require separate, informed and specific acceptance by the person holding the right being transferred.

Article V - Evidence and Eligibility. Certified records, witnessed acts, magical verification and authentic signatures are admissible. Forged entries may be challenged. A claimant has a right to review allegations against their eligibility and to present counterevidence before exclusion.

Article VI - Hearings. The Brass Arbiter is independent of individual contestants and must state the clause upon which each ruling relies. An appeal submitted before a scheduled forfeiture stays that forfeiture until the hearing, except immediate defensive action during active combat.

Article VII - Deceit and Contest. Tactical deception, disguise, misdirection, negotiation, coercive battlefield magic within the agreed contest, and lawful exploitation of a clause are permissible. Forgery of the Arbiter's seal, false representation of another person's consent, and threats against uninvolved dependents are not. A successful combat feint does not transform into an agreement to transfer a soul.

Article VIII - Duties and Withdrawal. A contestant may withdraw before final investiture and depart via a sanctioned return route once any particular, previously signed service duties are discharged. Withdrawal forfeits unspent Crown Marks but incurs no new soul penalty. A crowned ruler must defend the First Layer against invasion, uphold the published governance charter and answer the superior authority of the Lord of Nessus.

Article IX - Investiture. The lawful victor obtains the First Crown and the ability to appoint ministers, issue civil decrees and govern Avernus subject to Asmodeus's superior sovereignty and existing higher infernal law. The prize may be held by a registered joint slate. Investiture is witnessed publicly by the Brass Arbiter; Asmodeus will not withdraw it solely because he dislikes a lawful outcome.

Player's Legal Quick Start

When arguing an objection, identify (1) the named contract, (2) the actual clause, (3) who owns the right, (4) the evidence of consent or default, and (5) your requested remedy. A well-substantiated factual contradiction may succeed without a roll. When an issue is genuinely disputed, the DM should announce its legal DC rather than hiding an unanswerable rule.

Three claims you can make

My crown: You will rule alone, rewarding allies with offices or granting them independence.

Our crown: Sign the Covenant of Joint Regency to govern together, with the ability to disagree under agreed rules.

Their crown: You represent an NPC or patron; declare who that is and what you will personally receive.

Chapter 2

PREGENERATED CLAIMANTS



Six complete 12th-level claimants, each on five pages: **I · Core**, **II · Features & Equipment**, **III · Spells** or **Tactics**, **IV · Backstory** and **V · Claim & Connections**. Built from the 2014 SRD and this book's subclasses. These versions keep each claimant's private pressure for the DM to share.



CHARACTER NAME
Aurelia Quill

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Warlock 12	The Ruby Court	Tiefling
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Former Foundation compliance attorney	Lawful Neutral	

I · Core

STRENGTH	DEXTERITY	CONSTITUTION	INTELLIGENCE	WISDOM	CHARISMA
−1	+2	+3	+2	+0	+5
8	14	16	14	10	20

+4 PROFICIENCY BONUS

☐ HEROIC INSPIRATION

SAVING THROWS

- ○ −1 Strength
- ○ +2 Dexterity
- ○ +3 Constitution
- ○ +2 Intelligence
- ● +4 Wisdom
- ● +9 Charisma

Advantage vs charm/fright by fiends (Reserved Rights, from 10th); one reroll vs a spell per long rest.

SKILLS

- ○ +2 Acrobatics DEX
- ○ +0 Animal Handling WIS
- ● +6 Arcana INT
- ○ −1 Athletics STR
- ● +9 Deception CHA
- ○ +2 History INT
- ● +4 Insight WIS
- ○ +5 Intimidation CHA
- ● +6 Investigation INT
- ○ +0 Medicine WIS
- ○ +2 Nature INT
- ○ +0 Perception WIS
- ○ +5 Performance CHA
- ● +9 Persuasion CHA
- ○ +2 Religion INT
- ○ +2 Sleight of Hand DEX
- ○ +2 Stealth DEX
- ○ +0 Survival WIS

● *proficient* ◆ *expertise*

PASSIVE SENSES

- 10 Perception
- 14 Insight
- 16 Investigation

Darkvision 60 ft.; Devil's Sight 120 ft.

15	+2	30 FT.
ARMOR CLASS	INITIATIVE	SPEED

Studded leather +1 (13) + Dex 2

MAX HP	CURRENT HP	TEMP HP
99		

HIT DICE	DEATH SAVES
12D8	Successes ○○○ Failures ○○○

DEFENSES

Resistance: fire, psychic

WEAPON ATTACKS & CANTRIPS

NAME	HIT / DC	DAMAGE / TYPE	NOTES
Dagger	+6	1d4 +2 piercing	range 20/60, finesse, light
Eldritch Blast ×3	+9	1d10 + 5 force each	120 ft.; Repelling Blast pushes 10 ft.

ON YOUR TURN

ACTION *Eldritch blast* (three beams, +9, 1d10 + 5 force each, push 10 ft.), cast a spell

BONUS Offer a Minor Term (Clause of Mutual Aid, 4/long rest): a willing ally adds a d6 once

REACTION *Counterspell*, *hellish rebuke*; Consideration Received when a hostile breaks a Term; Reserved Rights reroll

PROFICIENCIES & LANGUAGES

Armor Light armour

Weapons Simple weapons

Tools —

Languages Common, Infernal

CONDITIONS & NOTES



CHARACTER NAME
Aurelia Quill

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Warlock 12	The Ruby Court	Tiefling
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Former Foundation compliance attorney	Lawful Neutral	

Features & Traits

Class & Subclass Features

Clause of Mutual Aid
You learn Infernal and gain proficiency in Investigation or Persuasion. As a bonus action, you may offer one willing creature you can see within 30 feet a Minor Term : a feasible, clearly stated action to perform or avoid before... 4/Long Rest ☐☐☐☐

Consideration Received
When a hostile creature that has separately accepted a Minor Term from you knowingly breaks it within 60 feet, you can use a reaction to deal and gain temporary hit points equal to your Charisma modifier plus your proficiency... 5/Long Rest ☐☐☐☐☐

Reserved Rights
You gain resistance to psychic damage and advantage on saves against being charmed or frightened by fiends. Once per long rest, when you fail a saving throw against a spell or magical effect, you may use your reaction to reroll... 1/Long Rest ☐

Mystic Arcanum
At 11th level, your patron bestows upon you a magical secret called an arcanum. Choose one 6th-level spell from the warlock spell list as this arcanum. You can cast your arcanum spell once without expending a spell slot.

Agonizing Blast
When you cast Eldritch Blast, add your Charisma modifier to the damage it deals on a hit.

Repelling Blast
When you hit a creature with Eldritch Blast, you can push the creature up to 10 feet away from you in a straight line.

Devil's Sight
You can see normally in darkness, both magical and nonmagical, to a distance of 120 feet.

Book of Ancient Secrets
You can now inscribe magical rituals in your Book of Shadows. Choose two 1st-level spells that have the ritual tag from any class's spell list (the two needn't be from the same list).

Mask of Many Faces
You can cast Disguise Self at will, without expending a spell slot.

Mire the Mind
You can cast Slow once using a warlock spell slot. You can't do so again until you finish a long rest. 1/Long Rest ☐

Pact of the Tome
Your patron gives you a grimoire called a Book of Shadows. When you gain this feature, choose three cantrips from any class's spell list (the three needn't be from the same list).

Species Features

Hellish Resistance
You have resistance to fire damage.

Infernal Legacy
You know the Thaumaturgy cantrip. When you reach 3rd level, you can cast the Hellish Rebuke spell as a 2nd-level spell once with this trait and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest.

Attuned Magic Items (3 slots)

- ● **Marshal's Chain of Allegiance**
  When a willing creature within 30 feet explicitly accepts your command for a specific task of no more than 1 minute, you may link a spectral brass strand to it;
- ○
- ○

Other Magic Items & Potions

- ○ **Studded Leather Armor +1**
  This armor has been embellished with powerful runes, crafted in sorcerous fires, blessed by a powerful being, or some other event has seen it bequeathed with enhanced...
- ○ **Quill of True Notice**
  A signature written with this quill leaves an indelible, visible timestamp and the signer's chosen disclosed name on the original sheet; copies show a faint orange line.
- ○ **Potion of Greater Healing** ×2
  The potion's red liquid glimmers when agitated. You regain 4d4+4 hit points when you drink this potion.

Equipment

Item	Qty	Weight
Dagger *(equipped)*	1	1 lb.
Book	1	5 lb.
Ink Bottle	1	0.06 lb.
Ink Pen	1	0 lb.
Sealing Wax	1	0 lb.
Parchment	10	0 lb.
Backpack	1	5 lb.

Carried: 26.26 lb. · Capacity 120 lb.

Coins

CP	SP	EP	GP	PP
0	30	0	250	5



CHARACTER NAME
Aurelia Quill

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Warlock 12	The Ruby Court	Tiefling
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Former Foundation compliance attorney	Lawful Neutral	

CHARISMA — Spellcasting Ability

17 — Spell Save DC

+9 — Spell Attack

5th ○○○ 6th (Arcanum) ○

Spell slots (tick when spent)

Spells

	Spell	School	Time	Range	Comp.	Duration	Save / Atk
Cantrips (at will)							
●	Eldritch Blast	Evoc	1A	120 ft.	VS	Inst.	+9 atk
●	Mage Hand	Conj	1A	30 ft.	VS	1 min	—
●	Minor Illusion	Illu	1A	30 ft.	SM	1 min	—
●	Thaumaturgy	Trans	1A	30 ft.	V	1 min	—
●	Witness Mark	Div	1A	Touch	VS	1 hr	—
1st Level							
●	Comprehend Languages ®	Div	1A	Self	VSM	1 hr	—
○	Detect Magic ®	Div	1A	Self	VS	Ⓒ 10 min	—
○	Hellish Rebuke	Evoc	1R	60 ft.	VS	Inst.	DEX save
○	Identify ®	Div	1 min	Touch	VSM	Inst.	—
●	Protection from Evil and Good	Abj	1A	Touch	VSM	Ⓒ 10 min	—
2nd Level							
○	Darkness	Evoc	1A	60 ft.	VM	Ⓒ 10 min	—
●	Hold Person	Ench	1A	60 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 1 min	WIS save
●	Misty Step	Conj	1BA	Self	V	Inst.	—
3rd Level							
●	Counterspell	Abj	1R	60 ft.	S	Inst.	—
●	Sending	Evoc	1A	—	VSM	1 rnd	—
4th Level							
●	Banishment	Abj	1A	60 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 1 min	CHA save
●	Dimension Door	Conj	1A	500 ft.	V	Inst.	—
5th Level							
●	Audit the False ®	Div	10 min	Touch	VSM	Inst.	—
●	Hold Monster	Ench	1A	90 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 1 min	WIS save
6th Level							
●	Mass Suggestion	Ench	1A	60 ft.	VM	24 hr	WIS save

◆ *always prepared* ● *prepared* ○ *in spellbook / known, not prepared* ® *ritual* Ⓒ *concentration · 1A action, 1BA bonus action, 1R reaction*

Pact Magic: *three 5th-level slots, back on a short rest.*
Mystic Arcanum: *mass suggestion once per long rest.*
Book of Ancient Secrets rituals: *detect magic, identify. Hex and armor of Agathys (not SRD) are replaced by hellish rebuke and protection from evil and good.*



CHARACTER NAME

Aurelia Quill

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Warlock 12	The Ruby Court	Tiefling
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Former Foundation compliance attorney	Lawful Neutral	

IV · Backstory



Appearance

AGE	HEIGHT
34	5'8"
WEIGHT	**EYES**
140 lb.	Gold, slit-pupiled
HAIR	**SKIN**
Black, long	Ruby red
GENDER	**FAITH**
Female	The Ruby Court (a patron, not a god)

A tiefling in a severe black coat with ruby lining and gold spectacles, a quill always behind one horn.

Personality Traits

I keep a physical card for every Minor Term I offer, and I make the recipient initial it.

I cannot hear the word 'standard' attached to a contract without asking which standard.

Ideal

Truth. A government is only as honest as the records it certifies.

Bond

I signed off on the Red Clause's forms. Every honest ruling I win pays a little of that back.

Flaw

I want to be the final judge of what is true, and I do not trust anyone else with the job.

Allies & Organizations

The Brass Arbiter's clerks; former Hearthlight auditors; a former client whose soul is still owed.

Your Role

The Advocate. You read the clauses no one else reads, argue the party's case before Hell's courts, and unpick enemy magic from the back line.

Backstory

For six years Aurelia Quill was the Hearthlight Foundation's compliance attorney in Waterdeep. She checked the sums, the signatures and the seals, initialled every form, and never asked what the forms were for. She had been told they were charity. She believed it.

On the second day of the Red Clause hearing, the Brass Arbiter laid three forged default notices before her. Her initials were on every one. She could have claimed forgery. Instead she testified to all of it, lost her licence within the week, and walked out into the snow with nothing but her notes and her name.

Her patron found her a month later. The **Ruby Court** is neither god nor devil; it is judgment itself, grown cold and patient enough to bargain. It gave her three powers: to witness a promise, to suspend it, and to enforce it. Nothing more. She has not forgotten how blind she was, and she does not mean to be blind again.

Why You Entered

You want the power to say what is true in Avernus. Once Hell's records can be audited, a second Red Clause becomes impossible. You helped build the last fraud without seeing it. You will see the next one coming.



CHARACTER NAME
Aurelia Quill

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Warlock 12	The Ruby Court	Tiefling
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Former Foundation compliance attorney	Lawful Neutral	

V · Claim & Connections

How It Began

Midwinter in Waterdeep. Snow on the courthouse steps, and inside, the Brass Arbiter's verdict fell like a portcullis. The Hearthlight Foundation's charity had been a harvest of souls from the first signature. The Red Clause was void. The ruling, **Precedent H-25**, held that Hell may enforce a true bargain but may never forge consent.

Six strangers stood in that courtroom. Two testified to how the fraud was built. One kept the doors. One pressed her seal into the verdict. The last two had crossed the planes to beg help for a village Hell had swallowed, and were sent away with nothing.

That night each of them found a red envelope sealed with nine black thorns. Asmodeus had opened the throne of Avernus to any claimant who could prove Survival, Deviousness and Dominion under a Charter written for all to read. Six claimants, six reasons to sign, and each of them already knows too much about the others.

Your Claim

If you rule alone, you will found a Court of Review that can audit any contract in Avernus. **If the party shares the crown,** you draft the rules the council votes by. **If you back someone else,** you stand as advocate for the Brass Arbiter's independence.

Under the Charter you may claim alone, as one of a declared joint slate, or as the open representative of a patron.

The Other Claimants

Orren Fenwick. He built the registry your forms ran through. You damned him in open court. He never argued back, and that was worse.

Dame Caldris Vowborne. The Arbiter's bailiff. When Hearthlight's creditors came for you on the courthouse steps, she filled the doorway until they left.

Sister Nema Copperwrit. She took down your testimony word for word. She knows everything you confessed.

Varka Blackseal. You pressed your card into her hand when the court turned her away. She has never used it.

Ilyra Ashroot. She asked how long a contract should last. You said, 'As long as it is written.' She looked at you with pity.

Your Private Pressure

Your DM has one more note for you: the private pressure that will test your claim. Keep it to yourself until it matters.

Playing Aurelia

- You are the party's advocate: read every clause aloud and file the right objection.
- Three *eldritch blast* beams a turn, pushing with Repelling Blast. Hold one control spell per fight.
- Offer Minor Terms to willing allies as a bonus action; they get a d6 to add when it matters.



CHARACTER NAME
Varka Blackseal

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Barbarian 12	Path of the Blood-Price	Half-Orc
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Displaced battlefield rescuer	Chaotic Good	

I · Core

Ability Scores

STRENGTH	+5	20
DEXTERITY	+2	14
CONSTITUTION	+4	18
INTELLIGENCE	−1	8
WISDOM	+1	12
CHARISMA	+0	10

+4 PROFICIENCY BONUS

☐ HEROIC INSPIRATION

Saving Throws

- ● +9 Strength
- ○ +2 Dexterity
- ● +8 Constitution
- ○ −1 Intelligence
- ○ +1 Wisdom
- ○ +0 Charisma

Advantage on Dex saves you can see coming (Danger Sense).

Skills

- ○ +2 Acrobatics DEX
- ○ +1 Animal Handling WIS
- ○ −1 Arcana INT
- ● +9 Athletics STR
- ○ +0 Deception CHA
- ○ −1 History INT
- ○ +1 Insight WIS
- ● +4 Intimidation CHA
- ○ −1 Investigation INT
- ○ +1 Medicine WIS
- ○ −1 Nature INT
- ● +5 Perception WIS
- ○ +0 Performance CHA
- ○ +0 Persuasion CHA
- ○ −1 Religion INT
- ○ +2 Sleight of Hand DEX
- ○ +2 Stealth DEX
- ● +5 Survival WIS

● *proficient* ◆ *expertise*

Passive Senses

15	Perception
11	Insight
9	Investigation

Darkvision 60 ft.

16	+2	40 FT.
ARMOR CLASS	INITIATIVE	SPEED

Unarmoured: 10 + Dex 2 + Con 4 · Fast Movement

MAX HP	CURRENT HP	TEMP HP
137		

HIT DICE	DEATH SAVES
12d12	Successes ○○○ Failures ○○○

Defenses

Raging: resist bludgeoning, piercing, slashing; Relentless Rage

Weapon Attacks & Cantrips

Name	Hit / DC	Damage / Type	Notes
Greataxe +1	+10	1d12 +6 slashing	two-handed, heavy, +3 raging; vow +1d8 first hit/turn; Brutal Critical
Handaxe ×2	+9	1d6 +5 slashing	range 20/60, light

On Your Turn

Action Attack ×2 (greataxe +10, 1d12 + 6; +3 raging; first hit each turn +1d8 vow damage)

Bonus Rage (5/long rest) and speak a Battle Vow; Reckless Attack is free

Reaction Collateral Guardian (soak a hit for an adjacent ally, 4/long rest) or opportunity attack

Proficiencies & Languages

Armor Light and medium armour, shields

Weapons Simple and martial weapons

Tools —

Languages Common, Orc

Conditions & Notes



CHARACTER NAME
VARKA BLACKSEAL

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Barbarian 12	Path of the Blood-Price	Half-Orc
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Displaced battlefield rescuer	Chaotic Good	

II · Features & Equipment

FEATURES & TRAITS

CLASS & SUBCLASS FEATURES

Rage Covenant
When you enter a Rage, speak one Battle Vow whose condition you can reasonably fulfil: protect a named willing ally within 30 feet, hold a location you can see, or engage a declared enemy without deliberately fleeing.

Collateral Guardian 4/long rest ☐☐☐☐
While raging, when a willing ally within 5 feet is damaged by an attack, you can use your reaction to reduce the damage by 1d10 + your Constitution modifier + your Rage Damage bonus.

Witness to the Oath
When you begin Rage Covenant, you may designate one willing ally within 30 feet as a Witness . While your Rage lasts and you are conscious, that ally has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

Rage
In battle, you fight with primal ferocity. On your turn, you can enter a rage as a bonus action. While raging, you gain the following benefits if you aren't wearing heavy armor: You have advantage on Strength checks and Strength...

Unarmored Defense (Barbarian)
While you are not wearing any armor, your Armor Class equals 10 + your Dexterity modifier + your Constitution modifier. You can use a shield and still gain this benefit.

Reckless Attack
Starting at 2nd level, you can throw aside all concern for defense to attack with fierce desperation. When you make your first attack on your turn, you can decide to attack recklessly.

Danger Sense
At 2nd level, you gain an uncanny sense of when things nearby aren't as they should be, giving you an edge when you dodge away from danger.

Extra Attack
You can attack twice, instead of once, whenever you take the Attack action on your turn.

Fast Movement
Your speed increases by 10 feet while you aren't wearing heavy armor.

Feral Instinct
By 7th level, your instincts are so honed that you have advantage on initiative rolls. Additionally, if you are surprised at the beginning of combat and aren't incapacitated, you can act normally on your first turn, but only if...

Brutal Critical
Beginning at 9th level, you can roll one additional weapon damage die when determining the extra damage for a critical hit with a melee attack.

Relentless Rage
Starting at 11th level, your rage can keep you fighting despite grievous wounds. If you drop to 0 hit points while you're raging and don't die outright, you can make a DC 10 Constitution saving throw.

SPECIES FEATURES

Relentless Endurance 1/long rest ☐
When you are reduced to 0 hit points but not killed outright, you can drop to 1 hit point instead. You can't use this feature again until you finish a long rest.

Savage Attacks
When you score a critical hit with a melee weapon attack, you can roll one of the weapon's damage dice one additional time and add it to the extra damage of the critical hit.

ATTUNED MAGIC ITEMS (3 SLOTS)

- ● **Crownmark Gauntlets**
  While wearing them, you have advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks made to climb, grapple or hold a contested objective.
- ○
- ○

OTHER MAGIC ITEMS & POTIONS

- ○ **Greataxe +1**
  You have a +1 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with this magic weapon.
- ○ **Potion of Greater Healing** ×2
  The potion's red liquid glimmers when agitated. You regain 4d4+4 hit points when you drink this potion.

EQUIPMENT

Item	Qty	Weight
Handaxe	2	4 lb.
Hempen Rope (50 ft.)	1	10 lb.
Backpack	1	5 lb.
Bedroll	1	7 lb.
Rations	5	10 lb.

Carried: 44.2 lb. · Capacity 300 lb.

COINS

CP	SP	EP	GP	PP
0	30	0	250	5



CHARACTER NAME
VARKA BLACKSEAL

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Barbarian 12	Path of the Blood-Price	Half-Orc
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Displaced battlefield rescuer	Chaotic Good	

III · TACTICS & TRICKS

ATTACK REFERENCE

NAME	HIT / DC	DAMAGE / TYPE	NOTES
Greataxe +1	+10	1d12 +6 slashing	two-handed, heavy, +3 raging; vow +1d8 first hit/turn; Brutal Critical
Handaxe ×2	+9	1d6 +5 slashing	range 20/60, light

EVERY TURN

Two greataxe attacks: +10 to hit, 1d12 + 6 slashing (+3 while raging). Brutal Critical adds one extra die on a crit.

RAGE COVENANT

When you Rage, speak a Battle Vow. Keep it and the first creature you hit each turn takes +1d8 necrotic or fire.

RECKLESS ATTACK

Advantage on your Strength attacks this turn; attacks against you have advantage until your next turn. Pick your moments.

COLLATERAL GUARDIAN

Reaction: reduce damage to a willing adjacent ally by 1d10 + 7. You take half the prevented damage as psychic. 4/long rest.

WITNESS TO THE OATH

Name a Witness when you Rage: advantage on saves against fear, and once per Rage they add +3 to a missed attack against your vow's foe.

STAYING UP

Relentless Rage and Relentless Endurance both keep you standing. Rage resistance to bludgeoning, piercing and slashing.

CROWNMARK GAUNTLETS

Advantage to climb, grapple or hold an objective. Once per long rest, gain 15 temp HP when you drop a foe or hold a control point two rounds.

RESOURCE TRACKER

RESOURCE	USES (TICK WHEN SPENT)	RECOVERS
Rage	☐☐☐☐☐	long rest
Collateral Guardian	☐☐☐☐	long rest
Crownmark Gauntlets (15 temp HP)	☐	long rest
Potion of Greater Healing	☐☐	single use
Handaxe	☐☐	thrown
Hit Dice (d12)	☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐	long rest, regain half

NOTES



CHARACTER NAME
VARKA BLACKSEAL

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Barbarian 12	Path of the Blood-Price	Half-Orc
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Displaced battlefield rescuer	Chaotic Good	

IV · BACKSTORY



APPEARANCE

AGE	HEIGHT
38	6'4"
WEIGHT	**EYES**
260 lb.	Red-brown
HAIR	**SKIN**
Black, shaved at the sides	Grey-green, scarred
GENDER	**FAITH**
Female	Her own vows

A towering half-orc in scarred leathers and a crimson sash, a greataxe on her back and an iron rescue hook at her hip.

PERSONALITY TRAITS

I name what I will protect out loud before every fight.

I eat standing up, in case someone needs carrying.

IDEAL

Protection. Power is only worth having if you stand in front of the people beneath it.

BOND

The list of Greyhurst's missing is in my coat. I mean to cross every name off by finding them.

FLAW

I failed one vow. I am afraid of what I will agree to pay to make up for it.

ALLIES & ORGANIZATIONS

Refugees and deserters she has carried out of the ash; the Greyhurst survivors.

YOUR ROLE

The Shield. You stand in the front rank, take the blows meant for others, and keep the party breathing long enough to win. When the powerful forget the people beneath them, you remind them.

BACKSTORY

For eleven years Varka Blackseal worked the lip of a planar wound where the Blood War bleeds into the world. When the rift tore wider, people fell through it: refugees, deserters, children, down into ash and screaming dark. Varka went after them with a rope, an iron rescue hook and her grandmother's banner. No one has counted how many she carried out. She has.

Then **Greyhurst** fell. It was a village a day's ride from the wound, with bells, a ferry and a mill. In a single hour it was gone, every house and every soul dragged down into Avernus. Varka reached the empty field at dawn. She has carried the list of Greyhurst's missing ever since, and it grows each time she passes a notice board.

Her rage is a vow. Before every fight she names aloud what she will protect, and the Blood-Price makes her bleed if she lets it go. She has never broken a vow by choice. She broke one by failing, and a devil keeps the paper.

WHY YOU ENTERED

You took Ilyra to Waterdeep to beg the Brass Arbiter's help for Greyhurst. The court said it had no jurisdiction over Avernus. Now Avernus offers you that jurisdiction itself. Win, and Greyhurst's people come home, and no lord of the First Layer will ever again sit safe behind the line.



CHARACTER NAME
Varka Blackseal

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Barbarian 12	Path of the Blood-Price	Half-Orc
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Displaced battlefield rescuer	Chaotic Good	

V · Claim & Connections

How it began

Midwinter in Waterdeep. Snow on the courthouse steps, and inside, the Brass Arbiter's verdict fell like a portcullis. The Hearthlight Foundation's charity had been a harvest of souls from the first signature. The Red Clause was void. The ruling, **Precedent H-25**, held that Hell may enforce a true bargain but may never forge consent.

Six strangers stood in that courtroom. Two testified to how the fraud was built. One kept the doors. One pressed her seal into the verdict. The last two had crossed the planes to beg help for a village Hell had swallowed, and were sent away with nothing.

That night each of them found a red envelope sealed with nine black thorns. Asmodeus had opened the throne of Avernus to any claimant who could prove Survival, Deviousness and Dominion under a Charter written for all to read. Six claimants, six reasons to sign, and each of them already knows too much about the others.

Your claim

If you rule alone, you will set up a defender's regency, with the ruler on the walls and not in the palace. **If the party shares the crown,** you marshal its armies. **If you back someone else,** you stand for the Greyhurst survivors and make sure the winner keeps faith with them.

Under the Charter you may claim alone, as one of a declared joint slate, or as the open representative of a patron.

The other claimants

Ilyra Ashroot. Six years at the wound together. You haul out the living and she keeps the names of the dead. You trust her above anyone alive.

Dame Caldris Vowborne. She commanded the relief column at the rift the night Greyhurst fell. You scouted for her. Her orders were to hold, and she held.

Sister Nema Copperwrit. Years ago you carried three of her novices out of a collapsing rift. A letter still comes from her every winter.

Aurelia Quill. A lawyer with a conscience, she claims. You are still deciding.

Orren Fenwick. He keeps apologising to you for things he has not yet explained.

Your private pressure

Your DM has one more note for you: the private pressure that will test your claim. Keep it to yourself until it matters.

Playing Varka

- Rage, then speak a Battle Vow: protect, hold, or engage. Keep it and your first hit each turn burns for +1d8.
- Collateral Guardian: soak a hit for an adjacent ally (your reaction, and you take half as psychic).
- Name a Witness at 10th level: they get advantage against fear and a once-per-rage boost against your foe.



CHARACTER NAME
Ilyra Ashroot

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Druid 12	Circle of Ashen Covenants	High Elf
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Planar refugee-warden	Neutral Good	

I · Core

STRENGTH −1 (8)
DEXTERITY +2 (14)
CONSTITUTION +3 (16)
INTELLIGENCE +1 (12)
WISDOM +5 (20)
CHARISMA +0 (10)

+4 PROFICIENCY BONUS

☐ HEROIC INSPIRATION

SAVING THROWS

- ○ −1 Strength
- ○ +2 Dexterity
- ○ +3 Constitution
- ● +5 Intelligence
- ● +9 Wisdom
- ○ +0 Charisma

Advantage vs charm; can't be magically put to sleep (Fey Ancestry).

SKILLS

- ○ +2 Acrobatics DEX
- ○ +5 Animal Handling WIS
- ○ +1 Arcana INT
- ○ −1 Athletics STR
- ○ +0 Deception CHA
- ○ +1 History INT
- ● +9 Insight WIS
- ○ +0 Intimidation CHA
- ○ +1 Investigation INT
- ● +9 Medicine WIS
- ● +5 Nature INT
- ● +9 Perception WIS
- ○ +0 Performance CHA
- ○ +0 Persuasion CHA
- ○ +1 Religion INT
- ○ +2 Sleight of Hand DEX
- ○ +2 Stealth DEX
- ● +9 Survival WIS

● *proficient* ◆ *expertise*

PASSIVE SENSES

- 19 Perception
- 19 Insight
- 11 Investigation

Darkvision 60 ft.

17 ARMOR CLASS
+2 INITIATIVE
35 FT. SPEED

Hide 12 + Dex 2 + Shield +1 (3) · wood elf

MAX HP	CURRENT HP	TEMP HP
99		

HIT DICE: 12D8

DEATH SAVES: Successes ○○○ Failures ○○○

DEFENSES

Resistance: fire (Covenant of Embers, 10th)

WEAPON ATTACKS & CANTRIPS

Name	Hit / DC	Damage / Type	Notes
Sickle	+3	1d4 −1 slashing	light
Produce Flame	+9	3d8 fire	30 ft.
Ash Warden: Ashen Touch	+9	2d8 + 4 fire	bonus action command

ON YOUR TURN

Action Cast a spell, Wild Shape (beast, or Ashen fiend up to CR 4), or manifest the Ash Warden Spirit (bonus action, costs a Wild Shape use)

Bonus Command the Ash Warden (Ashen Touch +9, 2d8 + 4 fire), *healing word*, *shillelagh*

Reaction Witness of the Grove (reduce damage to the Accord bearer by 1d8 + 5) or Remedy of the Root (−1d6 to an attacker)

PROFICIENCIES & LANGUAGES

Armor Light and medium armour, shields (no metal)

Weapons Clubs, daggers, darts, javelins, maces, quarterstaffs, scimitars, sickles, slings, spears

Tools Herbalism kit

Languages Common, Elvish, Sylvan, Druidic

CONDITIONS & NOTES



CHARACTER NAME
Ilyra Ashroot

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Druid 12	Circle of Ashen Covenants	High Elf
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Planar refugee-warden	Neutral Good	

Features & Traits

Class & Subclass Features

Witness of the Grove
You gain proficiency in Insight or Nature, and learn Infernal or Sylvan. As a 1-minute rite, you may place an Ashen Accord on one willing creature you touch. 4/long rest ☐☐☐☐

Ash Warden Spirit
As a bonus action you can expend one use of Wild Shape to manifest an Ash Warden Spirit in an unoccupied space within 30 feet for 10 minutes. Ash Warden Spirit. Small Elemental; AC 13 + your proficiency bonus;

Ashen Forms
When you use Wild Shape, you can transform into a fiend from the Ashen Forms list instead of a beast. The Circle teaches the shapes of Hell's lesser servants so that its druids can walk among them, and turn them.

Remedy of the Root
When a creature you can see within 60 feet harms the bearer of your Ashen Accord, you can use your reaction to impose a −1d6 penalty on one attack roll that creature makes before the end of its next turn; 5/long rest ☐☐☐☐☐

Covenant of Embers
You gain resistance to fire damage. When your Ash Warden Spirit is within 30 feet of the bearer of your Ashen Accord, the bearer has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

Infernal Form
You can expend two uses of Wild Shape at the same time to take an Infernal Form : a Barbed Devil or an Ashen Hellwarden (both CR 5). This works like the Circle of the Moon's Elemental Wild Shape.

Druidic
You know Druidic, the secret language of druids. You can speak the language and use it to leave hidden messages. You and others who know this language automatically spot such a message.

Wild Shape
Starting at 2nd level, you can use your action to magically assume the shape of a beast that you have seen before. You can use this feature twice. You regain expended uses when you finish a short or long rest.

Species Features

Fey Ancestry
You have advantage on saving throws against being charmed, and magic can't put you to sleep.

Trance
Elves don't need to sleep. Instead, they meditate deeply, remaining semiconscious, for 4 hours a day. (The Common word for such meditation is "trance.") While meditating, you can dream after a fashion;

Attuned Magic Items (3 slots)

- ● **Ashen Seed of Remembrance**
  Planting this dark-red seed over 1 minute creates a 20-foot-radius thicket lasting 1 hour. Willing creatures resting within it have advantage on checks and saving throws against magical memory...
- ○
- ○

Other Magic Items & Potions

- ○ **Shield +1**
  While holding this shield, you have a bonus to AC of +1. This bonus is in addition to the shield's normal bonus to AC.
- ○ **Potion of Greater Healing** ×2
  The potion's red liquid glimmers when agitated. You regain 4d4+4 hit points when you drink this potion.

Equipment

Item	Qty	Weight
Hide Armor *(equipped)*	1	12 lb.
Sickle *(equipped)*	1	2 lb.
Sprig of Mistletoe *(equipped)*	1	0 lb.
Healer's Kit	1	3 lb.
Backpack	1	5 lb.

Carried: 29.2 lb. · Capacity 120 lb.

Coins

CP	SP	EP	GP	PP
0	30	0	250	5



CHARACTER NAME
Ilyra Ashroot

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Druid 12	Circle of Ashen Covenants	High Elf
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Planar refugee-warden	Neutral Good	

WISDOM	17	+9
SPELLCASTING ABILITY	SPELL SAVE DC	SPELL ATTACK

1st ○○○○ 2nd ○○○ 3rd ○○○ 4th ○○○ 5th ○○ 6th ○

SPELL SLOTS (TICK WHEN SPENT)

Spells

	Spell	School	Time	Range	Comp.	Duration	Save / Atk
Cantrips (at will)							
●	Druidcraft	Trans	1A	30 ft.	VS	Inst.	—
●	Guidance	Div	1A	Touch	VS	Ⓒ 1 min	—
●	Produce Flame	Conj	1A	30 ft.	VS	10 min	+9 atk
●	Shillelagh	Trans	1BA	Touch	VSM	1 min	+9 atk
1st Level							
●	Detect Magic ®	Div	1A	Self	VS	Ⓒ 10 min	—
●	Entangle	Conj	1A	90 ft.	VS	Ⓒ 1 min	STR save
●	Faerie Fire	Evoc	1A	60 ft.	V	Ⓒ 1 min	DEX save
●	Healing Word	Evoc	1BA	60 ft.	V	Inst.	Heal
2nd Level							
●	Lesser Restoration	Abj	1A	Touch	VS	Inst.	—
●	Pass without Trace	Abj	1A	Self	VSM	Ⓒ 1 hr	—
●	Spike Growth	Trans	1A	150 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 10 min	—
3rd Level							
●	Call Lightning	Conj	1A	120 ft.	VS	Ⓒ 10 min	DEX save
●	Dispel Magic	Abj	1A	120 ft.	VS	Inst.	—
●	Plant Growth	Trans	1A	150 ft.	VS	Inst.	—
○	Writ of Safe Passage ®	Abj	10 min	Touch	VSM	1 hr	—
4th Level							
○	Breach of Dominion	Trans	1A	90 ft.	VS	Inst.	CON save
●	Conjure Woodland Beings	Conj	1A	60 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 1 hr	—
●	Freedom of Movement	Abj	1A	Touch	VSM	1 hr	—
●	Polymorph	Trans	1A	60 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 1 hr	WIS save
●	Wall of Fire	Evoc	1A	120 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 1 min	DEX save
5th Level							
●	Greater Restoration	Abj	1A	Touch	VSM	Inst.	—
●	Wall of Stone	Evoc	1A	120 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 10 min	DEX save
6th Level							
●	Heal	Evoc	1A	60 ft.	VS	Inst.	Heal

◆ *always prepared* ● *prepared* ○ *in spellbook / known, not prepared* ® *ritual* Ⓒ *concentration · 1A action, 1BA bonus action, 1R reaction*

Prepare 17 spells after a long rest. Wild Shape 2/short rest: a beast or an Ashen fiend up to CR 4 (Book II); both uses for a CR 5 Infernal Form; or one use for the Ash Warden Spirit.
Ashen Accord: *a 1-minute rite on one willing ally.*



CHARACTER NAME
Ilyra Ashroot

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Druid 12	Circle of Ashen Covenants	High Elf
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Planar refugee-warden	Neutral Good	

IV · Backstory



Appearance

AGE	HEIGHT
212	5'6"
WEIGHT	**EYES**
110 lb.	Green
HAIR	**SKIN**
Ash-white	Copper-brown
GENDER	**FAITH**
Female	The Ash Covenant (the turning of seasons)

A wood elf in moss-green hide armour with a crown of dried winter roses and a moonstone sickle at her belt.

Personality Traits

I press a dried rose into the hand of anyone I comfort.

I count the seasons of every promise I hear.

Ideal

Renewal. Every obligation needs a season in which it ends.

Bond

My ledger holds the names of people the war swallowed. I will not let anyone sell them.

Flaw

I am keeping a memory that is not mine, and I tell myself it is for the owner's good.

Allies & Organizations

The Ashroot grove; Blood War refugees; any druid who keeps a record of the lost.

Your Role

The Keeper. You heal, shield and shape the ground of every battle. In the story you remember the people everyone else has written off, and you hold the powerful to one law: every bargain must end.

Backstory

Ilyra Ashroot's grove stands where the Feywild frays against a planar wound, and for two hundred years its ash has fallen like snow. Her order, the **Circle of Ashen Covenants**, keeps what the Blood War devours: names cut into bark, voices sealed in seed-pods, a ledger of souls whose names were stolen. Its oldest teaching is simple. Every oath is a season, and every season must end.

For six years she has stood beside Varka Blackseal. Varka drags the living from the rift, and Ilyra keeps the names of those who never come back. When Greyhurst fell, she planted black trees on the empty field, one for every name on Varka's list.

She went with Varka to Waterdeep and watched the court turn them away. She came to Avernus with dried winter roses in her satchel, the bark-ledger of the lost on her back, and one memory that is not hers to keep.

Why You Entered

You want one law carved above the throne of Avernus: every obligation ends. A soul-debt without a season of release is not a contract. It is a cage. Win, and the First Crown must answer to the living, and no debt in Hell will run forever.



CHARACTER NAME
Ilyra Ashroot

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Druid 12	Circle of Ashen Covenants	High Elf
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Planar refugee-warden	Neutral Good	

V · Claim & Connections

How It Began

Midwinter in Waterdeep. Snow on the courthouse steps, and inside, the Brass Arbiter's verdict fell like a portcullis. The Hearthlight Foundation's charity had been a harvest of souls from the first signature. The Red Clause was void. The ruling, **Precedent H-25**, held that Hell may enforce a true bargain but may never forge consent.

Six strangers stood in that courtroom. Two testified to how the fraud was built. One kept the doors. One pressed her seal into the verdict. The last two had crossed the planes to beg help for a village Hell had swallowed, and were sent away with nothing.

That night each of them found a red envelope sealed with nine black thorns. Asmodeus had opened the throne of Avernus to any claimant who could prove Survival, Deviousness and Dominion under a Charter written for all to read. Six claimants, six reasons to sign, and each of them already knows too much about the others.

Your Claim

If you rule alone, you will found an Ash Covenant, a crown that must renew its consent with the governed every season. **If the party shares the crown,** you are its conscience and keep the succession records. **If you back someone else,** you sponsor a free civic council for Avernus's mortal survivors.

Under the Charter you may claim alone, as one of a declared joint slate, or as the open representative of a patron.

The Other Claimants

Varka Blackseal. Your partner at the wound and your dearest friend. You are keeping a secret from her, and it grows heavier with every mile.

Sister Nema Copperwrit. She knows a contract can be honest and still be cruel. You trust her judgment, but not yet her monastery.

Dame Caldris Vowborne. After Greyhurst she came to your grove and planted a tree with her own hands. She would not say for whom.

Aurelia Quill. She believes the written word is enough. You hope she learns otherwise before it costs her.

Orren Fenwick. He asked to copy your bark-ledger 'for indexing'. You refused.

Your Private Pressure

Your DM has one more note for you: the private pressure that will test your claim. Keep it to yourself until it matters.

Playing Ilyra

- Place the Ashen Accord on your frontliner before the fight (a 1-minute rite).
- Spend Wild Shape to manifest your Ash Warden Spirit; command it with a bonus action for 2d8 + 4 fire.
- Or Wild Shape into an Ashen fiend up to CR 4 (a Writ Hound or Barbed Toll-Warden), or spend both uses on a CR 5 Infernal Form.
- Use your reaction to shield the Accord's bearer, or to curse an attacker's next roll (Remedy of the Root).



CHARACTER NAME
Orren Fenwick

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Wizard 12	School of Infernal Contracts	Human
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Former infernal archivist	Neutral	

I · Core

STRENGTH	DEXTERITY	CONSTITUTION	INTELLIGENCE	WISDOM	CHARISMA
−1	+2	+2	+5	+1	+0
8	14	14	20	12	10

+4 PROFICIENCY BONUS

☐ HEROIC INSPIRATION

SAVING THROWS

- ○ +0 Strength
- ○ +3 Dexterity
- ○ +3 Constitution
- ● +10 Intelligence
- ● +6 Wisdom
- ○ +1 Charisma

+1 Cloak of Protection.

SKILLS

- ○ +2 Acrobatics DEX
- ○ +1 Animal Handling WIS
- ● +9 Arcana INT
- ○ −1 Athletics STR
- ○ +0 Deception CHA
- ● +9 History INT
- ○ +1 Insight WIS
- ○ +0 Intimidation CHA
- ● +9 Investigation INT
- ○ +1 Medicine WIS
- ○ +5 Nature INT
- ○ +1 Perception WIS
- ○ +0 Performance CHA
- ○ +0 Persuasion CHA
- ● +9 Religion INT
- ○ +2 Sleight of Hand DEX
- ○ +2 Stealth DEX
- ○ +1 Survival WIS

● *proficient* ◆ *expertise*

PASSIVE SENSES

11	Perception
11	Insight
19	Investigation

—

ARMOR CLASS	INITIATIVE	SPEED
16	+2	30 FT.

Mage armour 13 + Dex 2 + Cloak 1 (13 without mage armour)

MAX HP	CURRENT HP	TEMP HP
74		

HIT DICE	DEATH SAVES
12D6	Successes ○○○ Failures ○○○

DEFENSES

—

WEAPON ATTACKS & CANTRIPS

Name	Hit / DC	Damage / Type	Notes
Dagger	+6	1d4 +2 piercing	range 20/60, finesse, light
Fire Bolt	+9	3d10 fire	120 ft.
Ember Receipt	+9	3d8 fire (+1d4 if a promise was broken)	60 ft.

ON YOUR TURN

Action Cast a spell; Devil's Retainer takes Dash, Hide, Help or scribes

Bonus Contract Sigil: a bearer adds a d6 to one damage roll or save per turn (5/long rest)

Reaction *Shield*, *counterspell*; retainer's Object! (disadvantage on a save, 1/long rest)

PROFICIENCIES & LANGUAGES

Armor —

Weapons Daggers, darts, slings, quarterstaffs, light crossbows

Tools Calligrapher's supplies

Languages Common, Infernal, Draconic, Abyssal

CONDITIONS & NOTES



CHARACTER NAME
Orren Fenwick

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Wizard 12	School of Infernal Contracts	Human
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Former infernal archivist	Neutral	

II · Features & Equipment

Features & Traits

Class & Subclass Features

Runic Drafting
You gain proficiency with calligrapher's supplies and learn to read, write, and speak Infernal. You also learn the fine print cantrip, which does not count against your number of cantrips known.

Contract Sigil — 5/long rest ☐☐☐☐☐
As a bonus action, you can bind yourself or a willing creature you can touch with a Contract Sigil —a glowing infernal rune and a whispered clause.

Devil's Retainer — 1/long rest ☐
Over a 10-minute ritual, you bind a lesser devil into your service as a clerk. It uses the imp stat block, but it cannot make attacks and its Sting attack is replaced by the ability to Help.

Binding Authority
When you cast a spell that summons, calls, or binds a fiend, the creature obeys your spoken commands for the spell's duration without requiring a check or a saving throw to control it, provided you have not violated any term you...

Master of Covenants
Your mastery of infernal law deepens. Twin Contracts. You can maintain two Contract Sigils simultaneously, on different creatures. Superior Drafting. The Contract Sigil die becomes a d6 . Warding Covenants.

Arcane Recovery — 1/long rest ☐
You have learned to regain some of your magical energy by studying your spellbook. Once per day when you finish a short rest, you can choose expended spell slots to recover.

Attuned Magic Items (3 slots)

- ● **Gavel of Appeal**
  This blackwood gavel has 3 charges, regaining 1d3 daily. As an action expend one charge to cast dispel magic at 4th level.
- ● **Cloak of Protection**
  You gain a +1 bonus to AC and saving throws while you wear this cloak.
- ○

Other Magic Items & Potions

- ○ **Potion of Greater Healing** ×2
  The potion's red liquid glimmers when agitated. You regain 4d4+4 hit points when you drink this potion.

Equipment

Item	Qty	Weight
Spellbook	1	3 lb.
Component Pouch	1	2 lb.
Dagger	1	1 lb.
Ink Bottle	3	0.18 lb.
Ink Pen	1	0 lb.
Backpack	1	5 lb.

Carried: 15.38 lb. · Capacity 120 lb.

Coins

CP	SP	EP	GP	PP
0	30	0	250	5



CHARACTER NAME
Orren Fenwick

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Wizard 12	School of Infernal Contracts	Human
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Former infernal archivist	Neutral	

Intelligence
Spellcasting Ability

17
Spell Save DC

+9
Spell Attack

1st ○○○○ 2nd ○○○ 3rd ○○○ 4th ○○○ 5th ○○ 6th ○
Spell Slots (tick when spent)

Spells

	Spell	School	Time	Range	Comp.	Duration	Save / Atk
Cantrips (at will)							
●	Ember Receipt	Evoc	1A	60 ft.	VS	Inst.	+9 atk
◆	Fine Print	Div	1A	Touch	VS	1 min	—
●	Fire Bolt	Evoc	1A	120 ft.	VS	Inst.	+9 atk
●	Mage Hand	Conj	1A	30 ft.	VS	1 min	—
●	Minor Illusion	Illu	1A	30 ft.	SM	1 min	—
●	Prestidigitation	Trans	1A	10 ft.	VS	1 hr	—
1st Level							
○	Comprehend Languages ®	Div	1A	Self	VSM	1 hr	—
●	Detect Magic ®	Div	1A	Self	VS	Ⓒ 10 min	—
●	Find Familiar ®	Conj	1 hr	10 ft.	VSM	Inst.	—
○	Identify ®	Div	1 min	Touch	VSM	Inst.	—
●	Mage Armor	Abj	1A	Touch	VSM	8 hr	—
●	Shield	Abj	1R	Self	VS	1 rnd	—
2nd Level							
●	Mirror Image	Illu	1A	Self	VS	1 min	—
●	Misty Step	Conj	1BA	Self	V	Inst.	—
○	Registry of Names ®	Div	10 min	Touch	VSM	Inst.	—
3rd Level							
●	Counterspell	Abj	1R	60 ft.	S	Inst.	—
●	Dispel Magic	Abj	1A	120 ft.	VS	Inst.	—
●	Fireball	Evoc	1A	150 ft.	VSM	Inst.	DEX save
●	Fly	Trans	1A	Touch	VSM	Ⓒ 10 min	—
○	Writ of Safe Passage ®	Abj	10 min	Touch	VSM	1 hr	—
4th Level							
●	Dimension Door	Conj	1A	500 ft.	V	Inst.	—
●	Greater Invisibility	Illu	1A	Touch	VS	Ⓒ 1 min	—
5th Level							
●	Audit the False ®	Div	10 min	Touch	VSM	Inst.	—
●	Wall of Force	Evoc	1A	120 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 10 min	—
6th Level							
●	Chain Lightning	Evoc	1A	150 ft.	VSM	Inst.	DEX save
●	Contingency	Evoc	10 min	Self	VSM	10 day	—
●	Globe of Invulnerability	Abj	1A	Self	VSM	Ⓒ 1 min	—

◆ always prepared ● prepared ○ in spellbook / known, not prepared ® ritual Ⓒ concentration · 1A action, 1BA bonus action, 1R reaction

Arcane Recovery: once per day after a short rest, recover slots totalling 6 levels (none 6th+). Fine Print (◆) is always prepared by Runic Drafting. Prepare 17 spells after a long rest.



CHARACTER NAME
Orren Fenwick

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Wizard 12	School of Infernal Contracts	Human
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Former infernal archivist	Neutral	

IV · Backstory



Appearance

AGE	HEIGHT
47	5'10"
WEIGHT	**EYES**
150 lb.	Blue
HAIR	**SKIN**
Brown, untidy, with a short beard	Pale, ink-stained
GENDER	**FAITH**
Male	None he will admit to

A rumpled human wizard in a deep-blue archivist's coat, spectacles on a chain and a blackwood gavel at his belt.

Personality Traits

I index everything, including my friends' grievances.

I apologise to documents when I tear them.

Ideal

Accountability. A system is only as good as the archivist willing to burn the bad parts.

Bond

My registry made the Red Clause possible. I will see it unmade.

Flaw

I would rather be right in private than useful in public.

Allies & Organizations

The Brass Arbiter (on probation); defectors from the Asmodeun Scriptorium; Waterdeep's surviving debtors.

Your Role

The Archivist. You know Hell's paperwork from the inside, because you designed much of it. You find the forgery, break the ward, and end the battle with one decisive spell.

Backstory

For twenty years Orren Fenwick served the **Asmodeun Scriptorium**, and he was the finest archivist it had. He built the index that let the Ninth Court's clerks find any soul-contract by name, date or default in under a minute. He was proud of it. Order, he believed, was a kindness.

Then someone used his registry to build the Red Clause. His categories, his cross-references and his tidy blank fields became the machine that turned charity into harvest. During a Scriptorium audit he opened a Hearthlight form and found his own handwriting in the template.

He defected the week the Brass Arbiter took the case. He testified, surrendered his notebooks and was placed on probation, bound to carry a small brass gavel he may never raise in anger. Every night since, he has worked to unmake what he made.

Why You Entered

You want false-title registration destroyed: the trick of claiming a soul by inventing a legal category for it. You built that tool. Only a ruler of Avernus can outlaw it, so you will see that the next ruler does.



CHARACTER NAME
Orren Fenwick

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Wizard 12	School of Infernal Contracts	Human
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Former infernal archivist	Neutral	

V · Claim & Connections

How It Began

Midwinter in Waterdeep. Snow on the courthouse steps, and inside, the Brass Arbiter's verdict fell like a portcullis. The Hearthlight Foundation's charity had been a harvest of souls from the first signature. The Red Clause was void. The ruling, **Precedent H-25**, held that Hell may enforce a true bargain but may never forge consent.

Six strangers stood in that courtroom. Two testified to how the fraud was built. One kept the doors. One pressed her seal into the verdict. The last two had crossed the planes to beg help for a village Hell had swallowed, and were sent away with nothing.

That night each of them found a red envelope sealed with nine black thorns. Asmodeus had opened the throne of Avernus to any claimant who could prove Survival, Deviousness and Dominion under a Charter written for all to read. Six claimants, six reasons to sign, and each of them already knows too much about the others.

Your Claim

If you rule alone, you will abolish false-title registration and open every registry in Avernus to inspection. **If the party shares the crown,** you are its public legal architect. **If you back someone else,** you present the case of the surviving Waterdeep debtors.

Under the Charter you may claim alone, as one of a declared joint slate, or as the open representative of a patron.

The Other Claimants

Aurelia Quill. She damned you in open court, and she was right. You want her forgiveness. You know she should not give it yet.

Dame Caldris Vowborne. She guarded you for nine days during the hearing. She never once asked why you defected.

Sister Nema Copperwrit. Her monastery's plague bargain sits in your registry: contract 41-B. It is lawful and valid, and it is paid by people who never signed. You have not told her you know.

Varka Blackseal. Greyhurst's names went into the machinery of Avernus. You suspect you know which index holds them.

Ilyra Ashroot. Her bark-ledger is the only honest registry you have ever seen. She was right to refuse you.

Your Private Pressure

Your DM has one more note for you: the private pressure that will test your claim. Keep it to yourself until it matters.

Playing Orren

- Control the field: *wall of force*, *globe of invulnerability*, *counterspell*.
- Place a Contract Sigil on an ally (bonus action) for a once-per-turn boost to damage or a save.
- Your Gavel of Appeal grants advantage in a hearing once per hearing.



CHARACTER NAME
Dame Caldris Vowborne

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Paladin 12	Oath of the Infernal Lord	Dragonborn
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Veteran oathkeeper	Lawful Neutral	

I · Core

STRENGTH	DEXTERITY	CONSTITUTION	INTELLIGENCE	WISDOM	CHARISMA
+5	+0	+3	−1	+0	+4
20	10	16	8	10	18

+4 PROFICIENCY BONUS

☐ HEROIC INSPIRATION

SAVING THROWS

- ○ +9 Strength
- ○ +4 Dexterity
- ○ +7 Constitution
- ○ +3 Intelligence
- ● +8 Wisdom
- ● +12 Charisma

+4 Aura of Protection (you and allies within 10 ft.).

SKILLS

- ○ +0 Acrobatics DEX
- ○ +0 Animal Handling WIS
- ○ −1 Arcana INT
- ● +9 Athletics STR
- ○ +4 Deception CHA
- ○ −1 History INT
- ● +4 Insight WIS
- ● +8 Intimidation CHA
- ○ −1 Investigation INT
- ○ +0 Medicine WIS
- ○ −1 Nature INT
- ○ +0 Perception WIS
- ○ +4 Performance CHA
- ● +8 Persuasion CHA
- ○ −1 Religion INT
- ○ +0 Sleight of Hand DEX
- ○ +0 Stealth DEX
- ○ +0 Survival WIS

● *proficient* ◆ *expertise*

PASSIVE SENSES

10	Perception
14	Insight
9	Investigation

Divine Sense

22	+0	30 FT.
ARMOR CLASS	INITIATIVE	SPEED

Plate 18 + Shield +1 (3) + Defence 1

MAX HP	CURRENT HP	TEMP HP
112		

HIT DICE	DEATH SAVES
12D10	Successes ○○○ Failures ○○○

DEFENSES

Resistance: fire (Draconic Ancestry); immune to disease; allies within 10 ft. can't be frightened

WEAPON ATTACKS & CANTRIPS

Name	Hit / DC	Damage / Type	Notes
Longsword +1	+10	1d8 +6 slashing	+1d8 radiant (Improved Smite)

ON YOUR TURN

Action Attack ×2 (longsword +10, 1d8 + 6 + 1d8 radiant), cast a spell, Lay on Hands (60 HP), breath weapon (fire)

Bonus —

Reaction Channel Divinity: Fiendish Rebuke; opportunity attack

PROFICIENCIES & LANGUAGES

Armor All armour, shields

Weapons Simple and martial weapons

Tools —

Languages Common, Draconic, Infernal

CONDITIONS & NOTES



CHARACTER NAME
Dame Caldris Vowborne

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Paladin 12	Oath of the Infernal Lord	Dragonborn
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Veteran oathkeeper	Lawful Neutral	

II · Features & Equipment

Features & Traits

Class & Subclass Features

Tenets of the Infernal Lord
Tenets of the Infernal Lord Dominion through Fear. Inspire dread; enforce Asmodeus's law without mercy. Unbreakable Contract. Every bargain must be honoured—breaking a pact is a fate worse than death. Temptation's Grace.

Channel Divinity: Fiendish Rebuke
Fiendish Rebuke. When you or a creature you can see within 10 feet of you takes damage from an attacker you can see within 60 feet, you can use your reaction to present your holy symbol and unleash a bolt of hellfire.

Channel Divinity: Fiendish Binding
Fiendish Binding. As an action, you present your holy symbol and speak an infernal phrase of binding. One creature you can see within 30 feet must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw or be restrained by crackling infernal chains for...

Aura of Contract
You and friendly creatures within 10 feet of you have resistance to fire damage. In addition, a creature restrained by your Fiendish Binding cannot teleport, cannot be moved by teleportation or planar travel effects, and cannot...

Divine Sense
The presence of strong evil registers on your senses like a noxious odor, and powerful good rings like heavenly music in your ears. As an action, you can open your awareness to detect such forces. 5/long rest ☐☐☐☐☐

Lay on Hands
Your blessed touch can heal wounds. You have a pool of healing power that replenishes when you take a long rest. With that pool, you can restore a total number of hit points equal to your paladin level × 5. 60/long rest ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Divine Smite
Starting at 2nd level, when you hit a creature with a melee weapon attack, you can expend one spell slot to deal radiant damage to the target, in addition to the weapon's damage.

Divine Health
By 3rd level, the divine magic flowing through you makes you immune to disease.

Extra Attack
You can attack twice, instead of once, whenever you take the Attack action on your turn.

Aura of Protection
Starting at 6th level, whenever you or a friendly creature within 10 feet of you must make a saving throw, the creature gains a bonus to the saving throw equal to your Charisma modifier (with a minimum bonus of +1).

Aura of Courage
Starting at 10th level, you and friendly creatures within 10 feet of you can't be frightened while you are conscious. At 18th level, the range of this aura increases to 30 feet.

Improved Divine Smite
By 11th level, you are so suffused with righteous might that all your melee weapon strikes carry divine power with them. Whenever you hit a creature with a melee weapon, the creature takes an extra 1d8 radiant damage.

Defense
While you are wearing armor, you gain a +1 bonus to AC

Species Features

Breath Weapon - Red
You can use your action to exhale destructive energy. Your draconic ancestry determines the size, shape, and damage type of the exhalation. 1/short rest ☐

Attuned Magic Items (3 slots)

- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

Other Magic Items & Potions

- ☐ **Longsword +1**
  You have a +1 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with this magic weapon.
- ☐ **Shield +1**
  While holding this shield, you have a bonus to AC of +1. This bonus is in addition to the shield's normal bonus to AC.
- ☐ **Receipt of the Last Gift**
  A fragment of Form H-25 from Waterdeep, signed by the independent Brass Arbiter. As an action, display it to create a 10-foot-radius field that grants advantage on...
- ☐ **Potion of Greater Healing** ×2
  The potion's red liquid glimmers when agitated. You regain 4d4+4 hit points when you drink this potion.

Equipment

Item	Qty	Weight
Plate Armor *(equipped)*	1	65 lb.
Backpack	1	5 lb.
Bedroll	1	7 lb.
Parchment	1	0 lb.

Carried: 87.2 lb. · Capacity 300 lb.

Coins

CP	SP	EP	GP	PP
0	30	0	250	5



CHARACTER NAME
Dame Caldris Vowborne

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Paladin 12	Oath of the Infernal Lord	Dragonborn
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Veteran oathkeeper	Lawful Neutral	

CHARISMA	16	+8	1st ○○○○ 2nd ○○○ 3rd ○○○
SPELLCASTING ABILITY	SPELL SAVE DC	SPELL ATTACK	SPELL SLOTS (TICK WHEN SPENT)

Spells

	Spell	School	Time	Range	Comp.	Duration	Save / Atk
1st Level							
●	Bless	Ench	1A	30 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 1 min	—
●	Command	Ench	1A	60 ft.	V	1 rnd	WIS save
●	Cure Wounds	Evoc	1A	Touch	VS	Inst.	Heal
◆	Hellish Rebuke	Evoc	1R	60 ft.	VS	Inst.	DEX save
●	Protection from Evil and Good	Abj	1A	Touch	VSM	Ⓒ 10 min	—
◆	Seal of the First Pact	Ench	1A	30 ft.	VSM	24 hr	—
2nd Level							
●	Aid	Abj	1A	30 ft.	VSM	8 hr	Heal
●	Find Steed	Conj	10 min	30 ft.	VS	Inst.	—
●	Lesser Restoration	Abj	1A	Touch	VS	Inst.	—
◆	Quill of Binding ®	Conj	1A	Self	VSM	Ⓒ 1 hr	—
◆	Zone of Truth	Ench	1A	60 ft.	VS	10 min	CHA save
3rd Level							
◆	Devil's Due	Necr	1A	60 ft.	VSM	Inst.	CHA save
●	Dispel Magic	Abj	1A	120 ft.	VS	Inst.	—
◆	Magic Circle	Abj	1 min	10 ft.	VSM	@item.level - 2 hr	CHA save
●	Revivify	Necr	1A	Touch	VSM	Inst.	Heal
●	Writ of Safe Passage ®	Abj	10 min	Touch	VSM	1 hr	—

◆ *always prepared* ● *prepared* ○ *in spellbook / known, not prepared* ® *ritual* Ⓒ *concentration · 1A action, 1BA bonus action, 1R reaction*

Oath spells (◆) are always prepared. Prepare 10 more.

Divine Smite: *expend a slot on a hit for 2d8 radiant (+1d8 per slot above 1st, +1d8 vs fiends and undead).*



CHARACTER NAME
Dame Caldris Vowborne

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Paladin 12	Oath of the Infernal Lord	Dragonborn
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Veteran oathkeeper	Lawful Neutral	

IV · Backstory



Appearance

AGE	HEIGHT
58	6'6"
WEIGHT	**EYES**
300 lb.	Amber
HAIR	**SKIN**
None (blue scales)	Blue-grey scales
GENDER	**FAITH**
Female	The Oath of the Infernal Lord

A towering blue dragonborn in plate with a crimson tabard, a +1 longsword and a scorched oath-scroll on her shield.

Personality Traits

I recite the clause I am enforcing before I draw my sword.

I refuse any reward I did not earn under the rules.

Ideal

Order. The strictest code is the only one that can bind the strong.

Bond

A sealed promise I made under pressure. I have never opened it.

Flaw

I may obey Asmodeus even when obedience and justice part ways.

Allies & Organizations

Old comrades of the Ninth Court's honour guard; any court that keeps its own rules.

Your Role

The Judge. You hold the line in battle and hold officials to the law. Your aura shields the party, your word carries weight before any tribunal, and no unlawful seizure happens in your sight.

Backstory

Young and certain, Dame Caldris Vowborne swore the **Oath of the Infernal Lord**, Asmodeus's own code. She believed the hardest law in the multiverse would forge the truest servant of justice. Forty years on, she is as hard as that law. She is far less certain it is just.

She has led relief columns along the burning edges of the Blood War. On the night Greyhurst fell she stood at the planar wound with two hundred soldiers and orders to hold position. She held. Afterwards she laid down her command and swore herself to the Brass Arbiter as a bailiff. It was the one court in the planes she had seen convict the powerful.

Through the Red Clause hearing she kept the doors. She guarded the defector Orren Fenwick and shielded the disgraced Aurelia Quill from a mob. She also carries a sealed record of a promise made under duress, and she has never broken the seal.

Why You Entered

You believe law chains Hell better than any blade, but only if the officials wear the chains too. For the first time, Asmodeus has bound his own succession to a public Charter. You will see it honoured to the letter, and then you will rule by it.



CHARACTER NAME

Dame Caldris Vowborne

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Paladin 12	Oath of the Infernal Lord	Dragonborn
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Veteran oathkeeper	Lawful Neutral	

V · Claim & Connections

How It Began

Midwinter in Waterdeep. Snow on the courthouse steps, and inside, the Brass Arbiter's verdict fell like a portcullis. The Hearthlight Foundation's charity had been a harvest of souls from the first signature. The Red Clause was void. The ruling, **Precedent H-25**, held that Hell may enforce a true bargain but may never forge consent.

Six strangers stood in that courtroom. Two testified to how the fraud was built. One kept the doors. One pressed her seal into the verdict. The last two had crossed the planes to beg help for a village Hell had swallowed, and were sent away with nothing.

That night each of them found a red envelope sealed with nine black thorns. Asmodeus had opened the throne of Avernus to any claimant who could prove Survival, Deviousness and Dominion under a Charter written for all to read. Six claimants, six reasons to sign, and each of them already knows too much about the others.

Your Claim

If you rule alone, you will be a lawful and severe regent who holds every official, yourself included, to the Charter. **If the party shares the crown,** you are its military judge and captain of the watch. **If you back someone else,** you openly represent Zariel, Bel or an independent order, and say so.

Under the Charter you may claim alone, as one of a declared joint slate, or as the open representative of a patron.

The Other Claimants

Varka Blackseal. She scouted for you the night Greyhurst fell. She knows nothing of your bargain, and you fear she would understand it too well.

Ilyra Ashroot. You planted a tree in her grove for a soldier who died holding your line. You have never told her his name.

Orren Fenwick. You guarded him for nine days. He talks in his sleep, and every word is an apology.

Aurelia Quill. You held a doorway for her once. She thanked you as if signing a receipt, and you liked her for it.

Sister Nema Copperwrit. The only other claimant sworn to an oath she cannot break. Her word is iron to you.

Your Private Pressure

Your DM has one more note for you: the private pressure that will test your claim. Keep it to yourself until it matters.

Playing Caldris

- Your Aura of Protection adds +4 to everyone's saves within 10 feet. Stay close.
- Every hit adds 1d8 radiant; smite on confirmed priority hits.
- Channel Divinity: Fiendish Rebuke (reaction) or Fiendish Binding (restrain a foe).



CHARACTER NAME
SISTER NEMA COPPERWRIT

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Cleric 12	Contract Domain	Hill Dwarf
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Temple notary and advocate	Lawful Good	

I · CORE

STRENGTH +0 (10)
DEXTERITY +1 (12)
CONSTITUTION +3 (16)
INTELLIGENCE +1 (12)
WISDOM +5 (20)
CHARISMA +0 (10)

+4 PROFICIENCY BONUS

☐ HEROIC INSPIRATION

SAVING THROWS

- ○ +0 Strength
- ○ +1 Dexterity
- ○ +3 Constitution
- ○ +1 Intelligence
- ● +9 Wisdom
- ● +4 Charisma

Advantage vs poison (Dwarven Resilience).

SKILLS

- ○ +1 Acrobatics DEX
- ○ +5 Animal Handling WIS
- ○ +1 Arcana INT
- ○ +0 Athletics STR
- ○ +0 Deception CHA
- ○ +1 History INT
- ● +9 Insight WIS
- ○ +0 Intimidation CHA
- ○ +1 Investigation INT
- ● +9 Medicine WIS
- ○ +1 Nature INT
- ○ +5 Perception WIS
- ○ +0 Performance CHA
- ● +4 Persuasion CHA
- ● +5 Religion INT
- ○ +1 Sleight of Hand DEX
- ○ +1 Stealth DEX
- ○ +5 Survival WIS

● *proficient* ◆ *expertise*

PASSIVE SENSES

15	Perception
19	Insight
11	Investigation

Darkvision 60 ft.

18 ARMOR CLASS
+1 INITIATIVE
25 FT. SPEED

Scale mail 14 + Dex 1 + Shield +1 (3) · not reduced by heavy armour

MAX HP	CURRENT HP	TEMP HP
111		

HIT DICE: 12D8

DEATH SAVES: Successes ○○○ Failures ○○○

DEFENSES

Resistance: poison

WEAPON ATTACKS & CANTRIPS

NAME	HIT / DC	DAMAGE / TYPE	NOTES
Sacred Flame	DC 17 Dex	3d8 radiant	60 ft., no cover bonus

ON YOUR TURN

ACTION Cast a spell, Channel Divinity (Writ of Compulsion, Infernal Audit, Turn Undead; 2/rest)

BONUS *Healing word*, *spiritual weapon*; Notary of the Nine: offer a Minor Term for temp HP

REACTION Opportunity attack

PROFICIENCIES & LANGUAGES

Armor Light, medium and heavy armour, shields

Weapons Simple weapons, battleaxe, handaxe, light hammer, warhammer

Tools Calligrapher's supplies

Languages Common, Dwarvish, Infernal, Celestial

CONDITIONS & NOTES



CHARACTER NAME
Sister Nema Copperwrit

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Cleric 12	Contract Domain	Hill Dwarf
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Temple notary and advocate	Lawful Good	

Features & Traits

Class & Subclass Features

Notary of the Nine
You can bind a creature to a small promise and make the promise bite. 5/long rest ☐☐☐☐☐
As a bonus action, you offer a Minor Term to a creature within 30 feet that can hear and understand you: a single, clearly stated action it must take, or must...

Channel Divinity: Writ of Compulsion
As an action, you present your holy symbol and read a clause into the air. One creature within 30 feet that can hear you must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw or be bound by the writ for 1 minute.

Channel Divinity: Infernal Audit
As an action, you open Hell's books on the world around you. For 1 minute, you know the following about any creature you can see within 60 feet: whether it is bound by an oath, pact, curse, or contract;

Divine Strike: Hellfire Lien
Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you can cause the attack to deal an extra . When you reach 14th level, this increases to 2d8.

Channel Divinity: Turn Undead
As an action, you present your holy symbol and speak a prayer censuring the undead. Each undead that can see or hear you within 30 feet of you must make a Wisdom saving throw.

Destroy Undead
Starting at 5th level, when an undead fails its saving throw against your Turn Undead feature, the creature is instantly destroyed if its challenge rating is at or below a certain threshold, as shown in the table below.

Divine Intervention
Beginning at 10th level, you can call on your deity to intervene on your behalf when your need is great. Imploring your deity's aid requires you to use your action. Describe the assistance you seek, and roll percentile dice. 1/long rest ☐

Species Features

Dwarven Resilience
You have advantage on saving throws against poison, and you have resistance against poison damage.

Stonecunning
Whenever you make an Intelligence (History) check related to the origin of stonework, you are considered proficient in the History skill and add double your proficiency bonus to the check, instead of your normal proficiency bonus.

Attuned Magic Items (3 slots)

- ● **Marshal's Chain of Allegiance**
  When a willing creature within 30 feet explicitly accepts your command for a specific task of no more than 1 minute, you may link a spectral brass strand to it;
- ○
- ○

Other Magic Items & Potions

- ○ **Shield +1**
  While holding this shield, you have a bonus to AC of +1. This bonus is in addition to the shield's normal bonus to AC.
- ○ **Potion of Greater Healing** ×2
  The potion's red liquid glimmers when agitated. You regain 4d4+4 hit points when you drink this potion.

Equipment

Item	Qty	Weight
Scale Mail *(equipped)*	1	45 lb.
Amulet *(equipped)*	1	1 lb.
Healer's Kit	1	3 lb.
Sealing Wax	3	0 lb.
Backpack	1	5 lb.

Carried: 61.2 lb. · Capacity 150 lb.

Coins

CP	SP	EP	GP	PP
0	30	0	250	5



CHARACTER NAME
SISTER NEMA COPPERWRIT

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Cleric 12	Contract Domain	Hill Dwarf
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Temple notary and advocate	Lawful Good	

III · SPELLS

WISDOM	17	+9
SPELLCASTING ABILITY	SPELL SAVE DC	SPELL ATTACK

1ST ○○○○ 2ND ○○○ 3RD ○○○ 4TH ○○○ 5TH ○○ 6TH ○

SPELL SLOTS (TICK WHEN SPENT)

SPELLS

	Spell	School	Time	Range	Comp.	Duration	Save / Atk
Cantrips (at will)							
●	Guidance	Div	1A	Touch	VS	Ⓒ 1 min	—
●	Sacred Flame	Evoc	1A	60 ft.	VS	Inst.	DEX save
●	Spare the Dying	Necr	1A	Touch	VS	Inst.	Heal
●	Thaumaturgy	Trans	1A	30 ft.	V	1 min	—
●	Witness Mark	Div	1A	Touch	VS	1 hr	—
1st Level							
●	Bless	Ench	1A	30 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 1 min	—
◆	Command	Ench	1A	60 ft.	V	1 rnd	WIS save
●	Guiding Bolt	Evoc	1A	120 ft.	VS	1 rnd	+9 atk
●	Healing Word	Evoc	1BA	60 ft.	V	Inst.	Heal
◆	Seal of the First Pact	Ench	1A	30 ft.	VSM	24 hr	—
2nd Level							
●	Aid	Abj	1A	30 ft.	VSM	8 hr	Heal
●	Lesser Restoration	Abj	1A	Touch	VS	Inst.	—
◆	Quill of Binding ®	Conj	1A	Self	VSM	Ⓒ 1 hr	—
●	Spiritual Weapon	Evoc	1BA	60 ft.	VS	1 min	+9 atk
◆	Zone of Truth	Ench	1A	60 ft.	VS	10 min	CHA save
3rd Level							
◆	Devil's Due	Necr	1A	60 ft.	VSM	Inst.	CHA save
●	Dispel Magic	Abj	1A	120 ft.	VS	Inst.	—
◆	Magic Circle	Abj	1 min	10 ft.	VSM	@item.level - 2 hr	CHA save
●	Revivify	Necr	1A	Touch	VSM	Inst.	Heal
●	Spirit Guardians	Conj	1A	Self	VSM	Ⓒ 10 min	WIS save
4th Level							
◆	Banishment	Abj	1A	60 ft.	VSM	Ⓒ 1 min	CHA save
◆	Binding Clause ®	Abj	1 hr	Touch	VSM	Until dispelled	—
●	Death Ward	Abj	1A	Touch	VS	8 hr	—
●	Freedom of Movement	Abj	1A	Touch	VSM	1 hr	—
5th Level							
●	Flame Strike	Evoc	1A	60 ft.	VSM	Inst.	DEX save
◆	Geas	Ench	1 min	60 ft.	V	30 day	WIS save
●	Greater Restoration	Abj	1A	Touch	VSM	Inst.	—
◆	Soul Covenant	Ench	1 min	15 ft.	VSM	Perm.	—
6th Level							
●	Heal	Evoc	1A	60 ft.	VS	Inst.	Heal

◆ always prepared ● prepared ○ in spellbook / known, not prepared ® ritual Ⓒ concentration · 1A action, 1BA bonus action, 1R reaction

Domain spells (◆) are always prepared. Prepare 17 more after a long rest.

Divine Intervention: *12%.*



CHARACTER NAME
SISTER NEMA COPPERWRIT

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Cleric 12	Contract Domain	Hill Dwarf
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Temple notary and advocate	Lawful Good	

IV · BACKSTORY



APPEARANCE

AGE	HEIGHT
96	4'5"
WEIGHT	**EYES**
160 lb.	Hazel
HAIR	**SKIN**
Copper, braided into a bun, with a beard to match	Ruddy
GENDER	**FAITH**
Female	The Contract Domain (the god of witnessed promises)

A stout hill dwarf priest in scale mail with a notary's seal on a chain, a copper-red braid and beard.

PERSONALITY TRAITS

I can recite any contract I have witnessed.

I stamp my seal on my own lunch.

IDEAL

Restitution. Honour the signer, free those who never consented.

BOND

My monastery's bargain saved the novices and binds their children. I will settle it fairly.

FLAW

I believe a properly witnessed document can fix anything, and it cannot.

ALLIES & ORGANIZATIONS

The Monastery of the Copper Seal; temple notaries across the realms.

YOUR ROLE

The Witness. You keep the party standing with healing and wards, and you are the one person every faction agrees is honest. When you certify a thing, Avernus believes it.

BACKSTORY

Sister Nema Copperwrit is a temple notary of the **Contract Domain**, sworn to the mountain monastery of Saint Ostra, whose vaults hold six hundred years of records. She can recite most of them from memory. She has witnessed thousands of marriages, apprenticeships, debts and deathbed wills, and never once set her seal to a lie. Every court in three kingdoms knows it.

So the Brass Arbiter summoned her to Waterdeep. She took down every word of the Red Clause testimony and pressed her seal into the final verdict. Precedent H-25 bears her name in its margin.

She also carries a debt she never signed. Two generations ago, plague climbed the mountain to Saint Ostra, and the abbot struck an infernal bargain to save the novices. The bargain was honest, and the novices lived. Their children, and their children's children, still pay a tithe of years from their lives every winter. None of them signed. All of them are bound.

WHY YOU ENTERED

You do not ask Hell to be good. You ask it to stop hiding cruelty behind lawful paper. The throne of Avernus is an office, and for once its holder can be called to account. You intend to be in the room when that account is written.



CHARACTER NAME

Sister Nema Copperwrit

CLASS & LEVEL	SUBCLASS	SPECIES
Cleric 12	Contract Domain	Hill Dwarf
BACKGROUND	**ALIGNMENT**	**PLAYER**
Temple notary and advocate	Lawful Good	

V · Claim & Connections

How It Began

Midwinter in Waterdeep. Snow on the courthouse steps, and inside, the Brass Arbiter's verdict fell like a portcullis. The Hearthlight Foundation's charity had been a harvest of souls from the first signature. The Red Clause was void. The ruling, **Precedent H-25**, held that Hell may enforce a true bargain but may never forge consent.

Six strangers stood in that courtroom. Two testified to how the fraud was built. One kept the doors. One pressed her seal into the verdict. The last two had crossed the planes to beg help for a village Hell had swallowed, and were sent away with nothing.

That night each of them found a red envelope sealed with nine black thorns. Asmodeus had opened the throne of Avernus to any claimant who could prove Survival, Deviousness and Dominion under a Charter written for all to read. Six claimants, six reasons to sign, and each of them already knows too much about the others.

Your Claim

If you rule alone, you will proclaim a Charter of Protected Persons: no one bound by a contract they never signed. **If the party shares the crown,** you are its independent moral auditor. **If you back someone else,** you sponsor a pact-bound order of guardians to watch over the new ruler.

Under the Charter you may claim alone, as one of a declared joint slate, or as the open representative of a patron.

The Other Claimants

Aurelia Quill. You recorded her confession. She was braver than she knows, and harsher on herself than any law requires.

Varka Blackseal. She carried three of your novices out of a collapsing rift. You owe her a debt you have chosen never to settle, so that it always stands.

Orren Fenwick. He built a cage and now begs to break it. You will believe him when he confesses all of it.

Dame Caldris Vowborne. Her oath is to Asmodeus and yours is to the truth. They have never yet collided. You pray they never will.

Ilyra Ashroot. She says every bargain must have a season of ending. Your monastery's has none. She may be the answer you have prayed for.

Your Private Pressure

Your DM has one more note for you: the private pressure that will test your claim. Keep it to yourself until it matters.

Playing Nema

- *Spirit guardians* in close fights; *healing word* to bring the fallen back up.
- Notary of the Nine: offer a Minor Term for temporary hit points (bonus action).
- Channel Divinity: Writ of Compulsion forbids one action; Infernal Audit declares a foe In Arrears.

8. Six Pregenerated Level-12 Claimants

These six ready-to-run characters enter the First Crown competition at level 12. They are compatible with a 2014-style D&D 5e table; the three new subclasses are defined in this book, while the wizard, paladin and cleric use the existing Asmodeun Scriptorium subclass descriptions in The Night of the Red Clause (Appendix G). Their quick combat instructions are sufficient for an opening session, but use the full subclass text for exact spell access, prepared features and later advancement. All six have proficiency bonus +4. Their hit points assume average fixed increases after level 1; no item bonuses have been silently included. All are independent people; none starts pledged to sell a soul. Each has a reason to seek the throne alone or alongside the others.

Character creation standard. Each sheet below is a fixed, table-ready build rather than a promise of strict point-buy optimisation. Where racial background options differ between 2014 and 2024, use the listed final scores and do not double-add bonuses. Each character has a rare item, one uncommon or consumable reward, a visible personal ambition and a secret they may choose to disclose. Items with attunement are marked. Substitute comparable magic items if your table has its own allocation policy. In 2024, use 2024 base-class features and the conversion notes in Section 9.

How It Began

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Shared party introductions

Start the campaign by having each player answer two questions: *What would you change about Avernus if you actually held the First Crown?* and *Which personal principle would you refuse to trade, even to win?* The six claimants already know one another from the Brass Arbiter's courtroom. Read your *Other Claimants* notes aloud to each other, or keep them to yourself and let the table discover them. No one begins required to betray another player. If the claimants prefer separate claims, they can still travel as an alliance until final registration.

Chapter 3

CHARACTER OPTIONS



2. Warlock: The Ruby Court



The Ruby Court

Otherworldly Patron (Warlock)

Otherworldly Patron. Warlocks of the Ruby Court bargain for the authority to witness, suspend and enforce specific promises. They may work for Asmodeus, copy his methods without loyalty, or use Hell's law against Hell itself. Their magic cannot conjure soul ownership from an enemy who has not agreed to it.

Expanded Spell List. 1st *command, sanctuary*; 2nd *zone of truth, hold person*; 3rd *counterspell, sending*; 4th *banishment, freedom of movement*; 5th *geas, wall of force*. These are options on the warlock spell list, not extra known spells (2024 tables may treat them as always prepared).

2024 play. Grant the 1st-level feature at level 3 with the expanded spells; later levels unchanged.

Design ceiling. Short-lived attack/save support, one optional control ultimate, no automatic mind control, no extra spell slots and no involuntary soul transfer.

Clause of Mutual Aid (Warlock 1)

You learn Infernal and gain proficiency in Investigation or Persuasion.

As a bonus action, you may offer one willing creature you can see within 30 feet a **Minor Term**: a feasible, clearly stated action to perform or avoid before the start of your next turn. The creature knows the entire effect and may refuse without consequence. While it accepts and abides by the Term, once before it expires the creature may add 1d6 to one attack roll, saving throw or ability check after rolling but before the outcome is announced. If it knowingly breaks the Term, the unused die disappears; there is no involuntary soul loss or damage.

You may offer terms a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus per long rest; only one of your terms may be active at a time. This is neither concentration nor a spell.

Consideration Received (Warlock 6)

When a hostile creature that has separately accepted a Minor Term from you knowingly breaks it within 60 feet, you can use a reaction to deal 9 (2d8) psychic damage and gain temporary hit points equal to your Charisma modifier plus your proficiency bonus. You may use this reaction a number of times equal to your Charisma modifier (minimum once) per long rest, and no creature can trigger it more than once per long rest. Friendly characters never trigger this damage through playful self-default.

In addition, you have advantage on ability checks to locate a deliberate contradiction in an authentic written agreement you have been allowed to inspect for 10 minutes; this does not substitute for the evidence needed to win a hearing.

Reserved Rights (Warlock 10)

You gain resistance to psychic damage and advantage on saves against being charmed or frightened by fiends.

Once per long rest, when you fail a saving throw against a spell or magical effect, you may use your reaction to reroll it. You must use the second result. The reroll is a timely objection, not retrospective refusal of an already completed lawful bargain.

Final Notice (Warlock 14)

As an action, choose a creature within 60 feet that can hear or see you. It makes a Charisma saving throw against your warlock spell save DC. On a failure, it takes 33 (6d10) psychic damage and is *restrained* in spectral filing chains for up to 1 minute. It repeats the save at the end of each turn, ending the restraint on a success. On a success, it takes half damage and is not restrained.

If the target is currently bound by a genuinely accepted Minor Term from you and knowingly breached it, the initial damage increases by 2d10. Once used, this feature cannot be used again until a long rest. This is a magical attack, not a contract granting your patron title to a soul.

3. Barbarian: Path of the Blood-Price



Path of the Blood-Price

Primal Path (Barbarian)

Primal Path (3rd, 6th, 10th and 14th level, for 2014 and 2024 timing). These warriors swear measurable combat vows and draw power from the peril of keeping them. A Blood-Price barbarian might defend innocent people out of fierce devotion or serve Asmodeus as an honour-bound executioner.

Design ceiling. Rage Covenant's extra damage resembles established barbarian bonus-damage subclasses; reaction defence trades personal hit points and an action-economy slot for protection. The oath's penalty is limited and disclosed.

Rage Covenant (Barbarian 3)

When you enter a Rage, speak one **Battle Vow** whose condition you can reasonably fulfil: protect a named willing ally within 30 feet, hold a location you can see, or engage a declared enemy without deliberately fleeing. The vow lasts until your Rage ends.

On each of your turns while raging, if you have not knowingly broken it, the first creature you hit with a Strength-based melee weapon attack takes an extra 1d6 necrotic or fire damage (your choice when you vow). This increases to 1d8 at barbarian level 10. If you knowingly break the vow, you lose this extra damage until you start a new Rage; your Rage itself does not end. The vow does not magically force your actions or bind any ally's soul.

Collateral Guardian (Barbarian 6)

While raging, when a willing ally within 5 feet is damaged by an attack, you can use your reaction to reduce the damage by 1d10 + your Constitution modifier + your Rage Damage bonus. You take psychic damage equal to half the damage prevented, rounded down; Rage resistance can't reduce it. You may use this feature a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus per long rest. The ally knows you are assuming the cost and may decline.

Witness to the Oath (Barbarian 10)

When you begin Rage Covenant, you may designate one willing ally within 30 feet as a **Witness**. While your Rage lasts and you are conscious, that ally has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

Once during each Rage, when the Witness misses an attack against the foe named by your Battle Vow, the Witness may add your Rage Damage bonus to the attack roll, potentially turning the miss into a hit. The Witness can't gain this benefit while incapacitated, and may withdraw at any time.

The Price Comes Due (Barbarian 14)

While raging, when a hostile creature within 30 feet damages your designated Witness or an ally named by your Battle Vow, you may use your reaction to move up to half your speed toward that enemy without provoking opportunity attacks and make one melee weapon attack against it, provided it comes within reach. On a hit, deal an extra 9 (2d8) necrotic damage.

You may use this feature a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus per long rest. You cannot use it during the same reaction as Collateral Guardian.

4. Druid: Circle of Ashen Covenants



Circle of Ashen Covenants

Druid Circle

Druid Circle (2nd, 6th, 10th and 14th level; 2024 druids gain the 2nd-level features at 3rd).

The Circle teaches that every harvest carries a debt, every flame nourishes ash, and every oath must have a season in which it ends. Some druids venerate Asmodeus as an embodiment of cosmic exchange. Others study his contracts precisely to keep natural communities out of them.

Design ceiling. The spirit's attack requires a bonus action and does not combine with repeated Wild Shape strikes; the reactive mitigation competes for the same reaction; the capstone uses concentration.

Witness of the Grove (Druid 2)

You gain proficiency in Insight or Nature, and learn Infernal or Sylvan.

As a 1-minute rite, you may place an **Ashen Accord** on one willing creature you touch. It lasts until your next long rest, until dismissed by either party (no action), or until another Ashen Accord replaces it. While within 60 feet of you, when the bearer takes damage you may use your reaction to reduce the damage by 1d8 + your Wisdom modifier and grant the bearer temporary hit points equal to your proficiency bonus. You may use the reduction a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus per long rest; no creature is compelled to accept it.

Ash Warden Spirit (Druid 2)

As a bonus action you can expend one use of Wild Shape to manifest an **Ash Warden Spirit** in an unoccupied space within 30 feet for 10 minutes.

Ash Warden Spirit. Small Elemental; AC 13 + your proficiency bonus; HP 5 + five times your druid level; speed 30 ft., fly 20 ft. (hover); resistance to fire; immune to the poisoned condition; attack bonus equal to your spell attack modifier. It acts on your initiative immediately after your turn. It can move and Dodge freely; if you spend a bonus action to command it, it instead moves and makes one **Ashen Touch** attack (1d8 + your proficiency bonus fire damage; 2d8 + PB from druid level 10), Helps, or Dashes. It can't cast spells, carry large objects or make opportunity attacks. It vanishes at 0 HP, when dismissed, or when the duration expires. You can't have more than one.

Ashen Forms (Druid 2)

When you use Wild Shape, you can transform into a fiend from the **Ashen Forms** list instead of a beast. The Circle teaches the shapes of Hell's lesser servants so that its druids can walk among them, and turn them.

Challenge rating. Your Ashen Forms follow the Circle of the Moon's limits: challenge rating 1 or lower from 2nd level; from 6th level, up to your druid level divided by 3, rounded down (CR 2 at 6th, CR 3 at 9th, CR 4 at 12th, CR 5 at 15th). A form with a flying speed needs druid level 8. Unlike the Circle of the Moon, assuming an Ashen Form still takes your action.

In fiend form. The normal Wild Shape rules apply. You gain the form's traits, including Magic Resistance, Devil's Sight and telepathy, but you can't use a Shapechanger trait, spellcasting, innate spells or any ability that summons or gates in other creatures. Devils and demons see you as one of their own kind until you give yourself away; that can be worth more in Avernus than any claw.

Other books. Forms marked with a book and page use that book's stat block. They are listed so a table that owns those books can use them; nothing here reproduces them. A table without them simply uses the other forms.

The Ashen Forms

Ashen Form	CR	Druid Level	Stat Block
Lemure	0	2	SRD (Foundry actor)
Manes	1/8	2	MM 60 (use your own copy)
Abyssal Wretch	1/4	2	MTF 136 (use your own copy)
Cinder Mite	1/4	2	This adventure (stat block in Book II)
Dretch	1/4	2	SRD (Foundry actor)
Nupperibo	1/2	2	MotM 196 / MTF 168 (use your own copy)
Tallyhound	1/2	2	This adventure (stat block in Book II)
Brass Gatewing	1	8	This adventure (stat block in Book II)
Imp	1	8	SRD (Foundry actor)
Maw Demon	1	2	MotM 176 / VGM 137 (use your own copy)
Quasit	1	2	SRD (Foundry actor)
Vargouille	1	8	MotM 251 / VGM 195 (use your own copy)

Ashen Form	CR	Druid level	Stat block
Rutterkin	2	6	MotM 210 / MTF 136 (use your own copy)
Spined Devil	2	8	MM 78 (use your own copy)
Stokeback	2	6	This adventure (stat block in Book II)
Barbed Toll-Warden	3	9	This adventure (stat block in Book II)
Bearded Devil	3	9	SRD (Foundry actor)
Hell Hound	3	9	SRD (Foundry actor)
Writ Hound	4	12	This adventure (stat block in Book II)
Ashen Hellwarden	5	Infernal Form (10th)	This adventure (stat block in Book II)
Barbed Devil	5	Infernal Form (10th)	SRD (Foundry actor)

Remedy of the Root (Druid 6)

When a creature you can see within 60 feet harms the bearer of your Ashen Accord, you can use your reaction to impose a −1d6 penalty on one attack roll that creature makes before the end of its next turn; the penalty must be declared before that roll. If you use this reaction, the Accord bearer may immediately move 5 feet without provoking opportunity attacks. You may use the reaction a number of times equal to your Wisdom modifier (minimum once) per long rest. It competes with Witness of the Grove for your reaction.

Covenant of Embers (Druid 10)

You gain resistance to fire damage. When your Ash Warden Spirit is within 30 feet of the bearer of your Ashen Accord, the bearer has advantage on saving throws against being frightened. When the spirit scores a critical hit, its target can't make opportunity attacks until the end of the target's next turn. Duplicate spirit bonuses don't stack.

Infernal Form (Druid 10)

You can expend two uses of Wild Shape at the same time to take an **Infernal Form**: a **Barbed Devil** or an **Ashen Hellwarden** (both CR 5). This works like the Circle of the Moon's Elemental Wild Shape. The Ash Warden Spirit draws on the same Wild Shape uses, so an Infernal Form and the spirit compete for the same pool.

Court of Returning Ash (Druid 14)

As an action, you raise a 30-foot-radius grove of black trees centred on yourself for up to 1 minute, as if concentrating on a spell. You may include or exclude any willing creatures you can see when you activate it.

For the duration, the first time each round that an included creature takes damage within the area, reduce that damage by 2d8. An enemy that starts its turn within the grove must make a Wisdom save against your spell save DC or have its speed halved until the start of its next turn. The grove is stationary and counts as difficult terrain for enemies; it ends if your concentration ends. Once used, you can't use this feature again until a long rest. It does not nullify valid signed agreements or compel an enemy to contract.

4A. Artificer: The Soulforged

In Foundry

Subclass, features and the twelve Construct Imprints are in *Player Options*; the two servitor frames are actors in *Soulforged Servitors*; the soul tables are in *The Soulforged*; Forms SF-01 and SF-12 are handouts. The *Generate a Soul* macro rolls a complete soul.

"I gave them bodies of iron, hearts of hellfire, and voices that will not shut up. I have created life. Unfortunately, life has opinions."

Among the infernal manufactories of Avernus, few artificers are as feared, coveted or morally controversial as the Soulforged. Where ordinary golemancers animate constructs with arcane formulae, a Soulforged artificer gives a mechanical body a conscious pilot: a mortal soul imprisoned in a soul coin.

These souls keep their memories, personalities, convictions, alignments, ambitions and voices. A once-proud paladin might inhabit a hulking iron guardian. A cowardly thief could wake inside a spider-legged reconnaissance construct. A bitter surgeon might discover that their new body has six mechanical arms and a deeply inconvenient number of scalpels.

The artificer builds the body, installs its infernal furnace and engraves a magical **Directive Binding**. The soul takes control of the machine's movement and senses, and while bound it must obey the artificer's explicit, achievable instructions. But compulsory obedience is not compulsory agreement. A construct may insult its creator, protest cruel orders, demand maintenance, argue strategy, or hold long philosophical discussions about the nature of personhood. Because every soul has a different history, two identical constructs can behave and fight in completely different ways.

Some artificers treat their creations as property. Others treat them as companions, employees, prisoners, or the beginnings of a new form of life. The question at the heart of the tradition is not whether the artificer *can* control a soul. It is whether they should.

✦ ✦ ✦

Primary role	Construct commander, support and battlefield control
Secondary role	Crafting, investigation, infernal engineering
Primary ability	Intelligence
Unique resources	Soul coins, Resonance Sparks, Engine Heat
Rules	A specialist for the 2014 artificer; use the same levels with the revised artificer

Progression

Artificer Level	Features
3rd	Soulforge Engineering, Infernal Servitor, Directive Binding, Soulforged Spells
5th	Soul-Etched Enchantments, Resonant Conduit
9th	Twin-Furnace Architecture, Coordinated Directive, Merciful Disconnect
15th	Dominion of the Forged, Sovereign Overclock

Soulforged Spells

You always have these spells prepared once you reach the listed artificer level. They count as artificer spells for you and don't count against the number of artificer spells you prepare.

Artificer Level	Spells
3rd	*command, sanctuary*
5th	*heat metal, warding bond*
9th	*dispel magic, revivify*
13th	*fabricate, summon construct*
17th	*creation, wall of force*

Command represents the tradition's power to impose magical directives. It does not establish legal ownership of a creature, and the Directive Binding works separately from it. (*Summon construct* is from *Tasha's Cauldron of Everything*; the module grants the other nine from the SRD automatically.)

Features

Soulforge Engineering (Artificer 3)

You gain proficiency with smith's tools; if you already have it, choose another set of artisan's tools. You learn to speak, read and write Infernal; if you already know it, learn another language of your choice. You can use smith's tools or tinker's tools as a spellcasting focus for your artificer spells.

Creating a construct. During a long rest you can build or rebuild one Infernal Servitor with smith's or tinker's tools and 50 gp of metal, components or salvage. Once built, the same frame can be repaired during later rests without paying again. It may look like any mechanical creature of its size: an armoured golem, a warforged-like assistant, a quadruped guardian, a skeletal or porcelain automaton, a spider-legged repair unit, a miniature war machine. Appearance never grants flight, swimming, extra attacks, extra manipulating limbs or other unlisted abilities. A servitor is a construct creature, not a warforged character, and gains no warforged traits.

Choosing a chassis. Each servitor uses one of two frames: the **Enforcer** (melee attacks, bodyguard duty, labour, area control) or the **Attendant** (healing support, repairs, reconnaissance, tools). During a long rest you can rebuild a frame into the other configuration at no cost, provided it hasn't been permanently lost.

Infernal Servitor (Artificer 3)

Your servitor has two possible operating states.

Soulbound. Its infernal furnace accepts one soul coin at a time. As an action within 5 feet of an inactive servitor, you insert a coin; the coin is consumed and its soul becomes the machine's conscious pilot. The coin's remaining charges set its fuel and Resonance Sparks: 1 charge gives 24 hours and 1 Spark, 2 charges 48 hours and 2 Sparks, 3 charges 72 hours and 3 Sparks. The soul keeps its personality, alignment, knowledge and memories, and gives the servitor the **Construct Imprint** of its Soul Archetype. A servitor houses one soul at a time and can't stack or swap Echoes. When the fuel runs out the soul is destroyed unless it is liberated first. Replacing a soul means stopping the furnace and liberating its occupant (or another established extraction method); a removed soul never makes a new coin.

Arcane Emergency Power. With no usable coin, you can expend an artificer spell slot as an action while touching the servitor. It runs for 1 hour per slot level. In this state it follows the normal command and chassis rules and keeps its frame attacks and support functions, but has no personality and can't use an Echo, Pulse or Awakened Inscription, gain Sparks or Overburn. Emergency power never creates a soul. It keeps the subclass playable without destroying anyone.

Shared limits. A servitor occupies a space and can be targeted like any creature. It can't attune to magic items, gains no equipment or infusion slots, and never takes an extra action because it has a soul. At 0 hit points it becomes inert; its furnace stays available for liberation for 1 hour unless the core is destroyed. Rebuilding a frame never restores fuel or Sparks, and a soul with no fuel can't animate even an intact body.

Directive Binding (Artificer 3)

To control a servitor you attune to its **Soulforge Control Harness**. This uses one of your ordinary attunement slots. The harness can't be sold, transferred or used on another artificer's construct without a separate feature or agreement. It counts toward your attunement limit but isn't a magic item for features that count magic items. Ending the attunement severs the binding, and the construct becomes inactive.

The binding. An attuned, Soulbound construct must obey your explicit, achievable instructions, given aloud or telepathically within 120 feet. It can't deliberately disobey an unambiguous instruction, sabotage the task, or invent an unreasonable reading to dodge it. It keeps its own mind, and may freely argue, criticise, complain about its body, ask for repairs, comfort, new duties or liberation, offer unsolicited advice, keep friendships and rivalries, remember its life, keep unrelated information to itself, and negotiate further agreements. The binding can compel truthful disclosure of specifically requested information the soul actually knows; it can't make the soul remember what it has forgotten.

Rights of an imprisoned soul. The binding gives mechanical control, not lawful title. You may own a machine with no legal claim over the person inside it, and a compelled order is never voluntary consent under the Championship's law. A soul may dispute its imprisonment even while it can't defy an explicit order. This matters when Misty's repossession men, the Brass Arbiter or the Articles on personhood come calling.

In combat. Your servitor shares your initiative and acts immediately after you. It can move and speak freely; without a command it takes the Dodge action. As a bonus action on your turn you can command one attuned servitor within 120 feet to take one action on its next turn: Attack, Dash, Disengage, Help, a chassis ability, Construct Overburn or a Construct Pulse, or an object interaction or tool task. It takes reactions only when its statistics allow. It follows standing orders outside combat without new commands. While you are incapacitated it can move to safety or continue an established noncombat task, but can't start commanded attacks or Pulses. A soul never gives you extra actions.

Soul-Etched Enchantments (Artificer 5)

Awakened Inscription. You can dedicate one additional attunement slot to a servitor you already control, so that construct uses two of your slots. While it does, the servitor gains the **Awakened Inscription** of its resident soul's archetype. A servitor can never hold more than one inscription. You can end the extra attunement during a short rest, removing the inscription without affecting the control link. Changing the soul means removing or liberating the old occupant; the new soul's imprint replaces the old one's.

Resonant Conduit (Artificer 5)

Once on each of your turns, when you deal damage with an artificer spell or one of your servitors deals damage, you can add 1d8 force damage to one damage roll. Alternatively, when your artificer spell restores hit points or your servitor uses Bolster or Field Repair, you can increase one target's healing or temporary hit points by 1d8. You choose only one of these benefits each turn. The die becomes 2d8 at 15th level. Resonant Conduit works with soul power or Arcane Emergency Power.

Twin-Furnace Architecture (Artificer 9)

You can maintain two Soulforged constructs. During a long rest you can build an **Auxiliary Servitor** in addition to your Primary Servitor. Each needs its own Control Harness attunement and its own fuel, and each can be an Enforcer or an Attendant. The Auxiliary has half the normal maximum hit points of its chassis (rounded up) but otherwise uses the same statistics, abilities, imprint and scaling. You can swap which is Primary during a long rest; recalculate their maximum hit points, keeping their current proportion as closely as possible.

Coordinated Directive (Artificer 9)

When you use your bonus action to command your servitors, you can command both with the same bonus action. Each can move and take one action, but between them they take at most **one offensive action** per round: an Attack, or a Construct Pulse that deals damage or grants an immediate attack. The other takes a support action (Bolster, Help, Field Repair, Triage, Dash, Disengage or a non-damaging Pulse), or both can support. One construct never takes two commanded actions because the other is absent. Each tracks its own Heat and Sparks, and only one servitor may use a reaction in the same round.

Merciful Disconnect (Artificer 9)

Once per long rest, as an action, you can perform an emergency liberation of the soul in a powered-down servitor within 5 feet: the normal DC 18 liberation check succeeds automatically. The construct becomes inert and loses all remaining fuel and Sparks. This frees the soul from the furnace but doesn't cancel any independently valid infernal contract that imprisoned it; the freed soul's fate follows the campaign's rules for liberated souls.

Dominion of the Forged (Artificer 15)

Your attuned servitors, Primary and Auxiliary, gain +1 AC, 10 additional maximum hit points, and telepathic communication with you across 1 mile while on the same plane. Your Resonant Conduit die becomes 2d8. (In Foundry, drag the *Dominion of the Forged* effect from this feature onto each servitor.)

Sovereign Overclock (Artificer 15)

Once per long rest, as a bonus action, you activate Sovereign Overclock for 1 minute. While it lasts, when you use Coordinated Directive both servitors may take offensive actions (an Attack or an offensive Pulse each), though neither takes more than one commanded action on its own turn. Once per round, when one servitor activates a Pulse, the other can reduce its own Heat by 1. The Overclock ends early if you are incapacitated or both servitors are inactive. It never creates Sparks, restores fuel or bypasses attunement.

Infernal Servitors

Both frames are Small or Medium constructs, immune to poison damage, exhaustion and the poisoned condition, with darkvision 60 feet, Infernal and the languages their soul knew in life. Their attacks count as magical.

	Enforcer	Attendant
AC	13 + PB	12 + PB
Hit points	5 + 5 × artificer level + Int mod	5 + 4 × artificer level + Int mod
Speed	30 ft.	30 ft., climb 20 ft.
Str/Dex/Con/Int/Wis/Cha	16/12/16/10/12/10	10/14/14/12/14/10
Saves	Dex +1 + PB, Con +3 + PB	Dex +2 + PB, Wis +2 + PB
Abilities	**Force Fist** (spell attack, reach 5 ft., 1d8 + PB force); **Interpose** (reaction: disadvantage on an attack against a creature within 5 ft.); **Industrial Strength**	**Arc Needle** (spell attack, 60 ft., 1d6 + PB lightning); **Bolster** (1d6 + PB temp HP, 10 ft.); **Field Repair** (2d8 + Int, PB uses per long rest across all servitors); **Triage**

The Soul Furnace in a Servitor

Every Soulbound construct uses the Soul Furnace's three resources: **fuel** (how long the soul can animate the body, set by the coin's charges), **Resonance Sparks** (power drawn from the soul's memories, spent on Pulses, never recharged by rest), and **Engine Heat** (instability from Pulses and Overburn).

Pulses. A Pulse needs the servitor's commanded action, spends 1 Spark and adds 1 Heat; one Pulse per servitor per round. With no Sparks left, the soul still pilots the body and gives its passive Echo until its fuel runs out or it is freed.

Heat. 0–2 stable. 3–4 strained: the flames change colour, gears shudder, and the soul complains. At 5, each Pulse or Overburn causes a construct mishap on a d6 roll of 1–2. At 6 the furnace ruptures: the servitor takes 3d10 fire damage that ignores resistance and immunity, suffers one construct mishap, and resets to Heat 3.

Cooling. A construct loses 1 Heat at the end of its turn if it neither Pulsed nor Overburned that round. A character within 5 feet can use an action and make a DC 15 Intelligence check with tinker's tools: success removes 2 Heat, failure 1.

Construct Overburn. When commanded, once on its turn, a servitor can gain 20 extra feet of movement or advantage on its next attack roll that turn. It takes 2d10 fire damage (ignoring resistance and immunity) and gains 1 Heat. Overburn needs no Sparks.

D6	Construct mishap	Effect
1	Servo Seizure	The servitor's speed becomes 0 until the end of its next turn.
2	Screaming Feedback	The artificer makes a DC 15 Wisdom save or takes −2 on their next attack roll or ability check.
3	Soulfire Leakage	The construct takes 2d10 fire damage, ignoring resistance and immunity.
4	Directive Jam	The construct can't Attack or activate Pulses until the end of its next turn.
5	Ghost Hands	The construct makes a DC 15 Dexterity save or moves up to half its speed toward something significant in the soul's memories, avoiding obviously lethal terrain.
6	Creditor's Beacon	A creditor registered against that soul learns the machine's location for 1 hour.

A mishap is an involuntary malfunction, not deliberate disobedience.

Handling coins. Identify Soul (action, DC 14 Intelligence (Arcana or Religion)) reveals the archetype, charges, attitude and any infernal seal. Questioning a soul uses the coin's normal Query and spends a charge; merely holding it gives an emotional impression for free. To liberate a soul from a furnace, stop the engine and make a DC 18 Intelligence (Arcana) or Wisdom (Religion) check as an action with a consecrated focus or suitable magic. Success frees the soul and ends its fuel, Echo, Pulses and Awakened Inscription; failure costs the action but no Spark or fuel.

Vehicles. A Soulforged artificer can't make a quad, hauler or Reclaimer into an extra autonomous companion, but can identify, repair and manipulate their Soul Furnace systems. In a vehicle a soul gives its vehicle Echo and Pulse from the Codex; in a servitor it gives its Construct Imprint. One soul never gives both at once.

The Twelve Construct Imprints

D100	Archetype	Construct role
01–10	Courier	Rapid support and spell delivery
11–18	Lancer	Duelling and enemy control
19–27	Artificer	Mechanical adaptation
28–36	Scout	Detection and battlefield intelligence
37–45	Thief	Infiltration and disarming
46–54	Fire Adept	Area denial
55–63	Healer	Emergency healing and preservation
64–71	Warlord	Tactical coordination
72–79	Magistrate	Evidence, investigation and legal control
80–86	Penitent	Protective intervention
87–94	Berserker	Destructive area disruption
95–00	Planar Cartographer	Spatial engineering and planar defence

This table sets abilities, not alignment; a soul's profession, morals and personality are rolled separately. In Foundry, each imprint is an item in Player Options: drag it onto the servitor.

Courier (D100 01–10 · Rapid support and spell delivery)

Echo: Living Delivery Conduit. When you cast an artificer spell with a range of touch, your Courier servitor can deliver it as though it were the caster, provided it is within 60 feet of you and the target is within 5 feet of it. The spell uses your action, slot and other requirements.

Pulse: Emergency Dispatch (Support). Choose one willing creature within 30 feet of the servitor. It can use its reaction to move up to 15 feet without provoking opportunity attacks.

Awakened Inscription: Priority Delivery. Once per turn, immediately after the servitor delivers one of your touch spells, it can move 10 feet without provoking opportunity attacks. This doesn't use its movement.

Example soul: Quillip Swiftpost, the Undelivered Messenger. Impatient, sarcastic, constantly asks whether the party knows the meaning of the word urgent. Deeply distressed by unopened letters. Quest: Deliver the final letter Quillip was carrying when captured.

Lancer (d100 11–18 · Duelling and enemy control)

Echo: Duelist's Interdiction. Once per turn when the servitor hits a creature with a melee attack, that creature can't make opportunity attacks against anyone but the servitor until the start of your next turn.

Pulse: Oathpin (Offensive). The servitor makes one melee attack. On a hit, the target takes the attack's normal damage and must succeed on a Strength saving throw or have its speed reduced to 0 until the start of your next turn.

Awakened Inscription: Challenge of Iron. Once per round, when a creature the servitor struck on its previous turn attacks an ally within 5 feet of the servitor, the servitor can use its reaction to impose disadvantage on that attack.

Example soul: Tarnik Blackspoke, the Betrayed Cavalryman. Proud, formal, deeply protective of weaker companions. Horrified that a sworn knight's soul might be used for dishonourable acts. Quest: Find evidence that Tarnik did not abandon his squad.

Artificer (d100 19–27 · Mechanical adaptation)

Echo: Artisan's Memory. The servitor can use smith's tools, tinker's tools and one other set of artisan's tools you're proficient with, making those checks with your Intelligence modifier and proficiency bonus.

Pulse: Emergency Reconfiguration (Support). The servitor switches between Enforcer and Attendant configuration for 1 minute, gaining the other frame's movement, AC and chassis abilities. Its current and maximum hit points stay as they are until the effect ends; it keeps its fuel, Heat, Sparks and imprint.

Awakened Inscription: Redundant Soul Housing. Once per long rest, when the servitor would drop to 0 hit points, it drops to 1 hit point instead and its Heat resets to 0.

Example soul: Gilda Copperhand, the Disgraced Master Engineer. Obsessive about maintenance, meticulously critical of the artificer's workmanship, unable to accept that a working mechanism might still be badly designed. Quest: Recover Gilda's stolen master schematic, which may have shaped the Iron Heir.

Scout (d100 28–36 · Detection and battlefield intelligence)

Echo: Spectral Detection Lattice. The servitor can perceive invisible creatures and objects within 10 feet that aren't behind total cover.

Pulse: Weakness Revelation (Support). Choose one creature within 60 feet. Until the start of your next turn it gains no benefit from invisibility or from half or three-quarters cover against attacks by you or your servitors. Other concealment still applies.

Awakened Inscription: Perimeter Intelligence. While the servitor is conscious, you and friendly creatures within 10 feet of it can't be surprised and gain +2 to initiative rolls.

Example soul: Nera Ash-Eye, the Last Pathfinder. Suspicious, terse, watchful. Routinely predicts disasters and becomes insufferably smug when right. Quest: Discover what happened to the companions Nera guided into Avernus.

Thief (d100 37–45 · Infiltration and disarming)

Echo: Thieving Fingers. The servitor can use thieves' tools and make precise Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) checks, adding your proficiency bonus, with the fine motor control to do so whatever its chassis looks like.

Pulse: Filch the Weapon (Support). One creature within 5 feet makes a Dexterity saving throw or drops one Small or smaller object it's holding (your choice) into an adjacent space. Objects magically secured to their owner are unaffected.

Awakened Inscription: Cloaked Mechanism. Once per short or long rest, after the servitor succeeds on a Sleight of Hand check or Helps a creature's Stealth check, it becomes invisible until the start of your next turn, or until it attacks, deals damage or casts a spell.

Example soul: Pex Lockwhisper, the Impossible Burglar. Cheeky, opportunistic, naturally suspicious of authority. Insists every locked door is an invitation. Quest: Retrieve the fortune Pex hid shortly before he was murdered.

Fire Adept (d100 46–54 · Area denial)

Echo: Punishing Furnace. Once per turn, when a creature starts grappling the servitor or hits it with an unarmed strike, that creature takes 3 (1d6) fire damage.

Pulse: Molten Inscription (Offensive). Choose a 10-foot square of ground within 30 feet. Until the start of your next turn it is difficult terrain, and a creature that enters it for the first time on a turn or starts its turn there takes 2d8 fire damage (once per turn).

Awakened Inscription: Tempered Inferno. Fire damage from the servitor's own features ignores fire resistance (not immunity). The servitor chooses whether its fire ignites unattended combustibles.

Example soul: Mother Cinder, the Ashen Pyromancer. Dramatic, enthusiastic, and disturbingly appreciative of a beautiful explosion. An evil arsonist, an idealistic purifier or a devoted forge-worker, depending on alignment. Quest: Discover who deliberately set the fire that ended Mother Cinder's life.

Healer (d100 55–63 · Emergency healing and preservation)

Echo: Deathwatch Instruments. Friendly creatures within 10 feet of the active, unincapacitated servitor have advantage on death saving throws.

Pulse: Borrowed Heartbeat (Support). One willing creature within 5 feet can immediately spend up to two of its Hit Dice and regain hit points equal to the dice rolled plus your Intelligence modifier. If it is conscious and prone, it can also stand without spending movement.

Awakened Inscription: The Last Breath. Once per long rest, when a creature within 10 feet would drop to 0 hit points without being killed outright, the servitor can use its reaction to leave it at 1 hit point instead. The servitor then takes 2d8 necrotic damage that can't be reduced.

Example soul: Merrow Kindhand, the Battlefield Physician. Compassionate but impatient, especially with reckless adventurers. Calls everyone by their most recent injury. Quest: Find the surviving patients Merrow was protecting when she was captured.

Warlord (d100 64–71 · Tactical coordination)

Echo: Tactical Formation. Once per turn, one friendly creature within 5 feet of the servitor gains +1 on its first weapon attack roll that turn.

Pulse: General's Command (Offensive). One willing ally within 30 feet who can hear the servitor can use its reaction to make one weapon attack against a target within its weapon's range.

Awakened Inscription: Coordinated Assault. When one of your servitors Helps the other servitor's attack, that attack gains an extra +2 to hit (once per round).

Example soul: General Varnek, the Conqueror of Seven Banners. Authoritative, loud, arrogant, and certain that everyone else is disastrously incompetent at war. Quest: Learn which subordinate betrayed Varnek for an infernal promotion.

Magistrate (d100 72–79 · Evidence, investigation and legal control)

Echo: Witness Plate. While active, the servitor perfectly records conversations, visible writing and signatures within 30 feet, and can play them back in its voice or as projected script. Magical concealment can prevent a particular recording.

Pulse: Identify the Controller (Support). One construct or fiend within 30 feet makes a Charisma saving throw. On a failure, the servitor learns who is currently issuing its magical commands (if the target knows), and the target has disadvantage on its next attack roll before the start of your next turn.

Awakened Inscription: Chain of Custody. After examining a document or magical contract for 1 minute, the servitor identifies altered passages and counterfeit seals. This is authenticated evidence of alteration; it can't by itself decide whether the whole agreement is lawful.

Example soul: Ysera Quill, the Defiant Infernal Magistrate. Formal, pedantic, exacting, relentlessly concerned with the wording of instructions. Constantly reminds the artificer that owning a machine is not owning its occupant. Quest: Expose the fraudulent transaction by which Misty obtained Ysera's soul coin.

Penitent (d100 80–86 · Protective intervention)

Echo: Shield of Remorse. While the servitor is taking the Dodge action, friendly creatures within 5 feet of it gain +1 AC against the first attack made against each of them that round.

Pulse: Intercession Writ (Support). Choose one ally within 30 feet. The next time it takes damage before the start of your next turn, reduce the damage by 2d8 + your Intelligence modifier; any unused protection then vanishes.

Awakened Inscription: Burden of Mercy. Once per short or long rest, when the servitor uses Interpose or Intercession Writ to protect an ally, that ally can immediately repeat a saving throw against one effect making it charmed or frightened, ending it on a success.

Example soul: Brother Halven, the Repentant Executioner. Quiet, remorseful, deeply uncomfortable with coercion. Speaks most when the artificer faces a hard moral choice. Quest: Find someone harmed by Halven's former deeds and offer restitution.

Berserker (d100 87–94 · Destructive area disruption)

Echo: Grudge Engine. While the servitor is at or below half its maximum hit points, the first damaging attack it makes on each of its turns deals an extra 1d4 bludgeoning damage.

Pulse: Scrapstorm (Offensive). The servitor spins violently. Each enemy within 5 feet makes a Strength saving throw, taking 2d8 bludgeoning damage and being pushed 10 feet on a failure, or half damage and no push on a success.

Awakened Inscription: Wrecking Pressure. Once per turn, when the servitor hits with a melee attack while below half its hit points, it can take 1d6 fire damage (ignoring resistance and immunity) to deal an extra 1d8 force damage with that attack.

Example soul: Skritch Mawbreaker, the Pit Champion. Excitable, belligerent, quick to laugh, eager to fight enormous enemies. May regard the artificer as an inadequate but entertaining battle commander. Quest: Defeat the pit master who sold Skritch's soul rather than honour his promised freedom.

Planar Cartographer (d100 95–00 · Spatial engineering and planar defence)

Echo: Planar Surveyor. The servitor senses the presence and rough direction of planar portals, extradimensional entrances and unstable planar boundaries within 60 feet, unless a powerful ward blocks it. It doesn't learn destinations.

Pulse: Phase Bridge (Support). Create a solid bridge of translucent force up to 15 feet long and 5 feet wide between two points the servitor can see within 30 feet. It lasts until the start of your next turn; anyone on it when it vanishes falls.

Awakened Inscription: Dimensional Anchor. Once per long rest, when unwilling teleportation or planar displacement would affect you, the servitor or a willing ally within 10 feet of it, the servitor can use its reaction to prevent it. It can't undo a displacement that has already happened.

Example soul: Sevrin Nine-Roads, the Lost Navigator. Curious, philosophical, often distracted by impossible geometry. Describes places that no longer exist. Quest: Discover where an expedition that vanished between the planes finally went.

Souls and Alignment

Every alignment is equally likely, whatever the archetype. A Lawful Good Berserker, a Chaotic Evil Healer, a Lawful Evil Courier and a Chaotic Good Magistrate are all equally possible. Alignment shapes the soul's morals, worldview, reading of orders, relationships and personality. It never changes the imprint's mechanics.

Random alignment (2d6). Roll two separate d6. The first sets order (1–2 Lawful, 3–4 Neutral, 5–6 Chaotic), the second morality (1–2 Good, 3–4 Neutral, 5–6 Evil). Neutral and Neutral is True Neutral. Each of the nine results has exactly a 1 in 9 chance.

The Nine-Soul Deck. For a whole collection of coins, make nine cards, one per alignment. Shuffle, draw without replacement until all nine are used, then reshuffle. Every completed group of nine souls then has exactly one of each alignment.

The Nine Alignments

Lawful Good: The Principled Protector

- **Values:** Duty, compassion, justice, honour, responsibility.
- **To cruel or merciful orders:** They obey the binding while protesting the injustice and seeking lawful ways to prevent similar harm.
- **Trust is earned through:** Keeping promises, protecting the vulnerable, admitting mistakes, allowing eventual liberation.
- **Voice:** "I will do what you command. I shall not, however, call it honourable."
- **Contradiction:** Their need to fulfil an oath may conflict with their desire to escape servitude.

Neutral Good: The Compassionate Soul

- **Values:** Kindness, healing, empathy, reducing suffering.
- **To cruel or merciful orders:** Distressed, worried about consequences, eager to find merciful alternatives.
- **Trust is earned through:** Compassion, mercy, helping strangers, treating souls as individuals.
- **Voice:** "There must be another way. There is nearly always another way."
- **Contradiction:** They may willingly stay in a painful situation to protect someone they care about.

Chaotic Good: The Defiant Liberator

- **Values:** Freedom, justice, individuality, resisting oppression.
- **To cruel or merciful orders:** Outspoken condemnation, even when mechanically compelled to comply.
- **Trust is earned through:** Freeing captives, opposing tyrants, allowing personal expression.
- **Voice:** "I spent my life fighting slavers, and now I'm a bloody iron kettle with legs!"
- **Contradiction:** They might enjoy their powerful body while despising how they got it.

Lawful Neutral: The Keeper of Order

- **Values:** Procedure, discipline, structure, responsibility, consistency.
- **To cruel or merciful orders:** May comply without emotional protest but still question whether the order is procedurally justified.
- **Trust is earned through:** Clarity, consistency, adherence to formal agreements.
- **Voice:** "Instruction received. I advise you that the command violates three provisions of our existing agreement."
- **Contradiction:** Their loyalty to a system is tested when that system is demonstrably corrupt.

True Neutral: The Practical Observer

- **Values:** Practicality, balance, survival, knowledge, personal responsibilities.
- **To cruel or merciful orders:** More likely to discuss consequences than morality, though some object for personal reasons.
- **Trust is earned through:** Competence, balanced decisions, respect for personal goals.
- **Voice:** "Not what I would have chosen. But considering the alternatives, it may work."
- **Contradiction:** Their wish to stay uninvolved may become impossible as the Championship escalates.

Chaotic Neutral: The Unpredictable Individualist

- **Values:** Personal freedom, curiosity, originality, autonomy.
- **To cruel or merciful orders:** Anything from disgust to detached cynicism, depending on the soul's interests.
- **Trust is earned through:** Room to improvise, serious attention to their opinions, freedom where possible.
- **Voice:** "We could use the door. Or the wall. Or hear me out: the ceiling."
- **Contradiction:** They may form strong attachments while insisting they need nobody.

Lawful Evil: The Ambitious Tyrant

- **Values:** Hierarchy, ambition, power, discipline, control.
- **To cruel or merciful orders:** May ridicule generosity as inefficient, yet obey fully and sometimes take an interest in the results.
- **Trust is earned through:** Credible deals, status, influence, mutually beneficial arrangements.
- **Voice:** "You have commanded my obedience. You have not earned my respect."
- **Contradiction:** A devotee of hierarchy forcibly placed at its bottom.

Neutral Evil: The Calculating Opportunist

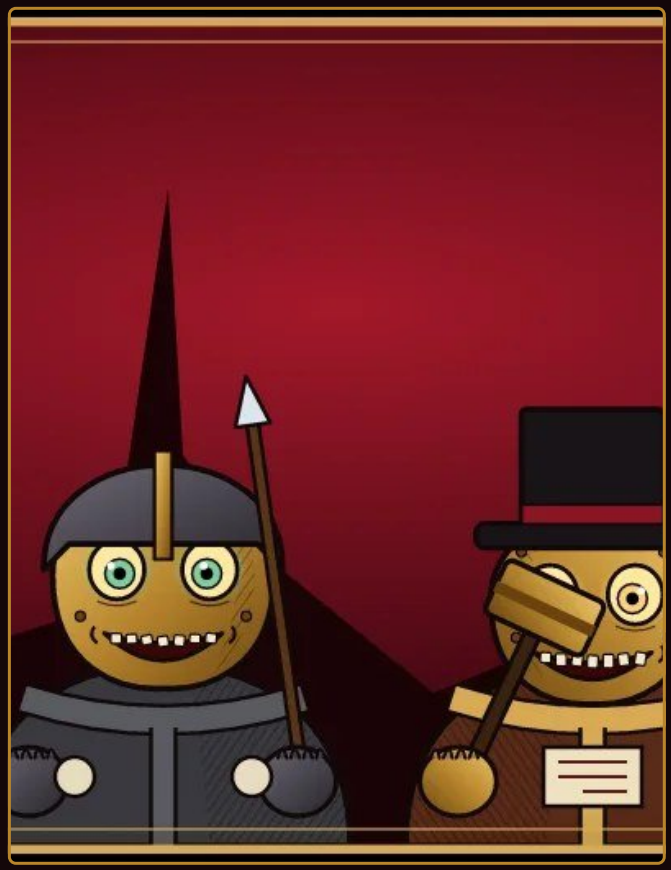
- **Values:** Personal advancement, survival, advantage, self-interest.
- **To cruel or merciful orders:** Generally complies, but asks why the artificer is spending resources for nothing.
- **Trust is earned through:** Clear incentives and bargains that consistently benefit both sides.
- **Voice:** "There's the profitable option, the merciful option, and the stupid option. Which would you like first?"
- **Contradiction:** They may find that attachment has become worth more to them than gain.

Chaotic Evil: The Malicious Destroyer

- **Values:** Domination, cruelty, impulsive desire, personal gratification.
- **To cruel or merciful orders:** Obeys, but complains loudly or mocks the people being helped.
- **Trust is earned through:** Personal incentives, chances to reach their goals, consistent treatment. Trust doesn't guarantee kindness.
- **Voice:** "WHAT DO YOU MEAN WE'RE SAVING HIM? I ALREADY PICKED WHICH ARM I WAS GOING TO BREAK!"
- **Contradiction:** A soul that wants absolute freedom may find it now depends on the artificer to exist at all.

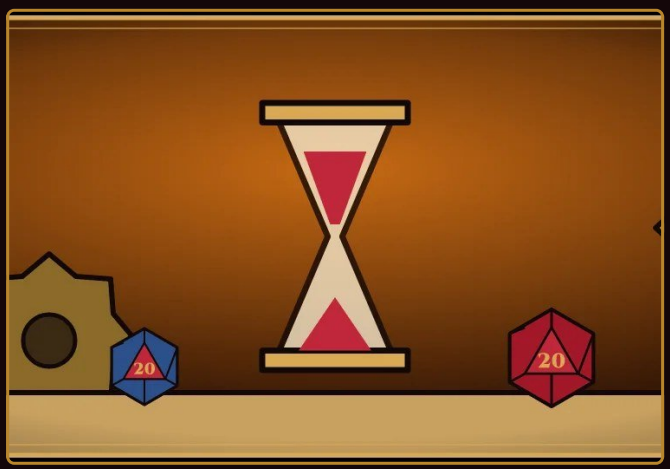
Creating a Soul

- Roll the **Soul Archetype** (d100).
- Roll **alignment** (2d6) or draw from the Nine-Soul Deck.
- Roll the **initial attitude** (d8) and the **legal origin** (d6), using the Soul Furnace tables.
- Roll a **core motivation**, **speaking manner**, **personal contradiction** and **grievance** (d6 each).
- Give the soul a name, former species, homeland and one meaningful memory, and choose how its relationship with the artificer begins.



d6	Core motivation	Speaking manner	Personal contradiction	Grievance
1	Recover someone they loved	Formal and precise	Their convictions conflict with something terrible they once did	Despises the design of their mechanical body
2	Take revenge on whoever caused their death	Sarcastic and irreverent	They want freedom but fear the afterlife	Resents compulsory obedience but is glad to move again
3	Restore their reputation or prove their innocence	Emotional and passionate	They hate imprisonment but enjoy their new mechanical abilities	Recognises someone involved in their imprisonment
4	Complete unfinished work	Quiet and contemplative	They stay loyal to someone who betrayed them	Believes their imprisonment was lawful and thinks liberation dishonourable
5	Escape an outstanding obligation or punishment	Confrontational and argumentative	They claim to want revenge but secretly want forgiveness	Wants revenge before their fuel runs out
6	Gain power, influence or a second chance at life	Warm and talkative	They believe they deserve punishment but can't accept its consequences	Wants freedom but is terrified of what comes after

Alignment has no bearing on the legal origin. An evil soul can be the victim of a fraudulent imprisonment, and a good soul may have made a genuinely terrible bargain. The individual soul is a persistent character, not a disposable table result: its alignment, personality and legal history survive any change of body.



A Balanced Collection: Nine Souls

Soul	Archetype	Alignment	Defining trait
Tarnik Blackspoke	Lancer	Lawful Good	An honourable knight determined to prove his innocence
Merrow Kindhand	Healer	Neutral Good	A compassionate physician who believes no patient is beyond saving
Quillip Swiftpost	Courier	Chaotic Good	A reckless messenger who smuggled food to oppressed communities
Ysera Quill	Magistrate	Lawful Neutral	A precise advocate who values truth and procedural fairness
Gilda Copperhand	Artificer	True Neutral	A brilliant engineer who values invention above ideology
Sevrin Nine-Roads	Planar Cartographer	Chaotic Neutral	A traveller obsessed with freedom and exploration
Mother Cinder	Fire Adept	Lawful Evil	A pyromancer who believes destruction should follow strict principles
General Varnek	Warlord	Neutral Evil	A mercenary commander who values personal advancement
Pex Lockwhisper	Thief	Chaotic Evil	A malicious burglar who treats theft and humiliation as entertainment

Nera Ash-Eye (Scout), Brother Halven (Penitent) and Skritch Mawbreaker (Berserker) roll their alignments the same way when introduced. The named examples never fix an archetype to an alignment.

Example: A 12th-Level Soulforged

Veyra Brassheart, a 12th-level Soulforged with Intelligence 20 (proficiency +4), travels with two independently conscious constructs.

Construct	Soul	Stats	Fuel / Sparks	Inscription
Iron Oath (Primary Enforcer, 70 HP)	Tarnik Blackspoke, LG Lancer	AC 17; Force Fist +9, 1d8 + 4 force	72 hours / 3	Challenge of Iron
Mercy-7 (Auxiliary Attendant, 29 HP)	Merrow Kindhand, NG Healer	AC 16; Arc Needle +9, 1d6 + 4 lightning	48 hours / 2	None

Attunement. Slot 1 Iron Oath's harness; slot 2 Mercy-7's harness; slot 3 Iron Oath's Awakened Inscription; slot 4 a personal magic item. At 14th level her fifth slot adds flexibility.

A turn. Facing three infernal soldiers and a wounded ally, Veyra casts *heat metal* on the captain's armour, then issues a Coordinated Directive with her bonus action. Iron Oath advances and punches a soldier; Mercy-7 reaches the wounded ally and Bolsters them for 1d6 + 4. Veyra adds Resonant Conduit's 1d8 to the punch *or* the temporary hit points, not both. The souls immediately start arguing.

"Advance!"

Tarnik: The enemy's flank is exposed! Strike while they're disorganised!
Merrow: I have three bleeding patients behind us, you oversized suit of cutlery!
Tarnik: I was commander of the King's Fifth Cavalry!
Merrow: Wonderful. And now you're a wardrobe with fists.
Both carry out their instructions anyway.

Level	How the Soulforged plays
3–4	One companion with a unique personality and limited soul abilities
5–8	A specialised companion, enhanced through extra attunement
9–11	Two constructs with coordinated combat and support actions
12–14	A customisable mechanical team working alongside the artificer's spells
15–17	A formidable commander able to field two offensive units
18–20	More attunement flexibility from the artificer's own progression

The Voluntary Maintenance Covenant

A Soulforged artificer may offer a separate contract to the soul in the machine, Form SF-12. It isn't needed to run the servitor. It sets out treatment, working conditions, disclosure, liberation and the soul's rights. Acceptance must be voluntary: the Directive Binding can't substitute for consent. A breach creates a legal dispute and remedies, but never transfers a soul, creates a power or overrides the Championship's higher rules.

Quick Reference

Build a frame	Long rest, tools, 50 gp of materials
Attune	One attunement slot per servitor
Install a coin	Action within 5 ft.; the coin is consumed
Fuel	24 hours per remaining charge
Sparks	1–3; never recharge
Pulse	Commanded action, 1 Spark, +1 Heat
Overburn	+20 ft. or advantage on an attack; +1 Heat; 2d10 fire to itself
Command	Your bonus action
Two constructs	9th level; one offensive action between them
Both attack	15th level, Sovereign Overclock
Awakening	A second attunement slot on that frame
Alignment	Two d6 or the Nine-Soul Deck
Liberation	Stopped furnace, DC 18 with a consecrated focus

The most interesting Soulforged won't necessarily be the one who builds the strongest golem. It may be the one who builds a body for a soul, offers that soul its freedom, and discovers that the soul chooses to stay. Not because it must.

Soulforged Servitors

Both frames at 12th level with Intelligence 20. Rescale with the formulas in each biography.



A combat frame built to intercept enemies, withstand punishment and protect its creator.

Shown for a 12th-level artificer with Intelligence 20 (proficiency bonus +4, spell attack +9, save DC 17). Rescale with your own numbers: AC 13 + PB; HP 5 + 5 × artificer level + Int modifier; Force Fist uses your spell attack, 1d8 + PB force. Its challenge rating only sets proficiency +4; a servitor is worth no XP.

Soulforged Enforcer

Medium construct, as its soul

Armor Class 17

Hit Points 70 (5 + 5 × artificer level + Int)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Dex +5, Con +7

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities exhaustion, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages Infernal, and any languages its soul knew in life

Challenge 9 (5,000 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +4

Industrial Strength. The Enforcer counts as one size larger when calculating carrying capacity and the weight it can push, drag or lift.

Magical Construction. Its attacks count as magical.

Actions

Force Fist. *Melee Spell Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) force damage.

Reactions

Interpose. *Reaction.* When a creature within 5 feet of the Enforcer is targeted by an attack, the Enforcer imposes disadvantage on that attack roll before it is made.



A support frame with repair tools, stabilisation mechanisms, defensive magic and precision instruments.

Shown for a 12th-level artificer with Intelligence 20 (proficiency bonus +4, spell attack +9, save DC 17). Rescale with your own numbers: AC 12 + PB; HP 5 + 4 × artificer level + Int modifier; Arc Needle uses your spell attack, 1d6 + PB lightning; Bolster 1d6 + PB; Field Repair 2d8 + Int. Its challenge rating only sets proficiency +4; a servitor is worth no XP.

Soulforged Attendant

Medium construct, as its soul

Armor Class 16

Hit Points 58 (5 + 4 × artificer level + Int)

Speed 30 ft., climb 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Dex +6, Wis +6

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities exhaustion, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages Infernal, and any languages its soul knew in life

Challenge 9 (5,000 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +4

Magical Construction. Its attacks count as magical.

Triage. As an action, the Attendant stabilises a living creature within 5 feet without an ability check.

Actions

Arc Needle. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +9 to hit, range 60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d6 + 4) lightning damage.

Bolster. One creature within 10 feet gains 1d6 + your proficiency bonus temporary hit points. Temporary hit points from repeated uses don't stack.

Field Repair. One construct, object or vehicle within 5 feet regains 2d8 + your Intelligence modifier hit points. Your servitors share a pool of uses equal to your proficiency bonus per long rest. A target destroyed at 0 hit points (rather than merely incapacitated) can't be repaired this way alone.

Ashen Forms: Fiends of Avernus

Seven original fiends for the Circle of Ashen Covenants' Wild Shape. The Ashen Hellwarden is an Infernal Form (10th level, two uses of Wild Shape). SRD fiends use the standard stat blocks; the forms from other books use those books.

Thumb-sized devils that nest in the cold furnaces of wrecked war machines and gnaw the ash for the last warmth of the souls burned there. The Souljack Yard is full of them.

Cinder Mite

Tiny fiend (devil), lawful evil

Armor Class 13

Hit Points 10 (4d4)

Speed 20 ft., climb 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
4 (-3)	16 (+3)	11 (+0)	6 (-2)	12 (+1)	6 (-2)

Damage Immunities fire, poison

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages Infernal, understands Infernal but can't speak

Challenge 1/4 (50 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Ember Body. A creature that touches the mite or hits it with a melee attack while within 5 feet of it takes 1 fire damage.

Furnace-Fed. While touching a fire, a burning object or a soul furnace, the mite regains 2 hit points at the start of its turn.

Actions

Ember Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) piercing damage plus 2 (1d4) fire damage.

The hounds of the Counting Gate. A tallyhound tracks unpaid debts the way a bloodhound tracks the wounded, and it barks once for every name it smells on a contract.

Tallyhound

Medium fiend (devil), lawful evil

Armor Class 13

Hit Points 22 (4d8+4)

Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	5 (-3)	13 (+1)	6 (-2)

Skills Perception +3

Damage Resistances cold

Damage Immunities fire, poison

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages Infernal, understands Infernal but can't speak

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Scent of Ink. The tallyhound has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell, and can smell fresh ink, sealing wax and signed contracts within 30 feet.

Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 12 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

Brass-winged couriers of the Brass Registry, carrying writs between the Citadel and the far tollhouses. Their talons leave a seal that every devil can read.

BRASS GATEWING

Small fiend (devil), lawful evil

Armor Class 14

Hit Points 27 (6d6+6)

Speed 20 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)

Damage Resistances cold

Damage Immunities fire, poison

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages Infernal, understands Common but can't speak it

Challenge 1 (200 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Devil's Sight. Magical darkness doesn't impede the gatewing's darkvision.

Flyby. The gatewing doesn't provoke opportunity attacks when it flies out of an enemy's reach.

ACTIONS

Seal Talons. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (2d4 + 3) slashing damage. A creature hit is marked with a glowing brass seal until the end of the gatewing's next turn; the next attack roll against it has advantage.

Hunched draught-devils with furnaces in their backs, bred to haul siege engines and souljack rigs across the ash when the soul fuel runs out.

STOKEBACK

Large fiend (devil), lawful evil

Armor Class 13

Hit Points 51 (6d10+18)

Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	3 (-4)	10 (+0)	5 (-3)

Damage Resistances cold

Damage Immunities fire, poison

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages understands Infernal but can't speak

Challenge 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Furnace Charge. If the stokeback moves at least 20 feet straight toward a target and then hits it with a Gore attack on the same turn, the target takes an extra 2d6 piercing damage. A creature must also succeed on a DC 14 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

Beast of Burden. The stokeback counts as one size larger for carrying capacity, and can tow a war machine.

ACTIONS

Gore. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) piercing damage.

Barbed devils who keep the tollhouses on the roads to the Brass Citadel. Every hook on their hide was once a receipt someone refused to pay.

Barbed Toll-Warden

Medium fiend (devil), lawful evil

Armor Class 15

Hit Points 52 (8d8+16)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)

Saving Throws Str +5, Con +4

Damage Resistances cold bludgeoning, piercing and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't silvered

Damage Immunities fire, poison

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages Infernal, telepathy 60 ft.

Challenge 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Barbed Hide. At the start of each of its turns, the toll-warden deals 1d6 piercing damage to any creature grappling it.

Magic Resistance. The toll-warden has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Actions

Multiattack. The toll-warden makes two Toll Hook attacks.

Toll Hook. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) slashing damage. Once per turn, a creature hit must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or be unable to take reactions until the end of its next turn, as the toll is exacted.

The repossession men's hunting hounds, chained in pairs to the Iron Reclaimer. A writ hound that has tasted a debtor never loses the scent.

Writ Hound

Large fiend (devil), lawful evil

Armor Class 15

Hit Points 76 (9d10+27)

Speed 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	14 (+2)	17 (+3)	6 (-2)	13 (+1)	8 (-1)

Skills Perception +3, Survival +3

Damage Resistances cold

Damage Immunities fire, poison

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages understands Infernal but can't speak

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Relentless Pursuit. The writ hound always knows the direction of a creature it has bitten within the last 24 hours, while both are on the same plane.

Keen Smell. The writ hound has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell.

Actions

Multiattack. The writ hound makes one Bite attack and one Chain Lash attack.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) piercing damage.

Chain Lash. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (1d10 + 4) bludgeoning damage. The target is grappled (escape DC 14) if it is Large or smaller. Until the grapple ends, the writ hound can't Chain Lash another target.

A guardian of grey ash and banked coals, raised where an oath burned out. Ashen druids learn its shape from the groves that grow on old battlefields: the Circle's Infernal Form.

Ashen Hellwarden

Large fiend (devil), lawful evil

Armor Class 16

Hit Points 110 (13d10+39)

Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	12 (+1)	17 (+3)	8 (-1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws Con +6, Wis +5

Damage Resistances cold bludgeoning, piercing and slashing from nonmagical attacks that aren't silvered

Damage Immunities fire, poison

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages Infernal, telepathy 60 ft.

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Magic Resistance. The hellwarden has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Ash Aura. At the start of each of the hellwarden's turns, each creature of its choice within 10 feet of it takes 5 (1d10) fire damage.

Actions

Multiattack. The hellwarden makes two Ember Fist attacks.

Ember Fist. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage plus 3 (1d6) fire damage.

Cinder Breath. The hellwarden exhales burning ash in a 15-foot cone. Each creature in the cone makes a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 21 (6d6) fire damage on a failure or half as much on a success.

School of Infernal Contracts

Arcane Tradition (Wizard) · from the Asmodeun Scriptorium

Wizards of this tradition treat spellcasting as the drafting and execution of binding pacts. Each firebolt is signed in flame; each divination is invoked through a devil's witness. They summon fiends, negotiate terms, and bind planar powers to their will—always mindful that every boon from Hell carries its price, and that the price is written in a footnote.

Contractual Wizard Features

Wizard Level	Feature
2nd	Runic Drafting, Contract Sigil
6th	Devil's Retainer, Binding Authority
10th	Master of Covenants
14th	Grand Infernal Binding

Runic Drafting

Wizard 2

You gain proficiency with calligrapher's supplies and learn to read, write, and speak Infernal. You also learn the *fine print* cantrip, which does not count against your number of cantrips known.

Your training in infernal law makes your spellbook a legal instrument. When you copy a spell into your spellbook, you can do so in half the usual time and for half the usual cost if the spell is on the Infernal Contract Spell List (Part VI) or has the abjuration, conjuration, or enchantment school.

Additionally, when you draft a contract using the Ledger rules, you make the drafting check with advantage.

Contract Sigil

Wizard 2

As a bonus action, you can bind yourself or a willing creature you can touch with a **Contract Sigil**—a glowing infernal rune and a whispered clause. As you place the sigil, state one simple **Term**: an action the bearer must take, or must refrain from taking, while the sigil lasts.

For 1 hour, once on each of its turns, the bearer can add **1d4** to one damage roll or one saving throw of its choice. If the bearer knowingly violates the Term, the sigil shatters: the effect ends and the bearer takes 5 (2d4) psychic damage.

You can have only one sigil active at a time, and you can place a number of sigils equal to your Intelligence modifier (minimum of one) per long rest. Placing a new sigil ends the old one.

Flavour. You trace a blood-red rune in the air, speak *"...per foedus omnia,"* and the mark fuses to flesh or armour—a promise of power drawn against Hell's vault, repayable in ways the bearer has not yet read.

Devil's Retainer

Wizard 6

Over a 10-minute ritual, you bind a lesser devil into your service as a clerk. It uses the imp stat block, but it cannot make attacks and its Sting attack is replaced by the ability to Help. It obeys your commands, shares its senses with you as a familiar does, and can scribe at your dictation in perfect Infernal.

Once per long rest, when a creature you can see within 60 feet of your retainer makes a saving throw against one of your spells, the retainer can **Object**, imposing disadvantage on that save. When it does, everyone within 60 feet hears the objection, whether or not they speak Infernal.

If the retainer is reduced to 0 hit points it dissolves into sulfurous paperwork, and you can rebind it after a long rest. Should you dismiss it in violation of its own terms of service, it files a grievance—which is a plot hook, not a mechanic.

Binding Authority

Wizard 6

When you cast a spell that summons, calls, or binds a fiend, the creature obeys your spoken commands for the spell's duration without requiring a check or a saving throw to control it, provided you have not violated any term you offered it. If you *have* violated such a term, the creature is instead immediately freed and hostile, and it knows exactly which clause you broke.

Master of Covenants

Wizard 10

Your mastery of infernal law deepens.

- **Twin Contracts.** You can maintain two Contract Sigils simultaneously, on different creatures.
- **Superior Drafting.** The Contract Sigil die becomes a **d6**.
- **Warding Covenants.** A creature bearing your sigil gains resistance to fire damage and psychic damage.
- **Consideration.** When a sigil shatters because its bearer violated a Term, you gain temporary hit points equal to twice your wizard level. Hell pays its finder's fees promptly.

Grand Infernal Binding

Wizard 14

You can cast *contract of infernal servitude* without a spell slot or material components. When you do, you can bind a creature of challenge rating 8 or lower, and the binding does not require concentration.

Additionally, whenever you cast a spell that binds, restrains, banishes, or compels a creature whose **True Name** you know, that creature has disadvantage on its saving throw and cannot benefit from legal remedies of any kind, which in practice means it cannot end the effect early by any means short of *wish*.

Once you use this feature to cast *contract of infernal servitude* without a slot, you cannot do so again until you finish a long rest.

Flavour. The sky above you darkens as interlocking infernal triangles spin into place, and a bone devil lieutenant steps forth —its service sealed, its objections noted for the record, its contempt entirely professional.

Oath of the Infernal Lord

Sacred Oath (Paladin) · from the Asmodeun Scriptorium

"By iron and flame, by blood and dread..."

Paladins who swear this Oath bind soul and steel to Asmodeus himself. Vengeance burns hot in their hearts, but they temper its fury with cold contractual precision, summoning fiendish allies and binding enemies in infernal pacts. They are not brutes. They are process servers with a greatsword.

Tenets of the Infernal Lord

- **Dominion through Fear.** Inspire dread; enforce Asmodeus's law without mercy.
- **Unbreakable Contract.** Every bargain must be honoured—breaking a pact is a fate worse than death.
- **Temptation's Grace.** Offer infernal power in exchange for weakness; all may be tempted.
- **Merciless Order.** Mercy is chaos; impose structure by any means.
- **Eternal Loyalty.** Your soul, your name, and your will belong wholly to Asmodeus.

Oath Spells

You gain the following spells at the paladin levels listed. They count as paladin spells for you and do not count against the number of spells you can prepare.

Paladin Level	Spells
3rd	*hellish rebuke*, *seal of the first pact*
5th	*zone of truth*, *quill of binding*
9th	*magic circle*, *devil's due*
13th	*banishment*, *binding clause*
17th	*flame strike*, *soul covenant*

Playing the Oath Without Playing a Villain

The Oath of the Infernal Lord is written for a lawful character who is genuinely dangerous, not for a player who wants to derail the table. Two guardrails work well in play.

The Contract Is Public. The paladin's terms are stated aloud and honoured to the letter, including the parts that inconvenience them. A party can plan around a devil they can read.

Enforcement Requires a Breach. Every punitive feature keys off someone breaking their word first. That is a discipline, not a limitation, and it makes the paladin's restraint the most frightening thing about them.

In The Night of the Red Clause this oath belongs to the Red Clause's enforcers and to anyone the party meets who signed the Ninth Court's terms. With DM approval it suits an antihero who means to beat Hell at its own law.

Tenets of the Infernal Lord

Paladin 3

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9th	*magic circle*, *devil's due*
13th	*banishment*, *binding clause*
17th	*flame strike*, *soul covenant*

Channel Divinity: Fiendish Rebuke

Paladin 3

Fiendish Rebuke. When you or a creature you can see within 10 feet of you takes damage from an attacker you can see within 60 feet, you can use your reaction to present your holy symbol and unleash a bolt of hellfire. The attacker must make a Dexterity saving throw, taking 11 (2d10) fire damage on a failed save, or half as much on a success. This damage increases to 3d10 at 9th level and 4d10 at 15th level.

Channel Divinity: Fiendish Binding

Paladin 3

Fiendish Binding. As an action, you present your holy symbol and speak an infernal phrase of binding. One creature you can see within 30 feet must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw or be **restrained** by crackling infernal chains for 1 minute. A creature restrained this way can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. A creature that has broken an oath, contract, or sworn promise within the last 24 hours makes its initial save with disadvantage.

Aura of Contract

Paladin 7

You and friendly creatures within 10 feet of you have resistance to fire damage.

In addition, a creature restrained by your Fiendish Binding cannot teleport, cannot be moved by teleportation or planar travel effects, and cannot be returned to its home plane against your will until the restraint ends.

At 18th level, the range of this aura increases to 30 feet.

Unbreakable Pact

Paladin 15

While you are concentrating on a spell from your Oath Spells list, or maintaining a Channel Divinity effect from this Oath, you cannot be charmed or frightened.

Additionally, when a creature affected by one of your Oath spells or by Fiendish Binding repeats a saving throw to end the effect, you can use your reaction to impose disadvantage on that roll. You can do so a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, regaining all expended uses on a long rest.

Finally, you have advantage on saving throws against any effect that would compel you to break a sworn agreement.

Avatar of the Infernal Lord

Paladin 20

As an action, you assume the true aspect of the Ruby Lord for 1 minute. Horns sprout from your head, your eyes blaze, and an aura of hellfire radiates from you in a 30-foot radius. For the duration:

- **Infernal Chains.** A creature of your choice that starts its turn in the aura must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw (DC = 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Charisma modifier) or be restrained until the start of its next turn.
- **Hellfire Blast.** When a creature enters the aura for the first time on a turn, or starts its turn there, it takes 14 (4d6) fire damage.
- **Wings of Flame.** You gain a flying speed equal to your walking speed.
- **Sovereign Authority.** Fiends have disadvantage on saving throws against your spells and Channel Divinity, and you cannot be charmed or frightened.

Once you use this feature, you cannot do so again until you finish a long rest.

Contract Domain

Divine Domain (Cleric) · from the Asmodeun Scriptorium

The Contract Domain serves the paperwork of Hell. Its clerics are notaries, auditors, and collections agents—priests who understand that a soul harvested by signature is worth three taken by force, and that the most damning thing you can do to a mortal is give them exactly what they asked for.

Deities of this domain include Asmodeus above all, but also Dispater, Mammon, and any lawful power that governs oaths, debts, and binding words.

Contract Domain Spells

Cleric Level	Spells
1st	*seal of the first pact*, *command*
3rd	*quill of binding*, *zone of truth*
5th	*devil's due*, *magic circle*
7th	*binding clause*, *banishment*
9th	*soul covenant*, *geas*

Domain Design Notes

The Contract Domain is deliberately conditional. Its best numbers only arrive when someone has agreed to something and then failed to honour it, which means the cleric's strongest play is *social*: extract a promise before the fight, and the fight arrives pre-loaded.

Notary of the Nine is the engine. A generous reading lets allies take Terms happily—temporary hit points for agreeing to charge the front line is a good trade for most fighters—so the feature reads as a buff at the table and as a leash in the fiction. Both readings are correct, which is the point.

Bonus Proficiencies

Cleric 1

You gain proficiency with calligrapher's supplies and heavy armour, and you learn to read, write, and speak Infernal.

Notary of the Nine

Cleric 1

You can bind a creature to a small promise and make the promise bite.

As a bonus action, you offer a **Minor Term** to a creature within 30 feet that can hear and understand you: a single, clearly stated action it must take, or must refrain from taking, before the end of your next turn. The creature must accept willingly.

If it accepts, it immediately gains temporary hit points equal to your cleric level. If it accepts and then knowingly breaks the Term while the temporary hit points remain, those hit points vanish and the creature takes psychic damage equal to 1d8 + your Wisdom modifier.

You can use this feature a number of times equal to your Wisdom modifier (minimum of once), regaining all uses on a long rest.

Channel Divinity: Writ of Compulsion

Cleric 2

As an action, you present your holy symbol and read a clause into the air. One creature within 30 feet that can hear you must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw or be bound by the writ for 1 minute.

When you use this feature, name one action the target is forbidden: attacking a specific creature, moving more than 10 feet from its current position, casting spells with verbal components, or leaving an area you designate. Each time the bound creature attempts the forbidden action, the attempt fails, it wastes the action, and it takes 11 (2d10) psychic damage. It can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on a success.

The damage increases to 3d10 at 8th level and 4d10 at 14th level. Fiends have disadvantage on the initial saving throw; they know exactly who taught you that phrasing.

Channel Divinity: Infernal Audit

Cleric 6

As an action, you open Hell's books on the world around you. For 1 minute, you know the following about any creature you can see within 60 feet: whether it is bound by an oath, pact, curse, or contract; whether it is currently in breach of one; and the identity of the party holding that instrument if that party is a fiend.

While the audit lasts, you can use a bonus action to declare one creature you can see **In Arrears**. Until the audit ends, that creature cannot regain hit points, and the first time on each of your turns that you or an ally deals damage to it, that damage increases by 1d8 necrotic.

A creature that is genuinely bound by no agreement of any kind—rare, and worth noticing—is immune to being declared In Arrears.

Divine Strike: Hellfire Lien

Cleric 8

Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you can cause the attack to deal an extra 4 (1d8) fire damage. When you reach 14th level, this increases to 2d8.

If the target is bound by a Minor Term, Writ of Compulsion, contract, or covenant to which you or an ally are a party, the extra damage is necrotic instead of fire, and the target cannot regain hit points until the end of your next turn.

Master of the Ledger

Cleric 17

Hell recognises your signature.

- **Standing Authority.** You cannot be charmed or frightened by fiends, and you have advantage on saving throws against their spells and abilities.
- **Sealed Covenant.** You can cast *soul covenant* once without expending a spell slot or material components. You regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest.
- **Foreclosure.** When a creature you can see within 60 feet knowingly breaks an oath, contract, or Term to which you are a party or witness, you can use your reaction to call the debt. The creature must make a Charisma saving throw against your spell save DC. On a failed save it takes 44 (8d10) psychic damage and is stunned until the end of its next turn; on a success it takes half as much damage and is not stunned. Once you use this feature, you cannot do so again until you finish a long rest.

Chapter 4

SPELLS



5. Contractual Spellcasting

These are 17 original new spells for this campaign, designed to extend rather than duplicate the Asmodeun Scriptorium's existing 26-spell ladder in *The Night of the Red Clause*. Spells do not forge genuine consent: a magical combat restraint is not a soul bargain. Every spell is in the *Spells* compendium.

Level	Spells
Cantrip	**Ember Receipt**, **Witness Mark**
1st	**Formal Objection**, **Promissory Ward**
2nd	**Collateral Chains**, **Registry of Names**
3rd	**Duel by Covenant**, **Writ of Safe Passage**
4th	**Breach of Dominion**, **Custody of Memory**
5th	**Audit the False**, **Temporary Injunction**
6th	**Planar Reprieve**, **Sever Assigned Name**
7th	**Sovereign Injunction**, **Writ of Provisional Dawn**
8th	**Statute of the First Crown**

Ember Receipt

Evocation cantrip

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S
Duration: Instantaneous

Make a ranged spell attack against a creature. On a hit it takes 4 (1d8) fire damage; if it knowingly broke a clearly stated promise to you during the previous round, it takes an additional 2 (1d4) fire damage (no additional damage from merely signing a contract).

The base damage becomes 2d8 at character level 5, 3d8 at 11 and 4d8 at 17; the bonus stays 1d4.

Spell Lists. Druid, Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Witness Mark

Divination cantrip

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: Touch
Components: V, S
Duration: 1 hour

You mark a willing creature or a document with a faint sigil. While the mark lasts, you can recognise the marked target if you see it within 60 feet, even if superficially disguised. The mark gives no truesight and does not defeat invisibility.

Once before the spell ends, the bearer can choose to reveal the sigil to gain advantage on an ability check to verify the authenticity of its own statement or a signature it personally made. The sigil then vanishes. You can have only one Witness Mark active.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Druid, Warlock, Wizard

Formal Objection

1st-level abjuration

Casting Time: 1 reaction, which you take when a creature within range makes a saving throw against being charmed or frightened
Range: 60 feet
Components: V
Duration: Instantaneous

Before the DM announces the outcome of the save, add 1d4 to the roll. The spell cannot retroactively undo an event.

At Higher Levels. Add another 1d4 at slot levels 3, 5 and 7, to a maximum of 4d4.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Promissory Ward

1st-level abjuration

Casting Time: 1 reaction, which you take when a willing creature within range is damaged by an attack
Range: 30 feet
Components: V, S
Duration: Instantaneous

Reduce the triggering damage by 1d10 + your spellcasting ability modifier. The protected creature may freely promise to aid you later, but this promise has no automatic magical penalty.

At Higher Levels. Add 1d10 reduction per slot level above 1st.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Druid, Paladin, Warlock

Collateral Chains

2nd-level conjuration

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

One creature you see must make a Strength saving throw. On a failure, spectral brass chains *restrained*{restrain} it. It may repeat the save at the end of each of its turns, ending the spell on a success. The chains end early if you lose concentration. A creature restrained by this spell is not legally indebted to you.

Spell Lists. Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Registry of Names

2nd-level divination (ritual)

Casting Time: 10 minutes
Range: Touch
Components: V, S, M (a quill and indexed paper worth 10 gp, not consumed)
Duration: Instantaneous

Touch a named document. Learn whether up to six listed signatures were made by the people they purport to represent, whether the writing has been magically altered since signing, and whether any named signatory appears twice under mutually incompatible identities.

You do not learn true names, a hidden signatory's location, or what a lawful contract means. The spell examines the document, not every copy in the universe.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Druid, Warlock, Wizard

Duel by Covenant

3rd-level abjuration

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

Name two willing creatures within range (one may be you) who can communicate their agreement. For the duration, each duellist gains +1 AC against attacks made by creatures other than the other duellist, and each can once use a reaction to move 10 feet without provoking opportunity attacks from outsiders.

The spell ends for both if either duellist withdraws consent (no action), if they move more than 120 feet apart, or if concentration ends. It does not force them to fight and does not cancel legal duels already established.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Paladin, Warlock

Writ of Safe Passage

3rd-level abjuration (ritual)

Casting Time: 10 minutes
Range: Touch
Components: V, S, M (a brass token worth 25 gp, not consumed)
Duration: 1 hour

Up to six willing creatures who touch the token when you cast gain advantage on their first saving throw each against an environmental hazard caused by heat, extreme cold, acidic rain or planar instability during the duration. Each creature also knows

the shortest nonmagical path back to the casting location while within 1 mile.

The spell neither protects from weapon attacks nor compels a planar authority to grant entry.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Druid, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Breach of Dominion

4th-level transmutation

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 90 feet
Components: V, S
Duration: Instantaneous

A construct or fiend within range makes a Constitution saving throw. On a failure, it takes 22 (5d8) force damage and cannot take reactions until the end of its next turn; on a success, half damage and no other effect.

A construct currently being compelled by a magical command can immediately make an additional saving throw against that command if one was initially allowed.

At Higher Levels. +1d8 damage per slot level above 4th.

Spell Lists. Druid, Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Custody of Memory

4th-level abjuration

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: Touch
Components: V, S, M (a clear glass bead worth 50 gp, not consumed)
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 hour

One willing creature gains advantage on Intelligence and Wisdom saving throws against spells and effects that erase, modify or extract its memories. Once during the duration, when it would fail such a save, it may choose to succeed instead; doing so ends the spell.

The spell has no effect on a memory already voluntarily transferred by a valid signed contract.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Druid, Warlock, Wizard

Audit the False

5th-level divination (ritual)

Casting Time: 10 minutes
Range: Touch
Components: V, S, M (ink dusted with platinum worth 100 gp, which the spell consumes)
Duration: Instantaneous

Touch one signed document or active magical record. You learn which of up to ten named signatures are forged or produced under magical impersonation; the date and general kind of magical alteration; and whether any cited authority belongs to the purported issuer.

You do not automatically learn the true perpetrator, and the spell cannot declare a genuinely voluntary but harmful agreement invalid. A creature capable of concealing its identity from divination may oppose you with a Charisma save against your spell save DC; on a success, the spell reveals that this entry is obscured, not that it is authentic.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Temporary Injunction

5th-level abjuration

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

One creature you can see makes a Charisma saving throw. On a failure, while within 60 feet of you it cannot teleport or use a feature to summon another creature. It repeats the save at the end of each turn, ending the spell on a success. On an initial success, nothing happens.

This does not prohibit ordinary movement, existing companions or the creature leaving on foot. Teleportation that is part of a mythic death-and-rebirth feature is suppressed only if the creature fails the save and the feature does not explicitly override spells.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Planar Reprieve

6th-level conjuration

Casting Time: 1 minute
Range: Touch
Components: V, S, M (a consecrated home-key worth 500 gp, not consumed)
Duration: Instantaneous

You and up to five willing creatures touching you teleport to a circle that you personally registered earlier on the same plane and within 10 miles. You must have spent 1 hour preparing that circle.

This spell cannot escape a sealed plane and is blocked by effects that prevent teleportation. It is deliberately slower and shorter-range than a universal emergency escape.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Druid, Warlock, Wizard

Sever Assigned Name

6th-level abjuration

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S, M (a seal of genuine testimony worth 250 gp, which the spell consumes)
Duration: Instantaneous

Choose a willing creature whose identity or name has been assigned to a magical claimant without their permission. One spell or magical effect of 6th level or lower sustaining that false assignment ends. For a higher-level effect, make a spellcasting ability check against DC 10 + the effect's level.

If a creature is actively sustaining the assignment, it may make a Charisma save; on a success, only the assignment's control is suppressed until the end of your next turn. This does not erase a legitimate name, make a true soul bargain disappear, or kill a person sustained by magic.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Druid, Warlock, Wizard

Sovereign Injunction

7th-level enchantment

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

One creature that can understand any language you speak makes a Charisma saving throw. On a failure, choose one: it cannot make opportunity attacks; it cannot use legendary actions; or it cannot teleport. At the end of each of its turns it may repeat the save, ending the injunction on a success.

A target with Legendary Resistance may use it normally. The spell does not prevent ordinary actions, remove legendary resistances or compel a contract. It may fail against an especially potent sovereign creature even when a weaker foe would be bound.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Writ of Provisional Dawn

7th-level transmutation

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 120 feet
Components: V, S, M (a sun-marked hourglass worth 500 gp, not consumed)
Duration: Concentration, up to 10 minutes

Within a 60-foot-radius sphere, magical effects that rely on a false or frozen local time instead use the actual passing time at the effect's original place of jurisdiction, if that place is known to you.

This cannot accelerate time, force true sunlight, end a legitimate contract before its term, or negate the passage of a real night. Any creature sustaining a false-time effect may make a Charisma save; on a success, its effect is unaffected until the start of your next turn, at which point the sphere attempts again.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Druid, Warlock, Wizard

Statute of the First Crown

8th-level abjuration

Casting Time: 1 minute
Range: Self (100-foot-radius sphere)
Components: V, S, M (a bronze crown replica worth 1,000 gp, not consumed)
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 hour

Declare a single procedural protection that applies equally to all creatures within the sphere: (a) no magical effect may use a forged signature as a source of authority; (b) no unwilling creature can be compelled to testify by magical effects of 5th level or lower; or (c) contracts of 5th level or lower cannot be magically altered while within the sphere.

A hostile magical creature whose effect would be stopped may make a Charisma save against your spell save DC when first affected, allowing its effect to continue for one round on a success. The protection does not invalidate truthful testimony, a genuine signed contract, or a superior divine law. The sphere is stationary. Casting this spell does not itself make you ruler of Avernus.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Warlock (8th-level Mystic Arcanum), Wizard

Spell use and stacking

New spell damage is not increased merely by using an infernal title. Multiple instances of the same spell do not stack. A character can concentrate on only one concentration effect. A warlock learns these spells under the standard class rules: the 8th-level spell requires a Mystic Arcanum selection, not a normal Pact Magic slot. The spells can be found as researched scrolls during the campaign; DMs need not grant every spell automatically.

The Asmodeun Scriptorium's Contract Spells

The twenty-six spells of the Scriptorium, carried over from *The Night of the Red Clause*. Orren, Caldris and Nema draw on them.

Brand of Arrears

Necromancy cantrip (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S
Duration: Instantaneous

You point at a creature and read its account aloud. Make a ranged spell attack. On a hit, the target takes 4 (1d8) psychic damage as a phantom column of figures tallies itself behind its eyes.

If the target is currently bound by any contract, oath, or Term to which you or an ally is a party, you add your spellcasting ability modifier to the damage.

The damage increases by 1d8 at 5th level, 11th level, and 17th level.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Fine Print

Divination cantrip (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: Touch
Components: V, S
Duration: 1 minute

You touch a written document and read it as Hell reads it. For the duration you comprehend every word, including text in languages you do not know, text deliberately obscured, and text written at a size no mortal eye could resolve. You also learn whether the document carries an active magical clause, and how many separate parties are bound by it.

This spell does not reveal the *content* of a magical clause, nor decipher ciphers or codes. It simply ensures that nothing on the page is hidden from you by the fact of being small, foreign, or shameful.

Ecclesiastical Note: The first cantrip taught to any acolyte, and the last one they thank the Church for. Novices are made to read the Scriptorium's own terms of employment with it. Most of them sign anyway.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Objection

Abjuration cantrip (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 reaction, which you take when a creature you can see within 30 feet makes a Charisma check or states a claim about an agreement
Range: 30 feet
Components: V
Duration: Instantaneous

You interject a single word of infernal legal procedure. The triggering creature has disadvantage on that Charisma check. If the trigger was a claim about the terms of an agreement rather than a check, you instead learn whether the creature believes the claim to be true.

A creature can be affected by your *objection* only once per minute; the courts of Nessus permit one interruption per party per proceeding, and Hell's procedural rules extend to any conversation a devil can overhear.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Sulfurous Seal

Conjuration cantrip (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: Touch
Components: V, S
Duration: 8 hours

You press your thumb to a door, container, scroll, or letter, leaving a smouldering wax sigil. The seal does not hold the object shut, but it cannot be removed, forged, or concealed without breaking, and you know the instant it breaks and in which direction the object lies from you, so long as you are on the same plane.

A creature that breaks the seal without your permission takes 1 fire damage and its hand is marked with a sooty brand for 1 hour, visible to you and to any fiend. This damage increases to 1d4 at 5th level, 2d4 at 11th, and 3d4 at 17th.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Retainer's Fee

1st-level abjuration (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 bonus action
Range: 30 feet
Components: V, M (a coin, which the target must accept)
Duration: 1 hour

You engage a willing creature's services and pay in advance. Name one task, one duty, or one restraint. If the creature accepts the coin, it gains **2d8 + your spellcasting ability modifier** temporary hit points and knows precisely what it has agreed to.

If the creature abandons the named duty while the temporary hit points remain, they are lost immediately and it takes psychic damage equal to the number lost.

At Higher Levels. The temporary hit points increase by 2d8 for each slot level above 1st.

Ecclesiastical Note: Battlefield chaplains of the Church carry sacks of these coins. A frightened militia holds a line rather well when leaving it costs them the only thing standing between them and a spear.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Seal of the First Pact

1st-level enchantment (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 30 feet
Components: V, S, M (a drop of your blood and a scrap of parchment)
Duration: 24 hours

You inscribe a glowing infernal seal in the air and affix it to a willing creature. As the seal takes hold, the target speaks aloud an agreement or vow; its terms imprint into the seal.

For the duration, if the creature knowingly and willingly breaks the agreed terms, the seal shatters. The creature takes 11 (2d10) psychic damage and is marked by a minor curse, suffering disadvantage on Charisma checks and Charisma saving throws until the curse is lifted by *remove curse* or comparable magic, or until it makes amends to the other party's satisfaction.

If the creature upholds its vow for the full duration, the seal fades harmlessly at the next dawn and the creature gains **advantage on one saving throw** of its choice within the following hour—Asmodeus's pat on the head.

At Higher Levels. When you cast this spell using a spell slot of 2nd level or higher, the psychic damage increases by 1d10 for each slot level above 1st, and you can affix the seal to one additional creature for each slot level above 2nd. Each creature swears its own terms.

Ecclesiastical Note: Clerics call this "the simplest form of contract"—a temporary test of one's word. The shattering of a seal is visible to nearby fiends, like a flare fired over a battlefield. Acolytes practise it on one another to train discipline. Very few pairs of acolytes remain friends.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

True Name Revelation

1st-level divination (ritual, infernal)

Casting Time: 10 minutes
Range: 30 feet
Components: V, S, M (a vial of quicksilver and a pinch of powdered vellum)
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 hour

You coax a creature's or object's hidden True Name into your mind. Choose one creature or object you can see within range. A creature can make a Charisma saving throw to resist; on a success, the spell fails and it knows you attempted it.

You learn the target's True Name, and for the duration you gain the following benefits:

- **Advantage on Influence.** You have advantage on Charisma checks made to interact with the named creature.
- **Arcane Insight.** If the target is a magic item, you have advantage on Intelligence (Arcana) checks to identify its properties or to command it.
- **Authority of the Name.** Any spell you cast that binds, compels, restrains, or banishes the named creature imposes disadvantage on its saving throw, as described in Part III.

The spell ends early if the target moves more than 100 feet from you. **You retain the knowledge of the name after the spell ends**, though the mechanical benefits require you to speak it as part of a casting.

Invocation: *"Nomen verum aperiatur, ut verba mea vincula frangant."* — "Let the true name be revealed, that my words may break all bonds."

Scriptorium Notes

- Derived from the *Catechism*'s teachings on True Names, Chapter V.
- This ritual does **not** bind or compel; it grants knowledge only. To compel by name, further rites are required.
- Cast on the same subject daily for seven days, the duration extends to 8 hours per casting, reflecting the deepening of the infernal record.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Contract of the Infernal Fury

2nd-level evocation (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 bonus action
Range: Touch
Components: V, S, M (a pinch of brimstone and a small iron chain)
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

You strike a brief and furious bargain with a willing creature you touch, granting it Hell's ferocity in exchange for Hell's terms. For the duration, the target's weapon attacks deal an extra 3 (1d6) fire damage on a hit.

As part of the casting, the target accepts one **Forbidden Term** of your choosing, which must be a restraint on its conduct: showing no mercy to a named enemy, refusing to retreat from a marked position, or striking no creature that has not first struck it. If the target violates the Term, the spell ends immediately and the target takes 7 (2d6) fire damage as the bargain closes on it.

At Higher Levels. The extra damage increases by 1d6 for each slot level above 2nd.

Invocation: *"By Hell's fury and Asmodeus's will, let our rage burn before His throne."*

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Quill of Binding

2nd-level conjuration (ritual, infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action, or 10 minutes as a ritual
Range: Self
Components: V, S, M (iron filings and a raven feather)
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 hour

You conjure an infernal quill of black iron that writes in blood-red ink, along with parchment enough for one instrument. For the duration, you can use this quill to inscribe contracts with supernatural speed: what would take an hour by mundane means takes one minute. Contracts penned with it have their **Loophole Rating reduced by 1** (minimum 1).

When a creature other than you signs a document written with this quill, choose one of the following clauses to bind into the signature. **A clause endures for its stated duration even after this spell ends**; the concentration requirement governs only the writing, not the writing's consequences.

- **Binding Signature.** For the moment of signing, the signatory cannot knowingly state a falsehood about its intent to uphold the contract. No saving throw; a creature unwilling to submit to this simply refuses to sign, which is itself informative.
- **Clause of Arcane Accountability.** For the next 7 days, whenever the signatory knowingly speaks falsely about the contract's terms or attempts to evade its obligations, the ink on its signing hand flares red, it takes 3 (1d6) psychic damage, and it has disadvantage on Charisma checks made to negotiate or conceal the breach for the next hour.
- **Witness of Asmodeus.** Until the contract is fulfilled or dissolved, you know immediately whenever the signatory breaks a major term, even across planes. You do not learn where they are, only that they have done it, and roughly how pleased Hell is about it.

If you lose concentration while writing, the ink vanishes from the page and the instrument must be redrafted.

Ecclesiastical Note: A gift from Dispater, Archduke of Iron, inspired by his endless archives. Paladins sign their Oaths with it. The Scriptorium keeps a permanent artifact version, *Golgorath's Quill*, used to notarize deals too large to trust to a spell.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Summons and Complaint

2nd-level conjuration (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 30 feet
Components: V, S, M (a sealed writ, which the spell consumes)
Duration: 10 minutes

You conjure a spectral imp clerk in an unoccupied space you can see. It has AC 13, 10 hit points, a flying speed of 40 feet, and immunity to fire and poison damage. It acts on your initiative and obeys your commands, though it will not fight.

The clerk can take only the Dash, Hide, Help, and Use an Object actions, and it can carry up to 20 pounds. Anything it witnesses, it records perfectly, and it can testify to what it saw before any infernal authority; such testimony is accepted as true by devils, which is occasionally more useful than a sword.

Once during the duration, you can command the clerk to **serve the writ** on a creature within 5 feet of it. The target must succeed on a Charisma saving throw or be marked for 1 hour. While marked, it has disadvantage on the first saving throw it makes against a spell you cast, and you always know its direction if it is within 1 mile.

At Higher Levels. When you cast this spell using a 4th-level slot or higher, you conjure two clerks. Using a 6th-level slot or higher, you conjure three.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Devil's Due

3rd-level necromancy (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S, M (a small balance scale and a pinch of sulfur)
Duration: Instantaneous

You call in a debt in blood and spirit. Choose one creature within range that is bound by a magical oath or contract, or that has willingly struck a bargain—written or spoken—with you or with a fiend allied to you. The target must make a Charisma saving throw. On a failed save it takes 21 (6d6) necrotic damage as a portion of its life force is siphoned away in payment; on a successful save it takes half as much damage.

If the creature is in **willful breach** of that agreement at the time of casting, it has disadvantage on the save, and on a failure the damage is maximised.

If this damage reduces the target to 0 hit points and the agreement in question pledged its soul as collateral, the soul is drawn to the Nine Hells rather than departing normally. Such a creature cannot be restored to life by *revivify*, *raise dead*, or *resurrection*; only *true resurrection*, *wish*, or divine intervention will serve, and Hell will litigate all three.

If the target survives, it is branded with a spectral mark on its chest or brow, visible to fiends, indicating that it tried to cheat Hell. Until it fulfils the agreement or the mark is removed by *remove curse*, it has disadvantage on saving throws against the abilities of fiends.

At Higher Levels. The damage increases by 1d6 for each slot level above 3rd.

Thematic Description: You utter an edict—*"All debts must be paid!"*—and a ghostly image of scales briefly overlays the target. Observers report a phantom clink, as of coins dropped into a coffer. The Scriptorium counsels restraint in its use: if mortals grow too frightened to strike deals at all, that is very bad for business.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Injunction

3rd-level abjuration (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S, M (a folded writ, torn as the spell is cast)
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

You name a single action and forbid it. Choose up to three creatures you can see within range and declare one prohibited activity: attacking a named creature, casting spells of a chosen school, moving more than 15 feet in a turn, or leaving an area you designate.

Each target must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw or be bound by the injunction for the duration. A bound creature that attempts the forbidden action takes 18 (4d8) psychic damage, and the action fails and is wasted. A bound creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

A creature that has broken a sworn agreement within the last 24 hours makes its initial saving throw with disadvantage.

At Higher Levels. When cast using a slot of 4th level or higher, you can target one additional creature for each slot level above 3rd, and the damage increases by 1d8 for every two slot levels above 3rd.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Seer's Vigil

3rd-level divination (ritual, infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action, or 1 minute as a ritual
Range: 30 feet
Components: V, S, M (parchment sealed with two drops of blood)
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 hour

You bind your mind to that of one willing creature within range under Asmodeus's watching eye. For the duration:

- You and the bonded creature can communicate telepathically at any distance on the same plane.
- Neither of you can knowingly speak a falsehood to the other through this link. A creature attempting it finds the words will not form.
- Once before the spell ends, either of you can grant the other **advantage on one attack roll, ability check, or saving throw**, declared before the roll.

If the bonded creature is compelled against its will while the vigil holds—charmed, dominated, or magically coerced—you know immediately, and you learn the general nature of the compulsion.

At Higher Levels. When cast using a 5th-level slot or higher, you can bond with one additional creature for every two slot levels above 3rd. Bonded creatures can communicate with each other as well as with you.

Invocation: *"By Asmodeus's gaze beyond the veil, our minds unite in infernal accord."*

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Binding Clause

4th-level abjuration (ritual, infernal)

Casting Time: 1 hour
Range: Touch
Components: V, S, M (rare ink worth 100 gp, which the spell consumes, and a pair of miniature iron manacles)
Duration: Until dispelled or triggered

You spend an hour inscribing a complex binding clause onto a contract, or directly onto two willing creatures as sigils upon their skin. The clause enforces one specific term of an agreement, defined during the casting: *"If X does not fulfil Y by Z, then [consequence],"* or *"So long as A protects B, A gains [boon]."* Choose one effect:

- **Curse of Breach.** A predefined curse of up to 3rd-level strength—as *bestow curse* or a comparable effect—automatically befalls a creature that violates the clause. The target makes a saving throw against your spell save DC when the breach occurs, with disadvantage. The curse persists until the contract is amended or the curse lifted.
- **Geas Enforcement.** A *geas* effect compels the creature to fulfil the clause. If it strays from the mandated duty, it takes 22 (4d10) psychic damage each day until it resumes. Unlike the standard spell, this effect cannot be ended by *remove curse*; it ends when the duty is fulfilled, when the clause is dispelled by *dispel magic* cast using a 5th-level slot or higher, or when *greater restoration* is cast on the creature.
- **Hellish Boon.** Rather than punish, the clause rewards. A creature that upholds the clause gains the benefit of *bless* whenever it acts in direct service of the contract's purpose, or, at your option, a single-use benefit of advantage on one attack roll, save, or check while so acting.

Only one clause effect can be established per casting; a complex contract requires several castings. The caster is immune to the effects of a clause they inscribe, and a clever devil-cleric never signs one from the other side.

Usage in Lore: High Inquisitors apply Binding Clauses to treaties between mortal nobles under the Church's watch. Entire fiefdoms have fallen when a king broke a Hell-witnessed treaty and found his heirs cursed by the terms. The Scriptorium records famous examples, such as the **Edict of the Everloyal**, which held a mercenary company to a hundred days' service under pain of transformation into slugs.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Contract of the Soulforged Blade

4th-level necromancy (ritual, infernal)

Casting Time: 1 hour
Range: Touch
Components: V, S, M (a weapon worth at least 100 gp, 10 gp of iron filings, and a sliver of blood-soaked vellum)
Duration: 24 hours

You forge an infernal compact into a melee weapon. For the duration, the weapon harvests souls and can spend them as fuel.

Soul Capacity. The blade holds a number of souls equal to your proficiency bonus.

Harvesting. When you reduce a hostile creature of challenge rating 1/2 or higher to 0 hit points with the bound weapon, its soul is drawn into the blade and you gain temporary hit points equal to its challenge rating (minimum 1). Souls beyond the blade's capacity are flung to Avernus through a crackling portal above the weapon, each becoming a lemure.

Spending Souls. As part of casting a spell of 3rd level or lower from the Infernal Contract Spell List, you can expend **N** souls in place of an Nth-level spell slot. When you do, make an Intelligence saving throw (DC 12 + 2 × (N − 1)).

- **Success.** The spell is cast and the souls are consumed.
- **Failure.** The souls combust. You take 9 (2d8) psychic damage per soul expended, the blade goes inert until you finish a short or long rest, and the souls are consumed regardless.

You cannot use souls to cast this spell, and any souls remaining when the spell ends are released to Avernus.

Weapon Attunement Progression. By renewing this ritual on the *same* weapon, the infernal bond deepens.

- **Tier 1 (Days 1–7).** Duration 24 hours; renewal daily.
- **Tier 2 (Days 8–28).** The bond stabilises; renewal every 7 days suffices.
- **Tier 3 (Beyond Day 28).** Renewal once per 28 days suffices.

If renewal lapses by more than one full period, the spell ends and the progression resets to Tier 1.

At Higher Levels. For each slot level above 4th: the duration extends by 24 hours, the blade's soul capacity increases by 1, and the maximum level of spell you can fuel with souls increases by 1 (to a maximum of 5th).

Words of Binding: *"Per pactum laminae, animas vinctas ferrum accipiat; superflua in Avernum mittantur!"*

Scriptorium Notes

- This rite weaves the **Binding Clause** and the **Seal of the First Pact** into the steel itself.
- Precise vellum inscriptions—the weapon's name and its soul limit—are required. Any error voids the bond.
- Lemures delivered to Avernus stand as offerings in the Infernal Ledger, and are counted toward your tithe quota.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Writ of Repossession

4th-level transmutation (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S, M (a wax seal bearing your sigil)
Duration: Instantaneous

You reclaim what was lent. Choose one object within range that you granted to another creature, that was pledged as consideration in a contract you hold, or that was taken from you unlawfully within the last 30 days. The object must weigh 100 pounds or less and must not be an artifact.

If the object is held or worn by a creature, that creature makes a Strength saving throw. On a failure, the object vanishes and reappears in your free hand. On a success, it holds fast and you learn the nature of the claim by which it does so.

A creature that is in breach of the agreement under which the object was granted has disadvantage on this save.

Additionally, you can use this spell to strip a **granted boon** rather than an object: a blessing, charm, or magical benefit you personally conferred on a creature ends immediately, with no saving throw.

At Higher Levels. When cast using a slot of 6th level or higher, you can target one additional object or boon for each slot level above 4th, and the weight limit rises to 500 pounds.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Infernal Class Action

5th-level evocation (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 120 feet
Components: V, S, M (a bundle of writs bound in red thread)
Duration: Instantaneous

You name up to six creatures within range as parties to a single grievance and read judgment against all of them at once. Each named creature must make a Dexterity saving throw, taking 28 (8d6) fire damage on a failed save, or half as much on a success.

A named creature that is currently in breach of any oath, contract, or sworn promise has disadvantage on this saving throw, and the damage against it is psychic instead of fire—the fire of a debt it recognises.

The named creatures need not be near one another, and the spell requires no line of effect between them, only that you can see each of them. Hellfire finds parties to a filing wherever they stand.

At Higher Levels. When cast using a slot of 6th level or higher, name one additional creature for each slot level above 5th.

Ecclesiastical Note: Introduced to the Scriptorium's practice in the year the Church discovered that suing three hundred villagers individually was inefficient. The rite is condemned by every mortal legal tradition and by four of the nine archdukes, chiefly on grounds of taste.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Soul Covenant

5th-level enchantment (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 minute
Range: 15 feet
Components: V, S, M (diamond dust worth 200 gp and a sliver of a soul coin, both consumed)
Duration: Until fulfilled or broken

You speak aloud a covenant, binding up to two willing creatures —which may include yourself—into a soul-bound contract beneath Hell's regard. All parties must be within range for the full casting, and all must agree to the declared terms before it completes. As you finish, each signatory's name burns itself into the air in fiery script and brands onto the covenant document. Each creature bears an **Infernal Mark** thereafter, signifying that its soul is pledged to the deal.

While the covenant persists, all parties are subject to the following:

- **Bond of Obligation.** Each creature is under a *geas* effect with no time limit, compelled to fulfil the agreed terms. Ignoring the duty or acting counter to it inflicts 27 (5d10) psychic damage per day of defiance. A willful attempt to break the covenant outright engulfs the creature's mark in hellfire, dealing 28 (8d6) fire damage immediately as a warning. This effect cannot be ended by *remove curse* or *dispel magic*; only *wish*, divine intervention, or fulfilment of the terms will end it.
- **Shared Fate (Optional Clause).** You can declare at casting that the signatories' fates are linked. If so, they cannot directly harm one another until the covenant resolves—attacks are stayed by an invisible force, harmful spells fizzle—and if one party dies before the terms are met, each survivor takes 35 (10d6) necrotic damage as part of the forfeit is extracted from them.
- **Infernal Witness.** The covenant is recorded in the grand infernal ledgers the instant it is sealed. Any fiend of Intelligence 6 or higher recognises a marked creature as under contract and will not casually interfere with it. You have **advantage on Charisma checks** made to influence lawful evil fiends in matters relevant to the covenant.

Breach. If a party grossly violates the terms, the covenant exacts payment at once: the offender is struck as by *flame strike* (6d6 fire and 6d6 radiant, the radiance being the searing light of Hell's judgment) and its soul is forfeit to the Nine Hells. A character whose soul is claimed this way is beyond ordinary resurrection and, in most campaigns, beyond further play; discuss this with your GM before signing anything.

Sacred and Scorned Use: This is the apex of infernal contract magic accessible to mortal casters—a miniature Pact Primeval. The Church reserves it for alliances between high priests, the sanctification of dark knighthoods, and the securing of a powerful warlock's soul. The casting is a spectacle: black candles, chanting choirs, lesser devils in attendance, diamond dust flaring in a brazier as each name burns. When the marks brand onto flesh, participants report searing pain followed by euphoria, as though touched directly by Asmodeus. Few dare break such a covenant; the known instances are infamous and are recited as morality plays by Hell's standards.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Amend the Record

6th-level transmutation (infernal)

Casting Time: 10 minutes
Range: Touch
Components: V, S, M (a knife, an eraser of pumice, and ink worth 250 gp, consumed)
Duration: Instantaneous

You touch a written contract, oath, or binding instrument and alter one of its Articles. The new wording must be of comparable scope to the old; you cannot use this spell to write yourself a kingdom, and Hell audits.

Every party bound by the instrument makes a Charisma saving throw, made with advantage if the amendment materially worsens that party's position. If **all** parties fail, the amendment takes effect and is recorded as though it had always been so; every copy of the document, including Hell's, updates itself. If **any** party succeeds, the amendment fails, all parties become aware that you attempted it, and you take 33 (6d10) psychic damage as the ledger rejects your hand.

A party who is present, willing, and consenting to the amendment automatically fails the save, which is why the honest way to use this spell is to ask first.

Ecclesiastical Note: The single most closely watched rite in the Scriptorium's repertoire. Every casting is logged. Unlogged castings are investigated by a bone devil auditor within the month, and the investigation is not adversarial so much as forensic and extremely slow.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Contract of Infernal Servitude

6th-level conjuration (ritual, infernal)

Casting Time: 1 hour
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S, M (a written instrument of service and 500 gp of infernal ink, consumed)
Duration: 30 days

You bind an extraplanar creature into lawful service. Choose one celestial, elemental, fey, or fiend of challenge rating 6 or lower that you can see within range, or summon one you name to an unoccupied space within range. The creature must make a Charisma saving throw. On a success, it resists and is immune to this spell for 24 hours—and, if it was summoned, it departs in a very poor mood.

On a failed save, the creature is bound by the terms written in your instrument. It must obey your commands to the letter for the duration. It will not follow an order that violates a term you granted it, and it will follow every other order in the most literal manner the wording permits.

Your instrument must specify a **service**, a **duration of the working day**, and a **consideration**. A bound creature that has been fairly considered serves competently; a bound creature that has been cheated serves precisely, which is far worse for you.

The spell ends early if the creature is reduced to 0 hit points, if you order it to act against a term of the contract, or if you fail to render the promised consideration.

At Higher Levels. When cast using a slot of 7th level or higher, the maximum challenge rating increases by 2 for each slot level above 6th, and the duration increases to 180 days at 8th level and one year and a day at 9th.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Foreclosure

7th-level necromancy (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S, M (a soul coin, consumed)
Duration: Instantaneous

You call every debt owed by a single creature due at once. Choose one creature within range that is bound by an oath, contract, or covenant. It must make a Charisma saving throw.

On a failed save, the target takes 66 (12d10) necrotic damage and its soul is placed under **lien**: for the next 30 days it cannot be restored to life if it dies, it cannot benefit from any effect that would transport it to another plane, and any healing it receives is halved. On a successful save it takes half damage and suffers no lien.

A creature in willful breach of the agreement makes this save with disadvantage. A creature whose True Name you speak as part of the casting makes it with disadvantage as well; both conditions do not stack, but both are satisfying.

The lien ends early if the debt is discharged—by fulfilling the contract, by delivering the agreed consideration, or by a substitution accepted by the holder.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Writ of Cessation

7th-level abjuration (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 90 feet
Components: V, S, M (a gavel of black iron)
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

You declare a 30-foot-radius sphere centred on a point you can see to be under the jurisdiction of the Ninth Hell. For the duration, the following laws hold within it:

- A creature that makes an attack roll, casts a spell with a harmful effect, or takes any hostile action while inside the sphere must first succeed on a Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, the action fails and is wasted, and the creature takes 33 (6d10) psychic damage.
- No creature inside the sphere can be teleported, banished, or otherwise removed from it against its will.
- Every creature inside the sphere hears every word spoken within it, in a language it understands, whether or not it wishes to.

You are not exempt. Hell's magistrates do not exempt themselves either; it is one of the very few things about them that mortals grudgingly admire.

Ecclesiastical Note: The traditional opening of an infernal arbitration. Armies have been stopped mid-charge by a single Scriptorium magistrate with a gavel and no sense of self-preservation. Some of them were even paid.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Paladin, Warlock, Wizard

Charter of the Iron Tower

8th-level abjuration (ritual, infernal)

Casting Time: 1 hour
Range: Self (500-foot radius)
Components: V, S, M (an iron boundary stake driven at each cardinal point, and 1,000 gp of infernal ink, consumed)
Duration: 24 hours

You charter a demesne and impose your law upon it. Choose an area up to 500 feet in radius centred on you. As part of the casting, declare up to **three Clauses**, each a clear, specific prohibition or requirement stated in a single sentence.

Every creature that enters the demesne becomes aware of the Clauses in a language it understands. A creature that knowingly violates a Clause suffers one consequence of your choice, chosen per Clause at the time of casting:

- **Chastisement.** The creature takes 44 (8d10) psychic damage. It can repeat this consequence no more than once per turn.
- **Restraint.** The creature is restrained by infernal chains until the end of its next turn. A successful Strength saving throw ends the effect early.
- **Ejection.** The creature is teleported to the nearest unoccupied space outside the demesne and cannot re-enter for 1 hour.

A creature makes a Charisma saving throw when it first violates a Clause; on a success it is immune to that Clause's consequence for 1 hour, though it remains subject to the other two.

Making it Permanent. If you cast this spell in the same location every day for 30 days, using the same three Clauses, the charter becomes permanent until dispelled. Dispelling it requires *dispel magic* cast using a 9th-level slot, the consent of the chartering caster, or a ruling from an infernal court of superior jurisdiction.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Devil's Advocate

8th-level conjuration (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 minute
Range: 30 feet
Components: V, S, M (a retainer of 1,000 gp in gems, which the advocate takes and keeps)
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 hour

You retain an infernal advocate: a barrister of the Court of Nessus who arrives already briefed, already annoyed, and entirely on your side for exactly as long as you have paid for. It uses the erinyes stat block, with these changes:

- Its Intelligence and Charisma scores are each 20, and it has proficiency and expertise in Persuasion, Deception, and Insight.
- It can cast *counterspell* at will, using its Charisma, but only in response to a spell cast by a creature that is a party to a dispute in which it is representing you.
- Once per round, when a creature within 60 feet makes a saving throw against a spell you cast, the advocate can **file an objection**, giving that creature disadvantage on the save.

The advocate acts on its own initiative and obeys the terms of its retainer, not your whims. It will argue, negotiate, notarize, intimidate, and if necessary fight—but it will not accept an instruction that contradicts the retainer, and it will bill you for any that try.

If the spell ends while a proceeding is unresolved, the advocate departs, and any contract it was drafting is left unsigned and legally worthless. It is generally cheaper to pay for another hour.

Spell Lists. Bard, Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Pact Primeval

9th-level enchantment (ritual, infernal)

Casting Time: 24 hours
Range: 30 feet
Components: V, S, M (a soul coin per signatory and 25,000 gp of diamond and onyx dust, consumed)
Duration: Until fulfilled or broken

You forge a covenant of world-shaping weight, binding up to **eight willing creatures**—which may include yourself—to a single declared Purpose. The Purpose must be a concrete objective or an enduring state of affairs: a war ended, a bloodline protected, a city's laws upheld, a god's prison kept sealed.

While the covenant holds, each signatory gains:

- Advantage on saving throws against effects that would prevent it from pursuing the Purpose.
- Resistance to fire and psychic damage.
- The ability to communicate telepathically with every other signatory across any distance on the same plane.
- Knowledge, at all times, of whether each other signatory yet lives, and whether each yet keeps faith.

Breach. A signatory that knowingly acts to defeat the Purpose is struck by the full weight of the First Contract: it takes 110 (20d10) psychic damage, its soul is forfeit to the Nine Hells, and every other signatory learns its name and its location at the moment of betrayal, wherever in the multiverse they stand.

Fulfilment. When the Purpose is achieved, the covenant dissolves. Each surviving signatory is restored to full hit points, is cured of all curses, diseases, and levels of exhaustion, and may ask one question of Asmodeus's court, which will be answered truthfully and unhelpfully.

Scope. This spell binds only willing mortals and creatures of the lower planes. It cannot bind a deity, an archdevil, or a creature that has never possessed a soul. Attempts to include such a party do not fail dramatically; they simply produce a document that Hell declines to file, which is worse.

Ecclesiastical Note: The Scriptorium teaches this rite to perhaps one scholar a century, and always with the same lesson attached: the original Pact Primeval was not signed to win a war. It was signed to end an argument. Everything Hell has become since is downstream of a compromise that both sides believed they had won.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Writ of Damnation

9th-level necromancy (infernal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S, M (the signed contract binding the target, which the spell consumes)
Duration: Instantaneous

You execute the ultimate judgment of Hell's law upon one creature bound by a soul-pledging contract that you hold and that the creature has broken. No other target is legal, and against any other target the spell simply fails, wasting the slot and, more painfully, the paperwork.

The target must make a Charisma saving throw with disadvantage. On a failed save, it takes 97 (15d12) necrotic damage, and if this reduces it to 0 hit points, its soul is drawn instantly to the Nine Hells and bound into a soul coin that appears in your hand. On a successful save it takes half damage, and the contract binding it is consumed and **voided**—its debt is discharged by its defiance, and it is free.

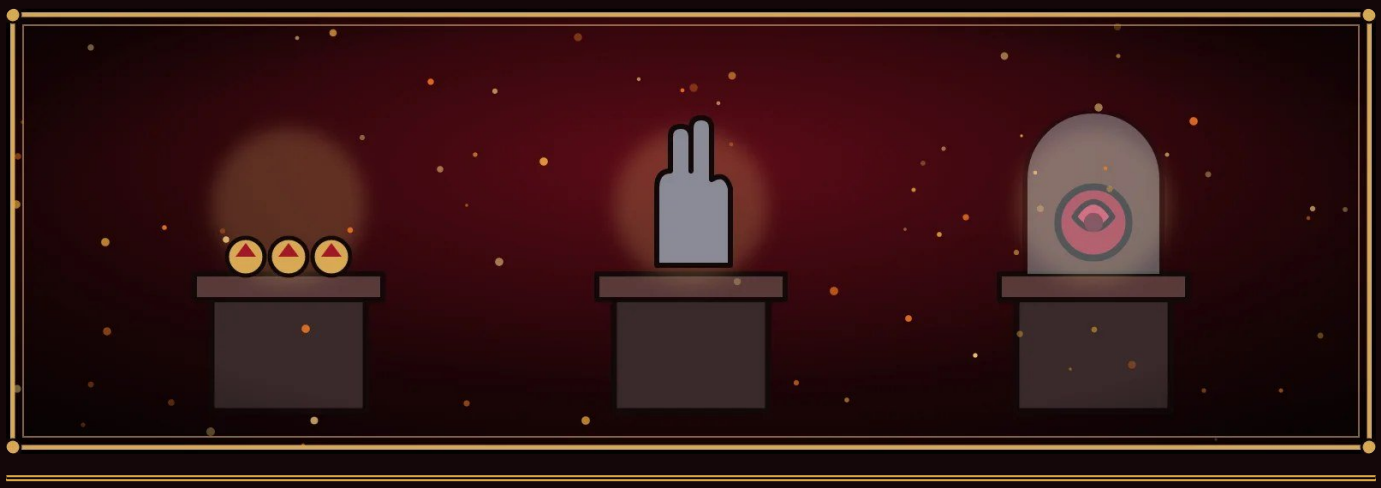
A creature whose soul is bound into a coin this way cannot be restored to life by any means short of *wish* or divine intervention, and even then only if the coin is first recovered and unmade.

Final Admonition: The Scriptorium permits this rite to be performed only after the breach has been proven before a witness of at least bone devil rank. This is not mercy. It is that a wrongful damnation is a breach of the Pact Primeval itself, and the entity that comes to collect on *that* debt does not negotiate.

Spell Lists. Cleric, Warlock, Wizard

Chapter 5

Relics of the Championship



6. Relics, Rewards and Championship Equipment

The following fourteen items are unique to this campaign. Normal attunement limits apply. The items are rewards for an entire party, not fourteen things one claimant is expected to acquire. A particularly important tool can also be obtained by contract, loan, purchase from a faction, or restitution.

Item	Rarity	Attunement	Recommended acquisition
Quill of True Notice	Uncommon	No	the Act I registration desk
Receipt of the Last Gift	Uncommon	No	Waterdeep carry-over / Act I
Crownmark Gauntlets	Rare	Yes	the first Proof of Survival
Mistletoe Manacles	Rare	No	citation enforcement stores
Marshal's Chain of Allegiance	Rare	Yes	the Greyhurst coalition
Ashen Seed of Remembrance	Rare	Yes	the Greyhurst grove
Glassheart Interpreter	Rare	No	Janella's forge
Pyric Covenant Ring	Rare	Yes	Misty's embassy
Contract-Splitter Blade	Very rare	Yes	the Citadel preliminary prize
Gavel of Appeal	Very rare	Yes	a Brass Arbiter special commendation
Writshield of Personal Sovereignty	Very rare	Yes	the hag's first witness
Hourglass of True Dawn	Very rare	Yes	the time registrar's vault
Lantern of the Three Witnesses	Very rare	Yes	the Heartstone investigation
Blackthorn Shears	Very rare	No	the Pyric Reliquary

Quill of True Notice

Wondrous item, uncommon

A signature written with this quill leaves an indelible, visible timestamp and the signer's chosen disclosed name on the original sheet; copies show a faint orange line.

The quill has 3 charges, regaining 1d3 at dawn. Expend a charge to learn whether the signature immediately before you was physically written by the person presenting themselves as its signer (an impostor may have signed sincerely under a false name). The quill is not a universal lie detector and cannot compel someone to sign.

Recommended acquisition: the Act I registration desk.

Unless a description says otherwise, a charge spent on a spell uses the listed item save DC, does not consume a spell slot, and recharges at dawn in Avernus.

Receipt of the Last Gift

Wondrous item, uncommon

A fragment of Form H-25 from Waterdeep, signed by the independent Brass Arbiter. As an action, display it to create a 10-foot-radius field that grants advantage on saving throws against being charmed or magically compelled by fiends until the end of your next turn. It then crumbles into red ash.

The receipt is also admissible documentary evidence of the Waterdeep ruling; that legal property is not consumed until the hearing ends.

Recommended acquisition: Waterdeep carry-over / Act I.

Crownmark Gauntlets

Wondrous item, rare (requires attunement)

While wearing them, you have advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks made to climb, grapple or hold a contested objective.

Once per long rest, when you reduce a hostile creature to 0 HP or hold an advertised arena control point for two consecutive rounds, you may use a reaction to gain 15 temporary hit points. The gauntlets never create extra Crown Marks; they only reward the underlying action.

Recommended acquisition: the first Proof of Survival.

Mistletoe Manacles

Wondrous item, rare

Three pairs. Reusable restraints for Medium or smaller creatures. A willing creature can be bound automatically; an unwilling, grappled creature is bound only after an action and a successful DC 17 Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) check contested by its Athletics or Acrobatics. A restrained wearer can use its action to attempt DC 17 Athletics or Acrobatics to escape.

The manacles prevent nonmagical use of hands but do not suppress spellcasting by themselves. Once per long rest, the wielder can activate them to prevent the wearer from teleporting until the end of its next turn on a failed DC 17 Charisma save. They contain no soul-ownership clause.

Recommended acquisition: citation enforcement stores.

Marshal's Chain of Allegiance

Wondrous item, rare (requires attunement)

When a willing creature within 30 feet explicitly accepts your command for a specific task of no more than 1 minute, you may link a spectral brass strand to it; you can have only one such link active.

Once per short rest, when the linked creature fails a saving throw, you can use your reaction to add 1d6 to the failed roll, potentially turning it into a success. Either participant can end the link instantly without cost. This is teamwork, not domination.

Recommended acquisition: the Greyhurst coalition.

Ashen Seed of Remembrance

Wondrous item, rare (requires attunement by a spellcaster)

Planting this dark-red seed over 1 minute creates a 20-foot-radius thicket lasting 1 hour. Willing creatures resting within it have advantage on checks and saving throws against magical memory alteration for the duration.

Once per long rest, one creature completing a short rest in the thicket may restore one expended Hit Die and can remember one event from its own life that had been altered by a spell of 5th level or lower, subject to the spell's original saving throw. It cannot recreate another person's experiences or restore a soul already lawfully sold.

Recommended acquisition: the Greyhurst grove.

Glassheart Interpreter

Wondrous item, rare

A palm-sized receiver keyed to Janella Greenbottle's maker-mark. Holding it within 30 feet of one of her golems allows a creature proficient in Arcana or tinker's tools to hear the construct's current orders and detect whether they were altered after leaving her workshop.

Once per long rest, the operator can use an action to give a construct another saving throw against a magical command effect, or force an uncontrolled construct to make a DC 17 Wisdom save or lose reactions until its next turn. The device never grants permanent ownership or control of an unwilling autonomous construct.

Recommended acquisition: Janella's forge.

Pyric Covenant Ring

Ring, rare (requires attunement)

You gain resistance to necrotic damage. Once per long rest, when a creature within 30 feet willingly tells you a truthful fact that would place it at risk, you can use a reaction to grant it 2d8 temporary hit points and advantage on its next saving throw before the start of your next turn.

The inscription reads: *A secret given freely is worth more than a secret stolen.* A rival who sees the ring may assume you work for Misty; the ring itself does not bind you to her.

Recommended acquisition: Misty's embassy.

Contract-Splitter Blade

Weapon, very rare (requires attunement)

Weapon (any sword), very rare (requires attunement). A +2 magic sword (statted here as a longsword).

Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature maintaining a magical contract effect, you can deal 3 (1d6) force damage additional damage.

Once per long rest, after hitting a target, you may choose one magical effect of 5th level or lower currently imposing a penalty or compulsion on that target; make a DC 17 ability check using your spellcasting ability, or Intelligence if you have none. On a success, end that effect. This cannot cancel a valid written agreement itself; it severs one active magical enforcement effect.

Recommended acquisition: the Citadel preliminary prize.

Gavel of Appeal

Wondrous item, very rare (requires attunement by a spellcaster)

This blackwood gavel has 3 charges, regaining 1d3 daily. As an action expend one charge to cast *dispel magic* at 4th level.

When resolving a public, contested hearing with documents that the relevant adjudicator can inspect, you can expend one charge to grant advantage on one Investigation, Religion or Persuasion check concerning admissibility or interpretation. No more than one charge may be spent this way per hearing, and the gavel cannot turn a lie into a true exhibit.

Recommended acquisition: a Brass Arbiter special commendation.

Writshield of Personal Sovereignty

Armour (shield), very rare (requires attunement)

Shield, very rare (requires attunement). A +1 shield.

When you or a creature within 10 feet fails a Charisma saving throw against a magical attempt to alter identity, bind a soul or compel a personal oath, you can use your reaction to allow a reroll. The second result stands. This can be done twice per long rest.

During the Heartstone confrontation, the shield can serve as one authentic protection against the queen's identity-seizure effects, but gives no automatic immunity to her spells.

Recommended acquisition: the hag's first witness.

Hourglass of True Dawn

Wondrous item, very rare (requires attunement)

Sand inside the glass flows according to time on the plane and jurisdiction named when the hourglass is activated. Once per long rest, as an action, create a 30-foot-radius sphere centred on the glass for 1 minute. Magical environmental effects relying solely on fabricated or frozen time are suppressed within the sphere.

A hostile source may make a DC 18 Charisma save when the field appears; on a success, its effect is delayed rather than suppressed for one round. The sphere does not create daylight, erase legitimate service, or halt natural time. In Misty's lair, activating it can delay one lair-action pulse or the Heartstone recovery pulse, not both.

Recommended acquisition: the time registrar's vault.

Lantern of the Three Witnesses

Wondrous item, very rare (requires attunement)

Three oil reservoirs are inscribed **Name**, **Consent** and **Jurisdiction**. The lantern has three charges and cannot be recharged until the campaign's current Heartstone rite ends.

One charge makes a hidden true-name inscription visible for 10 minutes; another grants advantage on one saving throw against a hag's enchantment or illusion (declare before rolling); the third illuminates a hidden soul-anchor or its nearest ward within 60 feet.

A bearer who has gathered all three Heartstone witness statements may use all remaining charges as an action to deactivate one of the queen's three witness-seals. It does not deal damage to Misty.

Recommended acquisition: the Heartstone investigation.

Blackthorn Shears

Wondrous item, very rare

A single-use ritual implement shaped from living infernal blackthorn. With an action while adjacent to a properly exposed soul-anchor, cut the magical tether connecting the anchor to its owner.

This succeeds only if the party has already disabled two witness-seals or obtained a valid independent court order establishing unlawful ownership. If used on Misty's Heartstone after her second defeat, the shears destroy the tether and render the stone vulnerable to physical destruction. They cannot permanently kill a creature while its living body is elsewhere or erase a consented mortal contract as an incidental benefit.

Recommended acquisition: the Pyric Reliquary.

Equipment balance and attunement

For a standard four-to-six-person party, three to five of these permanent attunement items by level 15 and three Heartstone tools spread among different characters by level 17 provide meaningful preparation without assuming every player gets a new legendary weapon. The unique anti-Misty tools help the party; they do not make a CR 30 mythic encounter safe. Item features calling for an action, reaction, charge or concentration use that action economy exactly.

Chapter 6

The Charter and Eight Contracts



7. Eight Contracts for Players

All eight forms are complete player-facing offers. A document only becomes effective when the appropriate signer freely accepts. There are no invisible additional paragraphs. The public Charter takes precedence over narrower private agreements when they conflict about eligibility or consent.

- **Form IC-01 — Covenant of Joint Regency**
- **Form IC-02 — Writ of Safe Passage**
- **Form IC-03 — Retainer of Witness Protection**
- **Form IC-04 — Misty's Memorandum of Memory Escrow**
- **Form IC-05 — Warden's Declaration of Autonomy**
- **Form IC-06 — Covenant of Faction Sponsorship**
- **Form IC-07 — Duel of Measured Claims**
- **Form IC-08 — Notice of Withdrawal and Return**
- **Blank Legal Challenge Card**

Remember the Scriptorium's existing Ledger rules remain available for voluntarily negotiated bargains. Official Championship Charter petitions do not automatically exact the Scriptorium's default 5% soul-fee on a failed argument; hearings under this Charter waive that fee and impose disclosed procedural delay or limited Crown Mark risks instead.

The Invitation

The Office of the Ninth Crown · By Order of the Lord of Nessus

Official Notice of Conditional Succession

A red envelope arrives with no messenger. Its seal is a crown of nine black thorns. The paper smells of ash, cinnamon and wet iron.

Whereas the First Layer requires a sovereign of proven force, ingenuity and contractual competence; whereas the present administration is subject to audit; and whereas the armies of Hell are weary of appointments made entirely by nepotism—

THE FIRST INTERPLANAR CHAMPIONSHIP IS HEREBY DECLARED.

You may seek the throne alone. You may nominate partners. You may reject the invitation.

But only those who attend will decide who rules Avernus next.

OFFICE OF THE NINTH CROWN

Public Instrument · Binding on All Contestants

The Nine Articles of Infernal Succession

This is the real player-facing charter. It can be handed out and used at the table. In the fiction it is witnessed by the Office of the Ninth Crown. No DM-only appendix changes these terms without a visible amendment and the genuine acceptance of an affected signatory.

Article I - Notice and Acceptance. A contender enters only after freely accepting this Charter, personally or through a disclosed and authorised proxy. Participation does not by itself pledge a soul, bloodline, descendants, memories or previously held property. Contestants who decline are not subject to its competitive obligations.

Article II - Competence. Qualification for final investiture requires valid proof of Survival, Deviousness, and Dominion. Competence may be demonstrated by physical contest, tactical leadership, investigation, negotiation, contract drafting, or other witnessed acts relevant to the Proof. No particular alignment or class is required.

Article III - Form of Claim. A claimant may seek the office alone, as part of a joint slate, or as the disclosed representative of a patron. A joint slate is one legal claimant for eligibility and reward purposes, with several named members. It must publish its internal voting and succession rules before investiture.

Article IV - Consent and Persons. No soul, memory, identity, body, service beyond the explicit competition, or interest in a dependent is transferred by acceptance of this Charter. Additional bargains require separate, informed and specific acceptance by the person holding the right being transferred.

Article V - Evidence and Eligibility. Certified records, witnessed acts, magical verification and authentic signatures are admissible. Forged entries may be challenged. A claimant has a right to review allegations against their eligibility and to present counterevidence before exclusion.

Article VI - Hearings. The Brass Arbiter is independent of individual contestants and must state the clause upon which each ruling relies. An appeal submitted before a scheduled forfeiture stays that forfeiture until the hearing, except immediate defensive action during active combat.

Article VII - Deceit and Contest. Tactical deception, disguise, misdirection, negotiation, coercive battlefield magic within the agreed contest, and lawful exploitation of a clause are permissible. Forgery of the Arbiter's seal, false representation of another person's consent, and threats against uninvolved dependents are not. A successful combat feint does not transform into an agreement to transfer a soul.

Article VIII - Duties and Withdrawal. A contestant may withdraw before final investiture and depart via a sanctioned return route once any particular, previously signed service duties are discharged. Withdrawal forfeits unspent Crown Marks but incurs no new soul penalty. A

crowned ruler must defend the First Layer against invasion, uphold the published governance charter and answer the superior authority of the Lord of Nessus.

Article IX - Investiture. The lawful victor obtains the First Crown and the ability to appoint ministers, issue civil decrees and govern Avernus subject to Asmodeus's superior sovereignty and existing higher infernal law. The prize may be held by a registered joint slate. Investiture is witnessed publicly by the Brass Arbiter; Asmodeus will not withdraw it solely because he dislikes a lawful outcome.

Player's Legal Quick Start

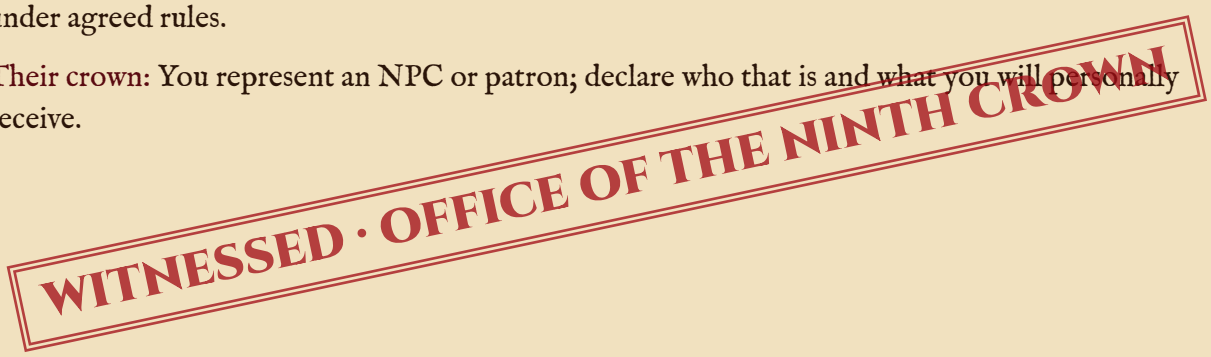
When arguing an objection, identify (1) the named contract, (2) the actual clause, (3) who owns the right, (4) the evidence of consent or default, and (5) your requested remedy. A well-substantiated factual contradiction may succeed without a roll. When an issue is genuinely disputed, the DM should announce its legal DC rather than hiding an unanswerable rule.

Three claims you can make

My crown: You will rule alone, rewarding allies with offices or granting them independence.

Our crown: Sign the Covenant of Joint Regency to govern together, with the ability to disagree under agreed rules.

Their crown: You represent an NPC or patron; declare who that is and what you will personally receive.



Form IC-01 · Championship of the First Crown

Covenant of Joint Regency

Parties: The named members of the proposed regency slate, identified below.

Consideration: Each member contributes campaign Proofs, testimony, strategic resources and governance service to the same recognised claimant.

Term: From signature until the slate withdraws or, if crowned, until all members unanimously dissolve or amend this instrument.

Office and voting: The slate holds the First Crown as a single legal office. At investiture, the signatories select an initial First Speaker. Ordinary policy is decided by simple majority; declaring a new war, selling an involuntary soul claim, or altering this Covenant requires unanimous consent. A dead or incapacitated member's vote is suspended until restored, but their membership is not automatically transferred.

Withdrawal: Before investiture, a member may withdraw by written notice; their personal Proofs cease to count unless separately assigned by explicit agreement. After investiture, a member may resign an executive duty without forfeiting their pre-existing personal soul, property or memories.

Disputes: The Brass Arbiter may interpret this written instrument. It cannot invent a missing unanimous vote.

Signatures:



Form IC-02 · Championship of the First Crown

Writ of Safe Passage

Parties: A named carrier or guild and up to six named travellers.

Service: The carrier provides escorted passage between the two destinations written below, using a route they reasonably consider safe from known hazards.

Price: 100 gp or one named logistical favour due within seven days of arrival, selected before acceptance.

Term: One journey, ending at the destination or after 48 hours, whichever comes first.

Limitations: The carrier need not defeat armies or disclose protected third-party trade routes. Travellers retain their weapons, bodies, memories and souls. A traveller may withdraw and travel alone; the paid fee is not refundable for services already rendered.

Breach: If the carrier deliberately abandons travellers without a credible threat to its own survival, it owes one replacement escort or return of the fee. If a traveller attacks the carrier first, the carrier may suspend escort duties while protecting itself.

Start / End: Price selected: Signatures:

PENDING SIGNATURE

Form IC-03 · Championship of the First Crown

Retainer of Witness Protection

Parties: One named witness and one named sponsoring claimant.

Offer: Sponsor provides reasonable shelter, medical care and an evacuation route until the testimony hearing concludes.

In exchange: Witness agrees to answer honestly about firsthand events and to identify material uncertainties. No guarantee of favourable testimony is made.

Privacy: The sponsor may disclose the witness's location only with permission or to the neutral Brass Arbiter for a sealed proceeding. The witness may refuse to reveal unrelated private memories.

Duration: Until the first completed testimony hearing or seven days, whichever comes first.

Breach: A party who deliberately exposes the witness to unnecessary harm must pay reparations decided by the Arbiter, capped at the value of the provided protection. The witness may leave freely.

Witness: Sponsor: Place of hearing:

PENDING SIGNATURE

Form IC-04 · Championship of the First Crown

Misty's Memorandum of Memory Escrow

Offeror: Misty, Queen of Barbed Chains, acting through the Pyric Triune.

Recipient: The named claimant below.

Consideration from Misty: Verified location of Janella's stolen infernal-glass core, plus one truthful answer concerning the current successor register.

Consideration from claimant: For twenty-four hours only, Misty may hold a magically exact copy of a single, specifically identified memory. The claimant retains the original memory. The copy may be inspected by Misty personally and cannot be sold, duplicated or transferred.

Excluded property: Soul, other memories, bodily autonomy, future votes, and any friend's secrets not owned by the claimant.

Return and destruction: The copy is irreversibly erased when escrow expires. The claimant may demand earlier destruction by returning Misty's answer unused and transferring no obtained core-related advantage. Disputes go to the Brass Arbiter. An unauthorised transfer is a material breach that entitles the claimant to termination and restitution.

Exact memory deposited:

Claimant: Pyric Witness:

PENDING SIGNATURE

Form IC-05 · Championship of the First Crown

Warden's Declaration of Autonomy

Parties: Janella Greenbottle, the restored Iron Warder identified by core number, and the named claimant supporting them.

Declaration: The Warder is recognised as an independent protective agent whose primary instruction is to safeguard the civilians it voluntarily names. Its maker retains rights in the physical plans; neither maker nor claimant acquires the right to command a self-aware construct against its explicitly registered protective mandate.

Mutual assistance: The claimant agrees to maintain safe access to repairs. The Warder agrees to defend Greyhurst for one season, provided that defence does not require harming civilians it has sworn to protect. Remedy: A disputed command is suspended for one round while a tribunal determines whether it conflicts with the registered mandate. This procedure does not grant a combatant perpetual immunity from control magic.

Warder designation: Janella: Claimant:

PENDING SIGNATURE

Form IC-06 · Championship of the First Crown

Covenant of Faction Sponsorship

Parties: Named faction and named contestant or joint slate.

Sponsorship: Faction supplies one unit of scouts, a safehouse, or a single rare magic item on loan (choose exactly one before signing).

Return: Claimant gives the faction a public hearing within thirty days after investiture regarding its proposed policy, without promising to enact the policy.

No purchase of government: The sponsor acquires neither sovereign veto nor automatic ministry. It may speak as a petitioner, not as a private ruler.

End: One successful hearing, written mutual cancellation, or claimant's lawful withdrawal.

Faction: Support selected: Claimant:

PENDING SIGNATURE

Form IC-07 · Championship of the First Crown

Duel of Measured Claims

Parties: Two named willing contestants.

Arena: Publicly announced site, time and dimensions.

Victory condition: First creature to surrender, be reduced to 0 HP, or be pushed from the marked central dais twice loses. At 0 HP, nonlethal magical stabilisation occurs immediately by the neutral marshal unless the participant expressly opts into a different publicly disclosed risk.

Agreed award: One Crown Mark transfer only if the loser legally owns that Mark and signs this instrument before combat. Otherwise the award is purely public recognition.

Restrictions: No action against spectators, dependents or uninvolved witnesses. Allies may not join without both duelists' consent.

Dispute: An equipment or arena violation suspends the duel for review. Contestants may jointly end the duel without penalty.

Contestant A: Contestant B: Marshal:

PENDING SIGNATURE

Form IC-08 · Championship of the First Crown

Notice of Withdrawal and Return

Claimant:

Notice: I withdraw from the Championship before investiture. I acknowledge forfeiture of unspent Crown Marks attached to my personal claim. I do not sell, tithe, transfer or abandon my soul, existing property, memories or identity by this notice.

Outstanding particular duties:

Discharge method and deadline:

Return route: The Office of the Ninth Crown will provide one sanctioned gate to the claimant's declared home plane within 24 hours of discharge or confirmed absence of such duties.

Effect: Acceptance of this filing ends competitive obligations under the public Charter. A separate valid bargain remains in force according to its actual terms and can be contested independently.

Claimant signature: Received by: Docket number:

PENDING SIGNATURE

Filed before the Brass Arbiter

Legal Challenge Card

Use this quick form whenever an exhibit, magical promise or arena rule is contested:

Standing (why I can object):

Article or instrument quoted exactly:

Material fact in dispute:

Proof or witness offered:

Remedy requested:

Ruling / costs / appeal date:

Chapter 7

Infernal Machines and Soul Coins



In Avernus, war machines run on souls. Before the road to the Brass Citadel you may borrow, restore or steal one, and you will have to decide what to burn in it. These are the rules your table uses; the GM has the same pages.

Every soul coin is a person. An infernal engine is not merely a furnace. It is a prison, a fuel tank and a choir of memories, and who the trapped soul was changes what the war machine can do.

Quick Play: Five Steps

Step	Procedure
1 · Identify	Action; DC 14 Intelligence (Arcana or Religion). Reveals the Echo, the soul's emotional tone, its remaining charges and any visible legal seal. It does not let you question the soul.
2 · Feed	Driver's bonus action. The whole coin is consumed and its soul enters the furnace. Each remaining charge gives 24 hours of fuel and 1 Resonance Spark.
3 · Tune	Only one Echo is active per engine. Engineer's action and DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana or tinker's tools) switches to another bound soul. Failure wastes the action.
4 · Pulse	Driver's bonus action or engineer's action. Spend 1 Spark and gain 1 Heat. One Pulse per vehicle per round.
5 · Release	Stop the engine, then use a consecrated focus and an action: DC 18 Arcana or Religion, or suitable curse-removing magic. On a success that soul is freed and its fuel and Echo end.

Energy, Heat and Crew

Resonance Sparks. A coin contributes Sparks equal to its remaining charges when fed (1–3). Sparks never recharge. Fuel durations stack; Echo bonuses don't. Track each bound soul by name, with its own Sparks.

Heat. Gain 1 Heat for each Pulse or Overburn. An engineer can use an action and DC 15 Intelligence (tinker's tools) to remove 2 Heat (1 on a failure). At the end of a round with neither a Pulse nor an Overburn, remove 1 Heat.

Crew. Weapons need a gunner's action; magic and boarding use the rider's own action. Echoes never give the vehicle a free turn. All bonuses obey the chase limits: +4 maximum to a check, and Lead moves at most 2 steps a round.

Heat	Effect
0–2	Stable. No adverse effect.
3–4	Strained. The engine screams; a warning, not a penalty.
5	Critical. Each further Pulse or Overburn triggers a furnace mishap on a d6 roll of 1–2.
6	Rupture. The vehicle takes 3d10 fire damage that bypasses its threshold; roll a vehicle mishap; reset Heat to 3.

Soul Echoes (d100)

Roll when a soul coin enters play. The Echo comes from who the soul was in life, not whether they were good or evil.

d100	Soul	Echo (passive while active)	Pulse (1 Spark, +1 Heat)	Voice
01–10	**The Courier** *A runner, messenger or smuggler who died before a final delivery.*	Vehicle speed increases by 10 feet. This never adds extra Lead by itself.	Ignore one stretch of difficult terrain this round, and grant +2 to the convoy's end-of-round Lead check (subject to the +4 cap).	Repeats an address, begging for one last message to be delivered.
11–18	**The Lancer** *A cavalry officer, outrider or chariot champion.*	The first ram made by this vehicle each round deals +1d4 damage on a hit.	The next ram before the end of the turn deals +2d8 piercing damage; the target driver makes a DC 16 Strength save or shifts one lane.	Insists the engine be pointed toward a worthy foe.
19–27	**The Artificer** *A smith, golemancer or enginewright who remembers every broken gear.*	Engineers gain +2 on checks to repair this vehicle.	Restore 3d10 vehicle hit points without expending a repair kit. The machine must be above 0 HP.	Knows a maker's mark or a schematic relevant to a campaign construct.
28–36	**The Scout** *A pathfinder who learned to survive impossible roads.*	Crew gain +2 on Perception or Survival checks to spot and navigate road hazards.	Reroll the next road hazard this round and choose either result; gain advantage on one check to avoid it.	Warns of dangers before anyone else can see them.
37–45	**The Thief** *An infiltrator, escape artist or fugitive.*	The driver gains +2 on checks to evade pursuit; riders gain +2 on boarding checks.	Sever one nonmagical snare or harpoon line affecting the vehicle and immediately change one lane without a maneuver check.	Offers the name of someone who sold them out.
46–54	**The Fire Adept** *A pyromancer, furnace-priest or careless arsonist.*	The first hit each round with a vehicle weapon that deals fire damage gains +1d4 fire damage.	A 15-foot cone erupts from the engine: DC 16 Dexterity save, 3d8 fire damage on a failure, half on a success. It can hit allies.	Laughs when the exhaust flames change colour.
55–63	**The Healer** *A physician, hospice worker or battlefield medic.*	Successful vehicle repairs restore 3 additional hit points.	Choose one: a rider regains 3d8 hit points, or the vehicle regains 2d10 hit points. Neither works on the dead or a wreck.	Asks the crew to save someone instead of winning a race.
64–71	**The Warlord** *A commander whose voice is louder than the engine.*	Embarked allies gain +1 on saving throws against being frightened.	An allied vehicle within 60 feet gains 10 temporary hit points and +2 on its next driving check before the end of the next round.	Gives orders even when no one wants to follow.
72–79	**The Magistrate** *An advocate, judge, clerk or infernal contract drafter.*	Crew gain +2 on Investigation, Religion or Persuasion checks made to examine or contest an infernal writ.	Add +2 to one crew member's check to contest a contract; or one legal-enforcement construct within 60 feet makes a DC 16 Charisma save or suspends one ongoing non-damaging lien effect until the end of its next turn.	Knows which seal, signature or date has been forged.

d100	Soul	Echo (passive while active)	Pulse (1 Spark, +1 Heat)	Voice
80–86	**The Penitent** *A redeemed sinner or faithful martyr who refuses to surrender compassion.*	Reduce the first instance of fire damage the vehicle takes each round by 3 (after resistance).	End the frightened condition on all embarked allies; one devil within 30 feet makes a DC 16 Wisdom save or is blinded until the end of its next turn.	Whispers a prayer that the engine cannot drown out.
87–94	**The Berserker** *A pit fighter whose dying rage still wants motion.*	When this vehicle Overburns, reduce its self-inflicted fire damage by 1d6 (minimum 0).	The next ram before the end of the turn deals +2d8 bludgeoning damage; the vehicle takes 1d8 recoil damage that bypasses its damage threshold.	Challenges every driver to go faster.
95–00	**The Planar Cartographer** *A traveller who saw paths between realities.*	The driver gains +2 on Arcana checks to navigate planar anomalies.	Teleport the vehicle and embarked occupants up to 30 feet to visible unoccupied ground, ignoring one immediate terrain hazard. This does not cross a planar barrier or end a chase automatically.	Knows a dangerous shortcut toward the Brass Citadel.

Handling, Consent and Legal Claims

Before the coin enters an engine. Holding a coin lets you sense the soul's emotion without a check. Identify (DC 14) reveals the Echo, attitude, charges and seal. To ask the soul a factual question, use the coin's ordinary Query, which spends a charge; the soul knows only what it knew in life. Drain Life also spends a charge and grants temporary hit points. When the last charge is spent the coin crumbles and the soul goes free.

Charges. A fresh coin holds 3 charges; a used one 1 or 2. Salvaged coins: roll d6 (1–2 one charge, 3–4 two, 5–6 three). No coin ever holds more than 3 charges or gives more than 3 Sparks.

When fuel runs out. A soul burned as fuel to the end is destroyed. That is what the engines sing about.

Legal play. A printed lien does not override the soul's real contract. An action and DC 16 Investigation or Religion finds an inconsistency in a recorded claim. At an infernal tribunal, DC 18 Persuasion or Religion wins a temporary stay when evidence is incomplete; authenticated proof of forgery, a paid debt or a missing grant of title wins the objection outright. A stay blocks seizure but does not by itself free a soul.

Misty's black seal. A coin stamped MIST-113 is claimed by the Hell Hag Queen's agents. An invented docket, stolen maker's mark or voided debt invalidates the claim; the seal gives no special magical ownership. The bound soul may know who applied it.

Liberation. A failed release attempt can be retried after 10 minutes and deals 1d6 psychic damage to the liberator, never to the soul. Other souls in the furnace keep the engine running. A freed soul may leave one parting gift: a true secret, a map clue, or advantage on one future check.

Demon ichor. A flask runs a machine for 8 hours at −20 feet speed, with a 1-in-6 chance of a mishap whenever it Overburns. Ichor engines have no Echo. It is unstable, but it burns no one.

d8	What the voice sounds like
1	Terrified, pleading
2	Angry, accusatory
3	Grief-stricken and distant
4	Coldly calculating
5	Quietly courageous
6	Eager to bargain
7	Deliriously joyful
8	Refuses to speak

d6	Claim record	What it means
1	Valid debt, correctly signed	The coin can be bought or used; no objection lies.
2	Signature forged	An objection wins outright once the forgery is proved.
3	Debt already paid	Proof of payment wins an objection automatically.
4	Captive of a night hag	Misty's coven holds the original; expect a MIST-113 seal.
5	Claim sold twice	Two creditors; neither holds clean title. A DC 16 check finds the second sale.
6	No recorded title	No one may lawfully sell this coin. It can be confiscated and freed.

Furnace Mishaps (d6)

d6	Mishap
1	**Clogged pistons.** Vehicle speed is halved until the end of its next turn.
2	**Choir of pain.** The driver makes a DC 15 Wisdom save or has −2 on the next driving check.
3	**Fuel-line burst.** The vehicle takes 2d10 fire damage that bypasses its damage threshold.
4	**Locked steering.** The next lane change is made at disadvantage.
5	**Ghost hands on the controls.** The driver passes DC 15 Dexterity (land vehicles) or shifts one lane.
6	**An infernal seal flashes.** One pursuing creditor knows the vehicle's location for 1 hour.

Example Souls

Tarnik Blackspoke (Lancer). An Avernian outrider falsely blamed for abandoning his squad. He wants their graves found. His Pulse is devastating on a Cinderfang Spiker, and his sworn enemy knows the real story.

Ysera Quill (Magistrate). A clerk who refused to validate Misty's forged chain of title. A MIST-113 stamp covers her original docket number. If Queried, she can name the crucial missing signature. (If Aurelia Quill is in play, Ysera is her great-aunt, and Aurelia knows the name.)

Merrow Kindhand (Healer). A battlefield surgeon who treated enemies as readily as allies. She refuses to help a crew that attacks refugees, and pleads for her family's release.

Sevrin Nine-Roads (Planar Cartographer). A trader who mapped a way from the Blackspine Narrows to the Brass Citadel. The route lies in a song he taught his daughter.

Which Soul for Which Machine

War machine	Recommended soul	What it changes
Scorchhound Quad	Courier or Scout	Faster recon, hazard avoidance, route-breaking escapes.
Cinderfang Spiker	Lancer or Berserker	Harder rams and high-risk interception.
Souljack Hauler	Artificer or Healer	Keeps crew and cargo alive; repairs under fire.
Iron Reclaimer	Magistrate or Warlord	Enforcement authority and control of allied vehicles.

Worked Example

The party feeds a 2-charge Scout coin to its Souljack Hauler: 48 hours of fuel, 2 Sparks, Heat 0.

- **Round 1:** the engineer Pulses, rerolling a claw-teeth hazard (Sparks 1, Heat 1).
- **Round 2:** the driver Overburns for +2 on the Lead check, taking 2d10 fire damage (Heat 2).
- **Round 3:** no Pulse or Overburn, so Heat falls to 1.

The Scout's passive +2 to hazard checks stays on throughout. If the soul is freed at a stopped engine, its Echo and its remaining fuel vanish together.

Rules boundary: ordinary soul-coin charges and fuel follow the established Avernus war-machine model. Echoes, Sparks, Heat, tuning, the coin tables and liberation checks are campaign homebrew for Interplanal Champions.

Driving in Avernus

Who does what. The driver spends their action to drive, change lanes, attempt a stunt or ram; their bonus action can start or stop the engine, juke, Overburn, feed a soul coin or Pulse. Gunners fire stations with their own actions, and the engineer repairs and cools the furnace. A vehicle never takes actions of its own, and riders cast and attack normally.

Lead. In a chase your convoy has a Lead score from 0 to 6. At the end of each round the lead driver makes a DC 16 Dexterity check (with land-vehicle proficiency): success raises Lead, failure lowers it. Scouting, maneuvers and teamwork add up to +4. Reach Lead 6 and you're clear.

Passengers. Scout (action; DC 15 Perception, Survival or Investigation) to give the driver +2; jump between adjacent vehicles with DC 15 Acrobatics or Athletics; catch a falling ally as a reaction (DC 15 Athletics). Anyone thrown off lands on the road and needs rescuing, not a funeral.

Repairs. With a repair kit and smith's or tinker's tools, an action and DC 15 Intelligence restores 2d10 + 5 vehicle hit points.

Driver maneuver	Action and check	Effect
Hold the line	Drive; no extra check	Move as you like; the normal end-of-round Lead check applies.
Thread the needles	DC 16 Dex (land vehicles)	Avoid a telegraphed hazard and give the convoy +2 on its Lead check; on a failure, take the hazard.
Swerve and screen	DC 15 Dex (land vehicles)	Allies behind you have half cover until your next turn; success also gives one ally +2 on its next chase check.
Ram	Adjacent target; vehicle attack	Use the machine's ram attack instead of evasive driving.
Board alongside	DC 16 Dex (land vehicles)	Pull alongside another vehicle for the round so allies can grapple, fight or jump across.
Overburn	Bonus action, once per round	+2 on this round's Lead check; your vehicle takes 2d10 fire damage that bypasses its threshold; +1 Heat.

The Machines You Can Crew



Compact and fast, with ragged blades and a twin-piston soul furnace: a warlord's favourite scout bike. It handles tight lanes with advantage on checks to avoid the claw-teeth. The driver has half cover from the engine cage.

Infernal war machine. An object, immune to poison and psychic damage and to the charmed, frightened and poisoned conditions. The machine never acts on its own; every weapon needs a crew member's action.

- **Damage threshold:** one instance of damage below it deals 0.
- **Mishap threshold:** a single hit meeting it triggers a d6 vehicle mishap.
- **Fuel:** soul coins (Soul Furnace Codex) or demon ichor.

Scorchhound Quad

Large vehicle (land)

Armor Class 16

Hit Points 68 (damage threshold 10, mishap threshold 25)

Speed 130 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	17 (+3)	14 (+2)	0 (−5)	0 (−5)	0 (−5)

Damage Immunities poison, psychic

Condition Immunities blinded, charmed, deafened, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, stunned, unconscious

Capacity 1 crew, 1 passengers

Stations Helm, chain-bow

Chain-Bow (passenger station). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, range 60/180 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d10) piercing damage. Once per round, on a hit against a vehicle, its driver makes a DC 15 Strength save or cannot Overburn until the end of its next turn. The line can be cut (AC 16, 15 HP).

Spike-Dash (driver, once per chase). After a successful DC 16 Dexterity (land vehicles) check, increase Lead by 1 and take 1d10 slashing damage from scorching debris. Uses the driver's action and counts toward the two Lead changes a round.



Scarred black iron wheels, hooked blades and a burner tuned to make crowds panic. These are Misty's escort bikes, but the party may steal one.

Infernal war machine. An object, immune to poison and psychic damage and to the charmed, frightened and poisoned conditions. The machine never acts on its own; every weapon needs a crew member's action.

- **Damage threshold:** one instance of damage below it deals 0.
- **Mishap threshold:** a single hit meeting it triggers a d6 vehicle mishap.
- **Fuel:** soul coins (Soul Furnace Codex) or demon ichor.

Cinderfang Spiker

Large vehicle (land)

Armor Class 17

Hit Points 78 (damage threshold 10, mishap threshold 25)

Speed 115 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	15 (+2)	16 (+3)	0 (−5)	0 (−5)	0 (−5)

Damage Immunities poison, psychic

Condition Immunities blinded, charmed, deafened, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, stunned, unconscious

Capacity 1 crew, 1 passengers

Stations Helm, side blades

Sideblade (driver, while adjacent, once per round). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (3d10) slashing damage. Against a creature the blade deals 3d6 slashing instead. A hit on a vehicle imposes −2 on that driver's next maneuver check. Replaces another driving stunt that turn.

Chain Flail (passenger station). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, range 30/90 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (2d8 + 3) bludgeoning damage. An exposed rider hit makes a DC 15 Strength save or is knocked prone on its vehicle; it falls only if it then moves recklessly or fails another balance check.



A survivor-built armoured mule. Seated riders have half cover; one creature in the armoured cargo locker has three-quarters cover. Its engine can be detached for maintenance and its central cage can carry the infernal-glass heart. It carries 3 repair kits and 6 harpoons.

Infernal war machine. An object, immune to poison and psychic damage and to the charmed, frightened and poisoned conditions. The machine never acts on its own; every weapon needs a crew member's action.

- **Damage threshold:** one instance of damage below it deals 0.
- **Mishap threshold:** a single hit meeting it triggers a d6 vehicle mishap.
- **Fuel:** soul coins (Soul Furnace Codex) or demon ichor.

Souljack Hauler

Huge vehicle (land)

Armor Class 18

Hit Points 175 (damage threshold 15, mishap threshold 45)

Speed 95 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	12 (+1)	20 (+5)	0 (−5)	0 (−5)	0 (−5)

Damage Immunities poison, psychic

Condition Immunities blinded, charmed, deafened, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, stunned, unconscious

Capacity 4 crew, 3 passengers

Stations Helm, harpoon, furnace gun, engineer

Chain Harpoon (gunner). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, range 120/240 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (3d10) piercing damage. The target vehicle makes a DC 16 Strength save or is Snared while the chain holds: −2 on its next Lead-related driver check. Remove the chain with an action and DC 16 Strength, or cut it (AC 16, 20 HP).

Furnace Gun (gunner; 4 ash cartridges). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, range 90/180 ft., one target. *Hit:* 18 (4d8) fire damage. On a natural 1 the gun jams; clearing it takes an action and DC 15 tinker's tools.

Shield Plating. The hauler takes half damage from the first ram against it each round (before its damage threshold). At the DM's discretion it can shield an allied quad in the same lane instead.

Chapter 8

Player Rules, Advancement and 2024 Conversion



A practical level-12 party setup

All new pregens begin with one short-term objective, one faction they understand, and one doubt about Hell's bureaucracy. The DM should hand them the nine Charter articles before any signature. Players may review, reject, propose amendments, seek a proxy or sign as a joint slate. A character who refuses can participate in an exploratory capacity until choosing a claim, without acquiring contestant Crown Marks.

Crown Marks are public rewards for genuine Proofs, not transferable currencies merely because someone writes a counterfeit receipt. A joint slate can pool eligible Proofs when it is registered. The party should keep a shared page with: current claim type, each Proof, additional Marks, outstanding agreements, current witness names, and the proposed order of succession.

2024 conversion

The adventure's maths assumes 2014-era class progression. For 2024-style play, use the newer base classes, proficiency progression and current spell text where it differs. Ruby Court patron starts at Warlock 3 rather than Warlock 1; its later features are at 6/10/14. Circle of Ashen Covenants starts at Druid 3 rather than Druid 2; later features are at 6/10/14. Path of the Blood-Price remains at Barbarian 3/6/10/14. Do not grant the same initial features twice when converting an existing character. For the three imported Scriptorium subclasses, follow that book's conversion sidebar and the table's declared class-feature timing.

A 2024 spell may have altered balance, duration or concentration. Use the modern spell's full text for that base spell. The 17 new spells in Section 5 are explicitly homebrew and have the effects printed here. All use the character's normal spellcasting modifier; an item states its own DC when it supplies a fixed one.

Fighting a legendary hag at level 17

The Heartstone arc is optional and advertised as extreme. The Queen is a mythic CR 30 antagonist, not a fair level-17 encounter in isolation. Strengthening a party with items, legal injunctions, the testimony of the Three Witnesses, and high-level spells may give them a slim, meaningful chance. Players should not expect ordinary attrition and damage alone to carry them to victory. No part of the Charter requires Misty's death to win the throne. Misty can be bargained with, outmanoeuvred, sponsored, publicly defeated in law, or physically challenged at enormous risk.

Character journals

At the end of each session, note: (1) one promise you fulfilled; (2) one promise you are considering; (3) one person who now has cause to trust or fear you. These are roleplay records, not soul penalties. At levels 13, 15 and 17, revisit each character's governance manifesto. Ask whether the ambition that brought them to Avernus is the same ambition they still hold.

Scriptorium compatibility reference

The Night of the Red Clause, Appendix G, The Asmodeun Scriptorium, contains 26 previous contractual spells, three subclasses (School of Infernal Contracts wizard, Oath of the Infernal Lord paladin, Contract Domain cleric), seven formal scroll contracts, and the Ledger subsystem with Draft DCs, Loophole Ratings and a soul-tithe track. This book adds three new subclasses, seventeen new spells, fourteen items, and eight complete Championship contract forms. It neither supersedes the original spell descriptions nor declares any signer to have accepted a contract they did not see. The two books can be used alongside the Red Clause Scriptorium as a single contract-magic rules family.

End of Book II — Player's Guide. Print the Nine Articles and the eight forms for play; keep the DM-only secrets, Misty lair details and encounter tables in Book I.

WITH THANKS



PACTS & POLYHEDRALS



BLOWN AWAY



IMAGI-NATIONS

To the Pacts & Polyhedrals, Blown Away and Imagi-Nations Discord servers, and to our playtesters, who were here first.

THE PLAYTESTERS

Tim · Alex · Heather · Kai

ASMO, PACTS & POLYHEDRALS (BEN VALE)

“My crown, our crown, or their crown?”

The Championship of the First Crown is open. Register alone, as a joint slate, or as a patron's proxy. Nobody makes you sell your soul. Nobody stops you, either.

- **Six level-12 claimants on five-page sheets**
- **The Ruby Court, Blood-Price and Ashen Covenants**
- **17 contractual spells and 14 relics**
- **The Soul Furnace: soul coins and war machines**
- **The Nine Articles and eight player contracts**